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2019 阅读大赛初赛 1

Directions: *In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)*

Questions 1-3 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the following quotes. Match the quotes with the book titles. Please note there are two extra options.

- A. *Pride and Prejudice*
B. *Alice's Adventures in Wonderland*
C. *David Copperfield*
D. *To Kill a Mockingbird*
E. *The Unbearable Lightness of Being*

1. 1

It's no use going back to yesterday, because I was a different person then.

2. 2

Love is the longing for the half of ourselves we have lost.

3. 3

My advice is, never do tomorrow what you can do today.
Procrastination is the thief of time.

Directions: *In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)*

Question 4 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Costco's chickens are bigger and cheaper than its competitors, yet it still has no plans of raising its price anytime soon — which is surprising because its \$4.99 price tag is so low that the retailer actually loses money on its chickens. But the money lost is a small price to pay for the foot traffic the company gets when poultry lovers go in for a chicken and come out with a full shopping cart.

4. Why does Costco avoid price hikes on its chicken?

- ☐ A. It wants to knock out other competitors.

☐ B. It tries to allure customers to buy other goods.

☐ C. The money lost is too small to mention.

☐ D. Its aim is to sell more goods at a small profit.

Directions: In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)

Question 5 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.



Perfume, for decades, was all about tangible effort. If you went through the trouble of spraying on a shellac of sweetness, you wanted people to notice, to inhale deeply during a hug and ask after your elixir. Now the dream question to be asked is: Why do you smell so good? Is it new soap?

The New Softies allow consumers to cover their tracks. You may have spent a mint to smell vaguely fresh and clean, but no one has to know. These new scents, heavy on synthetic formulations, are created to melt into the skin and evaporate in intimate puffs. They are perfume imagined as a deceptively expensive white T-shirt that drapes in all the right places.

5. Which of the following is a feature of the new perfume?

- ☐ A. It is like a mint sprayed on white T-shirts.
- ☐ B. It contains tiny synthetic formulations.
- ☐ C. It smells almost like nothing.
- ☐ D. It is a new kind of soap.

Directions: In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)

Question 6 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Hormones are like the managers of the body's organs and other tissues. These chemicals order cells — from your head to your toes — to switch on or off some particular activity. The brain usually coordinates the release of hormones, sending these managers to a particular job site when it's time for work to begin. But sometimes industrial chemicals and pollutants can mimic these managers. When such imposters enter the body, they can alter when or how an organism develops, what it looks like — even whether it gets some disease.

Toxicologists — the scientists who study the action of poisons — have begun referring to these hormone mimics as *endocrine disruptors*. That's because the endocrine system releases hormones. And these chemicals fake out the normal players in this system.

Hormones work in very small amounts. Still, they can have very big impacts. Hormones usually tell cells to start some task now. Or they turn on signals that report what's going on in and around the body.

6. Which of the following statements is INCORRECT according to the text?

- ☐ A. Even tiny amounts of hormones can have very big impacts on our body's organs and other tissues.
- ☐ B. The brain controls the release of hormones and sends them to a particular job site.
- ☐ C. Endocrine disruptors can affect many body activities, such as growth of an organism.
- ☐ D. Industrial chemicals and pollutants release the same hormones as the endocrine system does.

Directions: In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)

Question 7 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.



The term "International Schools" originally applied to schools that solely catered for expatriate communities in certain countries. These schools tended to be staffed by nationals from the expatriate country of origin and to teach a curriculum that was based on the one found in the home country. So, a school founded to educate children of UK expats living in Singapore would typically have an English school curriculum and English or English-speaking teachers and staff.

In more recent years though, the "International Schools" label has expanded to cover schools that set out to foster a global or international outlook in the minds of their students. These schools teach an international curriculum, typically English or American, will have English as their primary teaching language and will prepare pupils for a relatively seamless transition to higher education institutions beyond their country of residence.

7. In "International Schools" in recent years, students will have _____.

- ☐ A. an international outlook
- ☐ B. immersed English learning environment
- ☐ C. elite traditional courses
- ☐ D. a curriculum of the country of residence

Directions: In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)

Question 8 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Many college students try to live up to other people's high expectations. For example, they might be afraid of disappointing so-called "helicopter parents" who micromanage their lives, expect perfection, and push them toward classes and activities that they have no real interest in. As a matter of fact, a growing body of research now links helicopter parenting with college depression. After all, how can a student be expected to successfully handle so many new challenges if he or she has never been given the freedom to make mistakes or control his or her own life?

8. "Helicopter parents" can be defined as parents who _____.

- ☐ A. are unduly involved in their children's life
- ☐ B. often make their children disappointed
- ☐ C. usually push their children to face diverse challenges
- ☐ D. devote too much time to cultivating their children

Directions: In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)

Question 9 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

A wetland is an area of land that is completely soaked with water or flooded. ① It can be soaked all year round, or just for a season or two. ② Marshes, swamps and bogs are all different kinds of wetlands. ③ They are their own kinds of ecosystems. ④ Wetlands can be inland, or on coasts. They can be freshwater like a swamp or saltwater like a salt marsh. They can even be a brackish mixture of the two, like a mangrove forest.

9. Which blank does the following sentence best fit in?

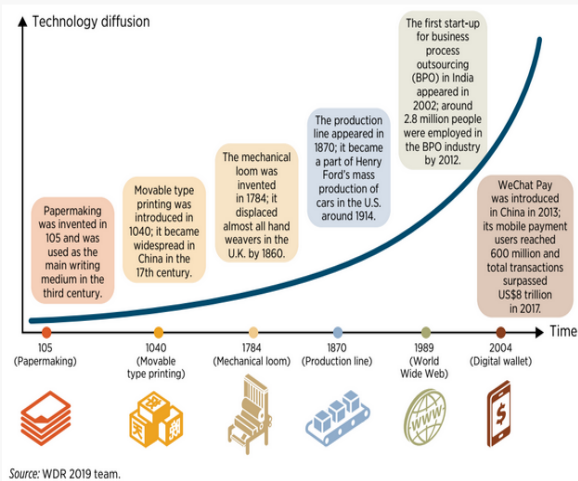
But wetlands are more than just a flooded piece of land.

- ☐ A. ③
- ☐ B. ②
- ☐ C. ④
- ☐ D. ①

Directions: In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)

Question 10 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: Answer the question according to the information in the figure.



10. What can we learn from the figure?

- ☐ A. The time interval between major innovations is decreasing.
- ☐ B. Technology diffusion is independent of geographical restrictions.
- ☐ C. The rate of technology diffusion is speeding up.
- ☐ D. People gain increasing benefits as time goes by.

Directions: *In Part II, you will read short texts on different subjects. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions based on logical inference and reasoning. (Time allowed: 55 minutes)*

Question 11 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

11. Which of the following examples contains a different logical fallacy from the other three?

- ☐ A. "Most of my friends have joined the social media website, so I need to create an account as well."
- ☐ B. "You did smoke when you were at my age! Therefore I can do it too."
- ☐ C. "Drink Gatorade because that's what all the professional athletes do to stay hydrated."
- ☐ D. "Almost everyone at my school will be at the party on Friday night. It must be the right thing to do."

Directions: *In Part II, you will read short texts on different subjects. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions based on logical inference and reasoning. (Time allowed: 55 minutes)*

Question 12 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the following text. Answer the question according to the text.

Philosophy is supposed to stand on neutral ground. But most philosophers argue for very definite conclusions. This is hardly standing on neutral ground. Shouldn't we conclude that most philosophers aren't doing philosophy?

12. Which of the following logical fallacies does the text illustrate?

- ☐ A. **Special Pleading:** a fallacy in which a person applies standards, principles, rules, etc. to others while taking herself/himself (or those s/he has a special interest in) to be exempt, without providing adequate justification for the exemption.
- ☐ B. **Guilt by Association:** a fallacy in which a person rejects a claim simply because the people s/he dislikes accept the claim.
- ☐ C. **False Analogy:** a fallacy drawing an analogy or comparison between two situations that are totally dissimilar.
- ☐ D. **Equivocation:** a fallacy in which a key term or phrase in an argument is used in an ambiguous way, with one meaning in one portion of the argument and then another meaning in another portion of the argument.

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Directions: In Part II, you will read short texts on different subjects. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions based on logical inference and reasoning. (Time allowed: 55 minutes)

Questions 13-14 Reasoning (Suggested completion time: 8 minutes)

The population of *peregrine falcons* (游隼) declined rapidly during the 1950s and 1960s and reached an all-time low in the early 1970s. The decline was attributed by scientists to the widespread use of the pesticide DDT in the rural areas.

13. Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the argument above?

- ☐ A. Some states had passed the law that banned the hunting of peregrine falcons and other birds of prey.
- ☐ B. Different from scientists, most ordinary people had little or no knowledge of the bad effects of DDT.
- ☐ C. DDT was highly effective as an insecticide though it can cause potential damage to ecology if abused.
- ☐ D. According to scientists who studied peregrine falcons, the population of its prey declined dramatically from 1950s to 1970s.

14.

Mark notices that a tree in his yard is dying. A few weeks later, he notices that the flowers planted around the tree are dying. He notices that many leaves from the tree are piled around the flowers and concludes that the dead tree killed the flowers.

Which of the following most undermines Mark's conclusion?

- ☐ A. The river nearby was recently polluted and the toxins in the water got into the soil.
- ☐ B. Mark is good at gardening and takes care of everything he planted.
- ☐ C. There is a biological way to send messages between the tree and the flowers.
- ☐ D. Plants have adaptation strategies to deal with environmental challenges.

Questions 15-16 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about middle-aged runners. Answer the questions according to the text.

According to data released by the running app Strava, middle-aged runners consistently average faster marathon times than their younger rivals, apparently defying the usual rules of athletic performance. Men in the 40-49 age bracket clock an average time of four hours and 17 minutes for a marathon, according to the recent figures. Women in the same age range typically come in at just under the five-hour mark.

In both instances, middle-aged runners outperform runners in their 20s, with fortysomething men and women more than two minutes and one minute faster than their younger peers, respectively. And, the data seems to suggest why: more hours spent pounding the pavements.

A key differential appears to be the hours the two groups are willing to put in. According to Strava, older runners average 28 miles (45km) a week about three months before race-day, compared with 24 miles for those in their 20s.

The rationale seems sound—marathon runners talk about having “miles in their legs” in reference to the buildup of strength and muscle from years of training. Yet how much difference an extra four miles a week makes is debatable. For the 59-year-old veteran Richard Askwith, the author of *Feet in the Clouds*, older runners’ success is more likely to be about mentality.

“Your perception of time changes with age. You become more patient in training and in racing... rather than fretting about the distance, we just cruise along in a more relaxed frame of mind,” he says.

The author of *Primate Change*, Vybarr Cregan-Reid, 50, argues that what 20-year-olds have in bone density and muscle mass, they lack in race experience and tenacity. “I’m sure if you saw race splits for younger runners, you would see that they went off much faster. Those in their 40s have enough experience not to make that rookie mistake.”

But it may not be a case of the tortoise and the hare, he adds. “I’m not convinced that people in their 40s train more. But I suspect it’s much more likely that someone in their 40s will track their training with an app.”

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15. According to the text, which of the following is NOT true?

- ☐ A. It is typically believed that younger runners outperform elder rivals in marathon.
- ☐ B. Patience is of great significance in both training and running for all ages.
- ☐ C. Running 4 miles more per week before race-day guarantees better performance.
- ☐ D. In general, people in their 40s run at least one minute faster than those in their 20s.

16. According to Vybarr Cregan-Reid, what is the reason for middle-aged runners' better performance?

- ☐ A. They are more persistent and richer in race experience.
- ☐ B. They are more willing and active in training.
- ☐ C. They are more likely to use new technology in training.
- ☐ D. They go off much slower at the start of the match.

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Questions 17-18 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about selfies. Answer the questions according to the text.



Why do we take selfies in the first place?

Experts say that the behavior can be rooted in a form of ____17____ that's directly connected to the human ego.

"We all have an ego. We all need recognition from peers and when people take selfies, it's generally to fulfill the ego's need for recognition," Balick said. Although sometimes, people use selfies to get validation, which he calls a "low complexity version of recognition."

"Validation is like a pat on the back. It's like a 'well done' or a 'you're pretty' or 'you're smart.' It's a thumbs up. That's what really gets you in trouble when you need recognition but you seek validation."

One of the motivations for posting images online centers around presenting positive versions of ourselves to the outside world, says Erin Vogel, Ph.D., a post-doctoral fellow in the dept. of psychiatry at the University of California, San Francisco.

"In real life, we can't undo things and make ourselves look the way we want to look, but online we can spend a lot of time constructing that."

A study by Janarthanan Balakrishnan of Thiagarajar School of Management, India and Mark Griffiths from Nottingham Trent University in the UK sought to develop a scale to measure what drives people to take selfies.

The researchers broke the motivations down into the following categories:

- Attention seeking—taking and posting selfies to feel more popular.
- Mood modification—has been described by Griffiths (2005) as an experience that makes someone feel better and is part of what defines addiction.
- Self-confidence—taking selfies may increase the self-confidence of those who engage in this behavior.
- Social competition—posting selfies to get likes on social media or taking selfies to increase one's social status.
- Subjective conformity—referring to an individual's tendency to copy what others do.
- Environmental enhancement—taking selfies to create memories or trophies of oneself.

17. Which of the following words best fits in the blank in the text?

- ☐ A. narcissism
- ☐ B. vanity
- ☐ C. cynicism
- ☐ D. nostalgia

18. Which of the following is NOT a reason for taking selfies according to the text?

- ☐ A. Crowd mentality.
- ☐ B. Social approval.
- ☐ C. Confidence enhancement.
- ☐ D. Reality distortion.

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Questions 19-20 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text on weight. Answer the questions according to the text.

Two annual occasions cause the quickest weight gain in the shortest period of time, write the authors of a new study: vacations and the holidays (in this case, the stretch between Thanksgiving and New Year's Day). During that last stretch of time, when parties dominate and early morning workouts take a backseat, the most weight is gained.

In an attempt to find an intervention, a team led by the University of Georgia's Sepideh Kaviani, tried a novel approach: Have volunteers weigh themselves daily (daily self-weighing, or DSW). They wanted to know if visual graphical feedback (GF) would make a difference in the amount of weight they put on and retain.

One hundred and eleven volunteers showed up for three sessions, one before Thanksgiving, one after New Year's Day, and a final visit 14 weeks into 2018. One group was instructed to partake in DSW using GF as a guide; the other group was given no instructions at all.

The team points to previous research that confirms that DSW produces clinically significant weight loss in general as well as during the first year of college. It is believed that a graphical representation of weight fluctuations encourages people to take in less energy (calories) while expending more (exercise) in an attempt to lose or maintain weight. Indeed, that is what Kaviani and her team report. Second author of the paper, University of Georgia associate professor Michelle vanDellen, comments that the GF is invaluable to those concerned with tracking improvement:

"People are really sensitive to discrepancies or differences between their current selves and their standard or goal. When they see that discrepancy, it tends to lead to behavioral change. Daily self-weighing ends up doing that for people in a really clear way."

The study, published in the journal *Obesity*, found that members of the control group gained weight during the holidays, while the active group either maintained or lost weight during the same period. In the control group, both men and women gained weight, but during the follow-up session men were generally able to shed those pounds while women were not. The only clinically significant weight gain between visits one and three was noted in women in the control group.

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19. Decide whether the following statement is True or False according to the text.

The team has done two separated researches in a year that lead to the same conclusion: daily self-weighing is helpful for weight control.

- ☐ A. True
- ☐ B. False

20. What can be inferred from the study according to the last paragraph?

- ☐ A. The study has significant influence on people's way of living.
- ☒ B. Women seem to be more likely to gain weight during holidays.
- ☐ C. It seems easier for men to lose the weight gained in holidays.
- ☐ D. DSW and GF are effective to both men and women.

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Questions 21-23 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about "we-media". Answer the questions according to the text.

The boom in social Internet use has created a new climate of participatory media, which some have labeled the "we-media" age. We-media is about individuals or enterprises using the Internet to send information to specific individuals or non-specific groups. We-media platforms include blogs, Weibo, WeChat and public forums. As to Wu Wei (CEO of *InRice.com*), this means everyone has become a reporter. Consumer information circulates increasingly fast and becomes more transparent. Comments about products, good or bad, spread quickly within circles of friends, changing the way consumers obtain information and shortening the decision-making process for shopping.

Explaining how this phenomenon is helping businesses and consumers deal with today's changing circumstances, Wu said: "In the past we all used the mass media and TV and newspaper advertising to publicise our products. Now, with the rise of Weibo, WeChat and other social media, more information channels are available, but we find it much more difficult to choose than before. When we shop online, there are so many products of the same kind to choose from, with different prices and different reviews. How do we choose? It is at times like this that circles of friends in social media show their strength, because people tend to trust people they know. Recommendations by friends are more trustworthy."

Wu's view is that the rise of "we-media" has reduced the distance between companies and consumers. Pointing out that companies can now use IP-marketing* and personalised brands to help establish brand preference and loyalty and attract a greater following, he said: "In the past, promoting brands through traditional media created a sense of distance. People heard about certain brands but were unable to have direct contact with them. With 'we-media', consumers can have a direct dialogue with the brands and even talk personally to the brand founders or CEOs. There is less distance between the consumer and the company and this helps to improve communication."

Wu noted that another important development is the rise of what are known as Key Opinion Leaders, or KOLs—consumers with a strong social media presence and the ability to create and influence conversations about products. Many KOLs have attracted large and loyal followings, and by making use of WeChat stores, applets and other tools, they are able to shorten consumers' decision-making processes and encourage transactions. Wu said: "Followers of KOLs will have faith in the products pushed by these influencers because they trust them. Fans will become a formidable force as more KOLs engage in brand promotion and product sales."

Pointing to several well-known examples where KOL marketing has paid off, Wu added: "Success stories include financial writer Wu Xiaobo selling his own brand of 'Wu Wine', fashion blogger Becky Li selling cars in her blog, and Chu Shijian setting up the company Chu Orange to sell oranges."

***Note:** IP is the abbreviation of intellectual property, but IP as used today also refers to movies, television, literature, games, animation and other resources suitable for secondary or multiple adaptation.

21-22. Decide whether the following statements are True or False according to the text.

21. Both businesses and consumers are faced with the problem of making choices in the era of "we-media".

- ☐ A. True
☐ B. False

22. It can be inferred from the text that "we-media" has already become a starting point for many entrepreneurs.

- ☐ A. True
☐ B. False

23. Which of the following would be the best title for the text?

- ☐ A. The Evolution of "We-media" in China
☐ B. How "We-media" Is Changing the Market
☐ C. The Distinctive Features of "We-media"
☐ D. The Advantages of "We-media" over Traditional Media

Questions 24-25 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about sound. Answer the questions according to the text.

Do you hear what I hear? More than just a memorable holiday song, it's a question that got the nation talking — talking about Yanny vs. Laurel.

Shortly after a viral audio recording left people wondering why some heard “Yanny” and others clearly heard “Laurel,” we learned that what you heard has less to do with your auditory system and more to do with the brain.

And the saga continues: A new Northwestern University study has found that bilingual and monolingual people listening to the same person speaking can hear two completely different sounds. The research shows that one's language experience affects even the most basic cognitive processes, according to Viorica Marian, a professor of communication sciences and disorders and psychology at Northwestern University.

“With Yanny and Laurel, our brain interprets the sound differently depending on how the neurons fire in our brain and based on the history of our linguistic experiences,” Marian said. “We classify the sound waves that come into our ear into linguistic categories that we are familiar with, so we hear a very categorical sound — what happens is the brain interprets the input that comes to us from our senses and transforms it into our perceived reality.”

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Your previous auditory and linguistic experience influences how you perceive the sound around you — the world around you — she said. Case in point: If you find accents easy to understand, you may have taken music lessons at some point in your life. Marian said learning the language of music can change the way your brain processes sound.

And if you thought Yanny and Laurel were perplexing, scope out the McGurk effect — wherein what you see affects what you hear. For example, when people hear a speech sound (e.g. “ba”) that conflicts with what they see (e.g. “ga”), they will often perceive a completely different sound (e.g. “da”).

The NU study found that bilinguals are more likely to experience the McGurk effect than monolinguals, because their exposure to another language allows their brain to interpret auditory and visual modalities differently.

“I think that’s maybe why the Yanny and Laurel thing is so fascinating to people because it’s the same sound, but people hear it so differently, and it’s an illustration of what happens in every aspect of our lives without even realizing it,” Marian said.

The Yanny/Laurel uproar began after the release of Marian’s study, but she said it and the bilingual/McGurk effect cases are mutually informative.

“We don’t see with our eyes, we don’t hear with our ears — we perceive with our brain. Our brain interprets the reality of our own lives,” Marian said. “The brain takes the input from the ears, takes the input from the eyes and combines them in an interesting way. It’s fascinating.”

24. What may lead to the Yanny and Laurel phenomenon?

- ☐ A. Your musical talent.
- ☐ B. Your brain structure.
- ☐ C. Your auditory system.
- ☐ D. Your linguistic experience.

25. Why does the writer mention the McGurk effect?

- ☐ A. It has also aroused people’s extensive concern.
- ☐ B. It is also a confusing perceptual phenomenon.
- ☐ C. It has a mechanism similar to Yanny and Laurel.
- ☐ D. It is intimately associated with Yanny and Laurel.

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Questions 26-28 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about high heels. Answer the questions according to the text.



High heels have long been seen as a female equivalent to the businessman's necktie. They're a sartorial accessory that, when worn in a business setting, sends a message of formality and professionalism. Nowhere has this been more true than in the highly gendered corporate culture of Japan, but the association is global. From Sheryl Sandberg to Theresa May, high heels have been a key component of female power-dressing for decades. John T Molloy's bestselling *Dress for Success* books of the 1970s cautioned American women never to go without their precious high-heeled pumps if they wanted to be taken seriously in the workplace.

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Some may not see why this would be a problem. After all, plenty of women not only choose to wear high heels, but passionately defend that choice. The word “empowerment” may even make an appearance. And besides, if men are often required to wear a jacket and tie, what’s wrong with a female equivalent?

But no item of men’s clothing causes such hampered movement or physical pain. Indeed, high heels fit into a long history of women’s physical repression and mandated suffering.

High heels have changed dramatically since they made their debut, on the feet of 16th-century Persian cavalymen, before migrating west to the European armies and royal courts. While high-heeled shoes were standard fare for both men and women in Europe throughout the 18th century, they took a tumble with the arrival of the French revolution. After Marie Antoinette was guillotined in a pair of high heels, the style fell out of fashion. Shoes went flat, and silhouettes slimmed down. When high heels returned to the feet of the fashionable, a curious gender divide began to widen: by the 20th century, as women gained more freedom, high heels were thought of as “women’s shoes” exclusively (with a brief glam rock interlude in the 1970s). They also became higher, thinner and harder to walk in than ever before.

If wearing high heels in the workplace was just about increasing height, more people would wear platforms. Men, who also experience professional benefits from seeming taller, would wear them too. But they do not, because high heels are a way to communicate femininity. They were considered such a vital part of women’s professional dress in the 1970s and 1980s precisely because the very act of working, having a job and seeking success and power was seen as inherently masculine. The high heels were a necessary counterpoint to the manly notions of ambition and wanting to control your own financial destiny.

Rather than reconfiguring the workplace to welcome women, societies across the globe have consistently focused on reconfiguring women to fit into a workplace that wasn’t built for them. Magazine articles and advertising still focus on what women should do, say, wear and buy to be worthy of professional respect. Even terms such as “women’s empowerment” and “lean in” place the emphasis on women needing to find, do or become something rather than the need to restructure a system that routinely hurts them.

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26. From what perspective does the author discuss wearing high heels in the workplace in the text?

- ☒ A. Fashion.
- ☐ B. Professionalism.
- ☐ C. Feminism.
- ☐ D. Etiquette.

27-28. Decide whether the statements are True, False or Not Given according to the text.

27. Women have long believed that high heels physically repressed themselves and put their health at risk.

- ☐ A. True
- ☐ B. False
- ☐ C. Not Given

28. The author calls for an end to requiring women to wear high heels at work.

- ☐ A. True
- ☐ B. False
- ☐ C. Not Given

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Questions 29-30 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about names. Answer the questions according to the text.

“Give me your tired, your poor, your huddled masses yearning to breathe free,” reads the poem on the Statue of Liberty. Censuses show that America’s 19th-century immigrants were poor. No data exist on whether they also yearned for freedom. But new studies use a proxy for individualism—first names—to suggest that they did.

Academics can learn a lot about society from names. The persistence of privileged surnames in prized jobs reveals the slow pace of social mobility. And studies show that American firms tend to reject fake job applications that use typical black names.

In the 1800s Nordic countries tracked the names of the 25% of their population that moved to America. A recent paper by Anne Sofie Beck Knudsen of Lund University found that, among people of similar backgrounds, emigrants were less likely than people who stayed put to have one of their country’s ten most common names.

That matters, since people with rare names tend to be individualists—perhaps because their parents want them to stand out. In one paper, students with unique names among their classmates had higher non-conformity scores (counted by things like “a desire to not always follow rules”). And countries with diverse names rank highly on the Hofstede individualism survey, which asks if people care more about personal success or their communities.

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If Nordic emigrants were unusually individualistic, that may have affected politics. In the 1860s frosts ruined Swedish harvests. This set off emigration in areas near seaports. Mounir Karadja and Erik Prawitz, two economists, have found that unions and left-wing parties grew faster in these regions than in similar parts of Sweden (including port towns that avoided frosts).

The authors write that the option to emigrate emboldened workers to join unions, who backed leftist parties. But emigrants' rare names imply another possible explanation: an exodus of individualists left behind people friendly to collectivism.

American data bolster **this story**. Nordic immigrants with rare names were most likely to marry foreigners and learn English. Mesay Gebresilasse, Martin Fiszbein and Samuel Bazzi of Boston University find that the western frontier was full of people with rare names. Today, poll respondents in such places dislike taxes more than others in their state of the same sex, age and race do. The frontier spirit lives on.

29. What can be learned about rare names according to the text?

- ☐ A. The 1800s Nordic emigrants were more likely to have rare names than their countrymen.
- ☐ B. Job applicants are more likely to be rejected for their rare names.
- ☐ C. Rare names indicate the longing for freedom of America's 19th-century immigrants.
- ☐ D. Students with rare names are more likely to stand out in academics.

30. What does **this story** in the last paragraph refer to?

- ☐ A. Nordic immigrants' great friendliness.
- ☐ B. Nordic immigrants' collectivism.
- ☐ C. Nordic immigrants' left-wing tendency.
- ☐ D. Nordic immigrants' individualism.

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Questions 31-40 (Suggested completion time: 35 minutes)

Directions: Read two passages about signature. Answer the questions according to the passages.

Passage A

The checkout lanes at your favorite stores should soon move more quickly, thanks to an industry move away from signing for purchases.

Major credit card companies, Mastercard, Visa, American Express and Discover, are eliminating the need for shoppers to sign receipts for credit and debit sales beginning April 14, 2018.

That means most merchants in the U.S. or Canada can decide ____ 31 _____. Some merchants have already ditched signatures for some purchases, but the credit card companies are collectively ending requirements for customers' autographs.

Mastercard was the first major credit card to announce plans to end signatures. Its own research found that "merchants and consumers would like to see the payment process streamlined and that a majority of people believe it would be easier to pay and checkout lines would move faster if they didn't sign when making purchases," said Linda Kirkpatrick, executive vice president of MasterCard's U.S. market development division.

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Currently, customers are only required to sign for Mastercard purchases of more than \$50. As a result, more than 80% of Mastercard's store transactions in North America already do not require a signature, Kirkpatrick says.

"You may have noticed that you won't have to sign when buying a cup of coffee or a train ticket, but will have to sign when buying a new pair of sneakers," she said. "With the advent of new security, we can create a more consistent shopping experience that excludes signature."

The encryption within the EMV (short for Europay, MasterCard and Visa) chip, which began rolling out three years ago, has helped buttress robust security, as have other steps taken by credit card companies and the underlying payment networks in which banks participate in.

Within weeks of Mastercard's announced plans last year, Discover, American Express and Visa also got on board to end the requirement of a signature. Visa will require merchants to either have EMV chip or contactless chip-enabled readers to opt out of signatures.

Visa has not required signatures for sales below \$25 for most merchants and below \$50 for many sales. Similarly, American Express last year eliminated signatures for sales under \$50 in the U.S., the company said in December, 2018.



Fewer receipts to sign will affect many because customers overwhelmingly prefer plastic when paying for purchases. Debit cards were preferred by 44% of 1,200 customers surveyed in the 2017 U.S. Consumer Payment Study released by global payment provider TSYS. One-third (33%) of consumers preferred credit cards and 12% preferred cash, the survey found.

“Eliminating the signing of receipts will make the checkout process more efficient not only for shoppers, but also for retailers”, says Laura Townsend, senior vice president of operations for the Merchant Advisory Group, which supports the industry move.

Payment networks have required merchants collect signatures to refute possible sales disputes. “Our fraud capabilities have advanced so that signatures are no longer necessary to fight fraud,” said Molly Faust, vice president of public affairs for global merchant and network services at American Express. “Amex, which is eliminating signatures globally, deploys advanced machine learning algorithms that allow for more precise detection of fraud while minimizing disruption of Card Members’ genuine spending,” she said.

Not all merchants will quit requiring signatures overnight, but most will move toward that, Townsend says. “For some merchants, it’s almost like the flip of a switch. Other merchants will have to do more development than that,” she said.



Other outlets such as rental car companies and restaurants may continue to require signatures. “If you think about a sit-down restaurant, they may go ahead and give the receipt to the customer anyway to get a tip. So from an operational standpoint, they probably won’t change,” Townsend said.

As credit card companies continue to deploy higher-tech payment solutions — such as contactless pay and biometric payments using fingerprints and facial recognition — more shoppers may soon not even need to insert a card into a card reader to pay.

“We believe multi-factor authentication is critical and signature has never been enabling that,” Townsend said. “Whether it’s a PIN or some other biometric that is where the industry needs to go. This is at least step one moving us in the right direction to a better, less fraud-prone system.”

Passage B

When I heard that most credit card transactions soon won’t require a signature, I was reminded of an experiment I once conducted. Curious to see if I would recognize their handwriting, I asked four friends to send me a postcard, each with the same greeting: “Having a wonderful time. Wish you were here.”

My guinea pigs included a real estate agent, an architect, a fellow journalist and a movie star. My score? A big old zero: I couldn’t identify a single one.

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Handwriting, once one of the most instantly identifiable elements of an individual, seems to have been lost to the ages, trampled into dust under the relentless advance of keyboards, touch screens and voice recognition software. Now the signature — the crown jewel of penmanship — is headed for the same ash heap. With the stroke of a virtual pen, American Express, Discover, Mastercard and Visa pronounced that even our laziest scrawling **John Hancocks** are no longer needed.

Am I surprised? Not one iota.

After all, Americans now send millions of holiday e-cards, and birthday greetings arrive mostly via Facebook. Emails have largely replaced personal letters. Even that marathon of document signing, the house closing, has moved on: When I bought a home last year, I never once put pen to paper. I used DocuSign, which creates a valid legal “signature.” DocuSign’s website trumpets its benefits: “Sign documents anywhere from any device”; “No overnighting, faxing or waiting”; and, of course: “More secure than paper.” (Not so much on that last one — in May 2017, DocuSign admitted that a database of customer email addresses had been breached in a phishing campaign, which is the act of attempting to acquire information such as usernames, passwords, and credit card details and sometimes, indirectly, money by masquerading as a trustworthy entity in an electronic communication.



Even in an age of dizzying change, this one feels like a real loss. It's been a long time since I actually signed my name to a check, which I used to do with a sense of pomp and circumstance, always careful to make the "t" in "Steven" parallel to the one in "Petrow," always placing an emphatic period after the "w" in my last name, my old-school form of encryption. Each signature was an original creation. Although I'm pleased by how quickly I can pay my bills now, every time I open the bank app on my phone I feel my identity eroding, replaced by routing and account numbers.

Some years ago I decided to organize a lifetime's worth of papers, which included handwritten notes, letters and postcards from my parents, my first girlfriend as well as some famous folks, including Senator Joe Biden, Mayor John V. Lindsay of New York and the tennis champ Billie Jean King. Each of them had its creator's unique signature.

I particularly treasure the letters from my maternal grandmother. At the upper left of each envelope she would write out her name, Marjorie L. Straus, in classic cursive. Even before I could read I knew those curves and curlicues equaled my grandma. The dozens of cards and notes from her are all signed exactly the same way, "Love, Grandma." The "L" and the "G" were original to her hand. I would have known her signature anywhere, and when I see it today I'm reminded of so much more: Her hair. Her perfume. How we watched "The Mary Tyler Moore Show" together on Saturdays. Her nightly Scotch and soda (which she always let me sip).

Grandma died in 1973; she lives on eternally through her penmanship.

According to one Mastercard executive, "The signature has really outrun its useful life." Granted, technological advances long ago made our scrawls obsolete as a protector of personal security. But not for a moment do I believe the signature has no life left in it.

To credit card companies, a chip is about to become my identity, with no signature necessary. Bit by byte, our identities get erased, and along with them our humanity. But I'll treasure my papers, and my signature.



31. Which of the following best fits in the blank in Passage A?

- ☐ A. when signatures on receipts are required in terms of modern payments
- ☐ B. what kind of payment they would like their customers to choose
- ☐ C. whether or not to require signatures on sales using cards
- ☐ D. whether or not to accept signatures on receipts for customers' purchases

32. Which of the following is NOT a reason that Mastercard is eliminating signatures according to Passage A?

- ☐ A. Many consumers don't like signing receipts.
- ☒ B. Signatures are not so important in fighting fraud now.
- ☐ C. Most Mastercard's transactions are below \$50.
- ☐ D. The EMV chip has helped strengthen security.

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33. Which description is correct about American companies in Passage A?

- ☐ A. More than 80% of Mastercard's store transactions already do not require signatures.
- ☐ B. Mastercard was the first major credit card to launch and terminate plans to end signatures.
- ☐ C. American Express has cancelled signatures for sales below \$50.
- ☐ D. Visa allows merchants holding EMV chip or contactless chip-enabled readers to give up signing receipts.

34. It can be inferred from Laura Townsend's words in the last paragraph of Passage A that _____.

- ☐ A. most merchants welcome the elimination of signing receipts
- ☐ B. signing on receipts is no longer an efficient and effective payment solution now
- ☐ C. some outlets won't change because the process of signing brings extra benefits
- ☐ D. the development of higher-tech payment solutions leads to a better paying system

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35. The experiment conducted by the writer of Passage B shows that _____.

- ☐ A. the development of computer technology leads to the extinction of handwriting
- ☐ B. the writer is curious to figure out if signatures can help identify individuals
- ☐ C. handwriting might not be an identifiable factor of different people anymore
- ☐ D. human's ability to create distinctive handwriting is gradually dying out

36. In Passage B, the underlined words ***John Hancocks*** refer to _____.

- ☐ A. the writer's name
- ☐ B. poor handwriting
- ☐ C. individuals' autographs
- ☐ D. a style of a set of letters

37. According to Passage B, the writer feels there is a real loss because _____.

- ☐ A. users' personal information has leaked
- ☐ B. he hasn't signed his name for a long time
- ☐ C. DocuSign is actually not so secure as paper
- ☐ D. the tradition of signature is fading away

38. Which of the following is TRUE according to Passage B?

- ☐ A. The handwriting from the writer's grandma records his important memories.
- ☐ B. The writer has the habit of collecting papers with lots of signatures.
- ☐ C. The writer generally holds an optimistic attitude towards the elimination of signatures.
- ☐ D. The signature of individuals acted as a protector of personal security long ago.

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39. What has been admitted in both Passage A and Passage B?

- ☐ A. Different people create different signatures to be identifiable to others.
- ☐ B. Major credit card companies in the world will no longer require signatures on receipts.
- ☐ C. Most merchants and shoppers are pleased with the efficiency of the new payment solution.
- ☐ D. Signatures are disappearing in purchasing due to technological developments.

40. Which of the following is TRUE concerning the two passages?

- ☐ A. Passage A might be a comment from a financial magazine.
- ☐ B. Passage B demonstrates that the writer decides not to change the way of payment.
- ☐ C. Passage A implies the writer's approval of the new payment solution.
- ☐ D. Passage B is a subjective writing about personal feelings.

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2019 阅读大赛初赛 2

Directions: In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)

Questions 1-3 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the following quotes. Match the quotes with the people. Please note there are two extra options you do not need.

- A. Somerset Maugham

B. Charles Dickens

C. Thomas Hardy

D. Mark Twain

E. Thomas Huxley

1. 1

"Classic." A book which people praise and don't read.

2. 2

People ask you for criticism, but they only want praise.

3. 3

Every great advance in natural knowledge has involved the absolute rejection of authority.

Directions: In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)

Question 4 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

A man's happiness is tied to whether he can beat his parents' academic achievements, according to a new study.

While women were not significantly affected if they failed to better their parents' educational successes, men who missed the mark suffered comparably to if they had experienced a divorce, researchers at Oxford University found.

The experts at the university's Department of Social Policy and Intervention delved into the data of over 50,000 people across 27 European countries and Israel to investigate how academic prowess affects a person's psychological well-being, *The Times* reported.

4. Which of the following is correct according to the text?

- ☐ A. People in many European countries and Israel were involved in the study.

☐ B. *The Times* supported the study of how parents' academic success affects children's well-being.

☐ C. Men suffered more than women from parents' divorce.

☐ D. Men's happiness equals women's when their parents were educationally successful.

Directions: In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)

Question 5 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Andy was working as a digital designer when he was approached by a company wanting to recruit him as an interface designer. The role was a step down in seniority, but a step up in pay and would open doors to future prospects, so Andy accepted the role. Once on the job, however, he found himself with little work, but **berated** by his manager for completing the work so quickly, and constantly reminded he was paid a higher salary than others in the team.

5. What does the word **berated** probably mean?

- ☐ A. criticized
- ☐ B. promoted
- ☐ C. complimented
- ☐ D. bewildered

Directions: In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)

Question 6 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.



For those who craved Starbucks Unicorn Frappuccino or still dream about the Crystal Ball Frappuccino, the coffee giant just drizzled some bad news into your otherwise sugar-sweet, colorful life.

Don't expect as many of those wacky concoctions next year.

The coffee chain announced on April 26 that it's cutting its limited-time offers by 30%.

However, the company said new frappuccinos are launching in early May. No word on what they'll be, though rumors point to dark caramel. Also, it's unclear if they're temporary or permanent additions to the menu.

6. What did Starbucks decide to do?

- ☐ A. To add dark caramel to its menu.
- ☐ B. To launch Unicorn Frappuccino in April.
- ☐ C. To have less temporary fancy drinks.
- ☐ D. To put its former offers back on market.

Directions: *In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)*

Question 7 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

There's a simple formula for learning a language that goes like this: input + practice = language acquisition. Very basically, "input" refers to the things you read, watch or listen to in English. And "practice" refers to what you do when you speak or write in English. It's that simple! It's what children do when they learn their first language. They're exposed to language, they practice it and then they learn it... without making any conscious effort to study. We provide you with all the valuable language input you need. And best of all, the language has been carefully selected to provide you with the most useful words and expressions.

7. What type of text is it?

- ☐ A. A book recommendation
- ☐ B. A piece of advice for grammar
- ☐ C. A notice on a learning platform
- ☐ D. A selective course introduction

Directions: *In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)*

Question 8 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Studying female birdsong is no simple task. Here's Karan Odom (Cornell behavioral ecologist): "So the biggest thing is to see the bird, which is number one not trivial. And number two, in the past since birdsong has been thought of as a male trait, it might not be that researchers were always verifying the sex of the bird by finding it and looking at it. So we're asking people to be aware that females sing and to actually get a look at the bird that you're recording."

These researchers hope that more awareness of female song will lead to better-informed studies that can tell us when and why female birds are singing. And perhaps reveal aspects of avian life that no one has yet considered.

8. What is the main purpose of the research into female birdsong?

- ☐ A. They want to help people know that female birds do sing.
- ☐ B. They want to make people aware of the difficulties in studying female birdsong.
- ☐ C. They want to have a more in-depth knowledge of female birdsong.
- ☐ D. They want to prove wrong the idea of birdsong as a male trait.

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Directions: In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)

Question 9 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

One thing to remember in our age of instant gratification is that friends aren't found; instead, friends are made — crafted, really — over time. It takes 6 to 8 conversations before someone considers us a friend. We wish we could walk into a party, instantly connect, and walk out arm-in-arm with a new BFF (Best Friend Forever), but really it's an incremental process. The good news is that the bar to start is low. It's been shown again and again that, as long as we are mutually kind to each other, we become friends with whoever we see most often. Proximity and repetition are key. So put yourself in situations where you see the same faces again and again: a dog park at the same time each morning, a weekly writer's workshop, or a co-working space.

9. What factor is essential to friend-making according to the text?

- ☐ A. Instant connection.
- ☐ B. Face-to-face communication.
- ☐ C. Frequent contact.
- ☐ D. Mutual affection.

Question 10 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: The two figures show the sales growth by sector of the UK in April 2019. Answer the question according to the information in the figures.

Figure 1: April 2019 compared with March 2019

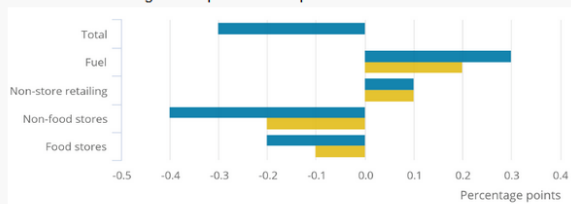
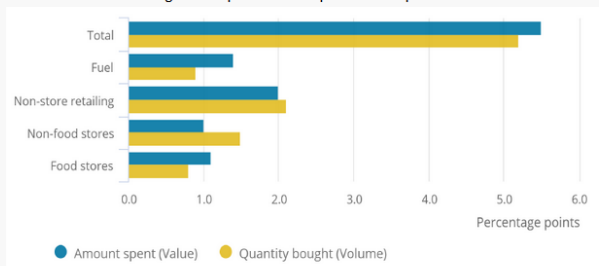


Figure 2: April 2019 compared with April 2018



10. Which of the following is an INCORRECT description of the figures?

- ☐ A. Non-food stores were the largest negative contributor to the year-on-year growth, with the least amount spent and the quantity bought.
- ☐ B. Fuel was the largest positive contributor to the monthly growth of both the amount spent and the quantity bought.
- ☐ C. Non-store retailing provided the largest contribution to the year-on-year growth, with the amount spent and the quantity bought both increasing by around 2%.
- ☐ D. Figure 1 shows the contribution by sector to month-on-month growth, with the overall amount spent dropping and the quantity bought remaining flat.

Questions 11 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the definition of the following logical fallacy. Answer the question according to the definition.

Begging the Question occurs when an argument's premises assume the truth of the conclusion, instead of supporting it. In other words, you assume without proof the stand/position, or a significant part of the stand, that is in question. It is also called "circular reasoning".

11. Which of the following is a typical example of *Begging the Question*?

- ☐ A. If cheap things are no good then this cheap watch is no good. But this watch is actually quite good. So some good things are cheap.
- ☐ B. Smoking causes cancer because my father was a smoker and he died of lung cancer.
- ☐ C. People who buy stocks are no different from people who bet on horse racing. They both risk their money with little chance of making a big profit.
- ☐ D. Happiness is the highest good for a human being, since all other values are inferior to it.

Questions 12 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the definition of the following logical fallacy. Answer the question according to the definition.

Two Wrongs Make a Right is a fallacy in which someone argues that a course of action is justified because the other person has done the same or would do the same if given a chance.

12. Which of the following provides a typical example of *Two Wrongs Make a Right*?

- ☐ A. Organs are living components in a body. Fetuses are living and in a body. Therefore, fetuses are equivalent to organs.
- ☐ B. Gravity makes things fall. The apple that hit my head was due to gravity.
- ☐ C. Bill has borrowed Jane's expensive pen, but found he didn't return it. He tells himself that it is okay to keep it, since she would have taken his.
- ☐ D. That building is in terrible shape. Either we tear it down or someone will surely die.

Questions 13-14 Reasoning (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

13.

Lily: Everyone is so beautifully dressed at the Christmas party that it's no easy task to stand out from the crowd, but you can still turn some heads with the help of the right dress, jewelry and shoes.

Which of the following would Lily most agree with?

- ☐ A. Grace: The right outfit is useless unless you carry it off well.
- ☐ B. Lucy: One outstanding necklace is enough rather than being different in every aspect.
- ☐ C. Tracy: The most important thing is the makeup.
- ☐ D. Jim: Parties are for enjoyment and no one bothers about how others look.

14.

States of depression do not just happen. There is a clear co-relation between nutritional deficiencies and mental health. Depression is actually one of the early signs of nutritional depletion. Diseases begin when the body begins to get imbalanced. The imbalances can be identified and corrected with proper food, herbs and vitamins. Besides oxygen, clean water, we need proper food that nourishes our body and brains.

What message does the author want to convey?

- ☐ A. People who suffer from depression should seek advice from a nutritionist.
- ☐ B. Right food can prevent people from mental illnesses.
- ☐ C. Nutritional deficiencies lead to mental imbalance.
- ☐ D. One can cure diseases by eating the correct food.

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Questions 15-16 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

People who have a sense of purpose in life appear to live longer, according to the latest research linking this outlook to a person's quality of life and to better physical and mental health.

The authors of the study published in the journal *JAMA Network Open* looked at data collected from 6,985 adults who were signed up to the Health and Retirement Study. These people were at the age of 50 and above in the U.S. The team looked at a group who completed a questionnaire in 2006 about their purpose in life, and used it to come up with a score. On average, the participants were 68.6 years old. Next, the scientists looked at causes of death in the group between 2006 and 2010. Variables included their demographic, marital status, race and education level. Lifestyle choices like smoking and drinking were also noted.

Purpose was defined by the authors as a self-organizing life aim that stimulates goals, promotes healthy behaviors and gives meaning to life.

The data revealed that the stronger the participants felt they had a purpose in life, the lower their risk of dying. This result remained even when the scientists adjusted their calculations for factors that could affect their score, such as a participants' sociodemographic status and their health.

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But scientists don't know why there seems to be a link between purposefulness and the length of life. One explanation is that the attitude and overall well-being could prevent genes linked with inflammation from being expressed in the body. Meanwhile, lacking a purpose could dampen a person's motivation to be healthy and active, the authors suggested.

Study co-author Celeste Leigh Pearce, Associate Professor in the Department of Epidemiology at the University of Michigan School of Public Health, told *Newsweek*: "The association between life purpose and health outcomes is becoming increasingly clear."

"Life purpose may be derived from family, community, work, religion or other domains, and so it is accessible to everyone," Celeste said. "Our view is that life purpose can change over time. There is research to suggest that activities such as volunteering may have a positive impact on life purpose. There are eHealth applications that have been designed to help users define and strive toward increasing their life purpose. We are studying an eHealth application to determine whether it can help increase life purpose and quality of life among cancer survivors."

15. Which of the following statements is indicated in the text?

- ☐ A. People who enjoy longevity may lead a purposeful life.
- ☒ B. The definition of life purpose varies from person to person.
- ☐ C. The recent study confirms the link between the sense of life purpose and the lifespan.
- ☐ D. If one person often engages in meaningful activities, his or her sense of life purpose may increase.

16. What might be a reason of the link between purposefulness and the length of life in the study?

- ☐ A. Purposefulness could prevent viruses from spreading in the body.
- ☐ B. The calculations for variables combined to affect the result.
- ☐ C. EHealth applications helped promote life purpose and quality of life.
- ☐ D. Lacking a purpose could restrain a person's motivation to be healthy and active.

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Questions 17-18 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: Read the introduction to the Beinecke Rare Book & Manuscript Library. Answer the questions according to the text.

The Beinecke Rare Book & Manuscript Library inspires engagement with the past, in the present, for the future. One of the world's largest libraries devoted entirely to rare books and manuscripts, it is Yale University's principal repository of literary archives, early manuscripts, and rare books.

Designed by Gordon Bunshaft of the architecture firm Skidmore, Owings & Merrill, the Beinecke Library opened in October 1963, after three years of construction. The library was the gift of three Yale alumni—Edwin J. Beinecke, 1907; Frederick W. Beinecke, 1909; Walter Beinecke, 1910—and their families. As noted by words that greet visitors entering the library, they gave it to “stand as a symbol of the loyalty and devotion of three brothers and serve as a source of learning and as an inspiration to all who enter.”

The innovative design includes a six-story glass-enclosed tower of book stacks, holding approximately 180,000 volumes, inside a cube with large “windows” made of translucent Vermont marble panels, an inch and a quarter thick, in a granite frame. The exterior framework gestures to the golden ratio: Fifteen marble blocks run across the face of the building, five run vertically, and ten run along its depth, representing the ratio of 3:1:2. This is also a nod to the collections, as the pages of many early books and manuscripts are laid out in this proportion, considered pleasing to the eye and reverential to the text. The marble panels protect the collections from damaging direct sunlight while absorbing and reflecting the exterior light in warm hues on the interior.

The research level and most of the stacks are on two underground floors that extend beneath the plaza. Additional material from collections is housed in the university's Library Shelving Facility. The courtyard adjacent to the reading room features a sculpture garden by Isamu Noguchi in an assemblage with representations of the earth (pyramid), sun (circle), and chance (cube). The sculptor wrote of it that “It is nowhere, yet somehow familiar. Its size is fictive, of infinite space or cloistered containment.”

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17. Decide whether the following statement is True or False according to the text.

The Beinecke Rare Book & Manuscript Library, which was donated by Yale's former students in the early 20th century, is one of the largest libraries in the world.

- ☐ A. True
- ☐ B. False

18. What is the main function of the large marble panels used on the building?

- ☐ A. To prevent the sunlight.
- ☐ B. To inspire the readers.
- ☐ C. To strengthen the frame.
- ☐ D. To pay a special tribute.

Questions 19-22 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about gig economy. Answer the questions according to the text.

Gig economy is a temporary work system based on a short-term relationship between workers and companies. Workers perform "gigs," in which they are employed for a specific task or time. This is done to achieve advantage of cost, quality, and flexibility. Once the task is complete, the worker is free to move on. A McKinsey report says, 20-30 percent of the developed countries' workforce is today engaged in independent work.

Factors aiding the rise of the gig economy

Several factors contributed to the rise of the gig economy.

Firstly, most businesses started factoring cost into their competitive strategy after the Great Recession in 2007. As a result, companies combined different approaches — reducing the number of employees, improving operational efficiency, or both. They started to rationalise, among other things, **antiquated** workforce model and full-time employment. Progressively jobs that could be manned remotely were cut down and contracting on-demand workers gained ground.

Secondly, seasonal spikes in customer service across most businesses helped in the rise of the gig economy. A flexible workforce allows organisations to be more agile and plan for spikes and lows. It aided them to elevate business performance faster and effectively. In fact, 70 percent of employers say gig workers increase profitability and efficiency. All this led to the trend of hiring independent short-term workers, at short notice, for a short time instead of full-time employees.

Thirdly, technology played an important role in consolidating remote and mobile workforce, enabling rapid growth of the gig economy. Platforms enabling centralised communication, real-time scheduling and tracking, dashboard, video conferencing, etc. created a marketplace for gig like ecommerce did for goods.

21

The gig economy has benefited both companies and workers. With geography no more a barrier, companies can hire workers without fear of attrition (人员缩减). The gig system results in lower training overheads and savings in office costs. Globally, 43 percent of companies with gig workers save 20 percent in labour costs, per an industry survey. Author and Professor Diane Mulcahy says in her book *The Gig Economy* that hiring a full-time worker with benefits and protections can cost a company 30–40 percent more than gig workers.

For workers, the flexibility of the system works best. With 33 percent saying work-life balance is getting difficult, the gig system gives them personal time. It allows them to network and work better. They can quote their price on projects of their choice, and at a time and place of their choice.

But the system has its flip side. As companies forgo their traditional style, their strategic vision may become obscure. Companies struggle to retain their corporate culture, and staff lack in team spirit when workers are temporary. Shorn of in-house talent, they are always on the lookout for gig workers for new projects. Regular coordination among different workers or teams working in silos isn't easy. The gig system also calls for regular implementation of new technology platforms to manage churn (大量生产) faster. This can be time consuming and costly.

On the work front, workers should find their own gigs, which isn't easy unless you have an established relationship with a client. Geographic flexibility means you have competition from across the world, and competitors can dislodge you with lower bids.

22

The success of the gig economy is dictated by a region's culture as well. In the US or the EU, it's accepted more rationally than in Asian countries. In countries like India, for example, the traditional norms of work, propensity to stay anchored to stable jobs, fewer networking platforms, etc., have curtailed its rapid expansion.

But regardless of its current pace of adoption worldwide, gig economy is here to stay and strengthen, into the future. People like the flexibility of gigs, and technology has made it easier to connect them to the jobs. It has filtered well through white-collar professions such as in commerce, banking, the legal profession, etc. Even the labor-intensive business process management industry is increasingly turning to this kind of employment to perform critical jobs like customer service, manning both front- and back-office roles.

With more and more on-demand platforms emerging to support agile, responsive, cross-geography work models, it's a given that the future workforce will well and truly embrace it with open arms.

19. What does the word **antiquated** probably mean?

- ☐ A. innovative
- ☐ B. flexible
- ☐ C. outdated
- ☐ D. neglected

20. Which of the following is NOT the difficulty brought by gig economy to companies?

- ☐ A. The gig workers employed are lacking in team spirit.
- ☐ B. It's difficult to coordinate different workers or teams.
- ☐ C. It's difficult for companies to maintain their corporate culture.
- ☐ D. Business strategies become hard to be implemented on a regular base.

21-22. Which of the following subtitles best fit in the blanks in the text?

- A. Difficulties arise, and the outlook is dim
- B. Overall, advantages outweigh disadvantages
- C. The benefits are mutual, but so are the pitfalls
- D. As the gig economy changes work, so should the rules
- E. Obstacles abound, but that's where the road is headed

Questions 23-24 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.



(Scientists check the island for rodents. The last of the poisoned bait was dropped more than two years ago. Photograph: Oliver Prince/South Georgia Heritage Trust)

The world's biggest project to eradicate a dangerous invasive species has been declared a success, as the remote island of South Georgia (a British overseas territory in the southern Atlantic Ocean) is now clear of the rats and mice that had devastated its wildlife for nearly 250 years.

Rats and mice were inadvertently introduced to the island, off the southern tip of South America and close to Antarctica, by ships that stopped there, usually on whaling expeditions. The effect on native bird populations was dramatic. Unused to predators, they laid their eggs on the ground or in burrows, easily accessible to the rodents.

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Two species of birds unique to the island, the South Georgia pipit and pintail, were largely confined to a few tiny islands off the coast, which the rodents could not reach, and penguins and other seabird populations were also threatened.

Mike Richardson, the chair of the decade-long £10m project, said: “No rodents were discovered in the [final] survey. To the best of our knowledge, for the first time in two and a half centuries this island is rodent-free. It has been a long, long haul.”

The South Georgia programme involved dropping hundreds of tonnes of poisoned bait on areas known to be infested with rodents. The last of the poisoned bait was dropped more than two years ago, but scientists have spent the intervening period monitoring the island for rodents. Two experienced dog handlers from New Zealand walked three dogs — named Will, Ahu and Wai — across nearly 1,550 miles in often extreme weather, beset by heavy rain and often fierce storms, seeking out signs of rats and mice.

Only when none were found over the whole period and in every area was the project deemed a success according to international standards. **The leaders of the eradication effort declared the island free of rats and mice on May 9, 2018, and said the air resounded with the once-rare song of the native pipit.**

The project was led by the South Georgia Heritage Trust, a charity set up to protect the island, and an associate organisation, the US-based Friends of South Georgia Island. The UK government also played a role, but the bulk of the funding came from private fundraising and philanthropy.

Scientists hope the success could become an inspiration and model for other projects around the world to eliminate invasive species, which in the worst cases can drive native animals close to extinction.



23. What do we know about the project?

- ☐ A. Most of its funding came from the government and charities.
- ☐ B. It is a good example to protect animals on the edge of extinction.
- ☐ C. It has worked for two and a half centuries for its goal.
- ☐ D. Its aim is to wipe out rats and mice on the island of South Georgia.

24. Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the declaration in boldface?

- ☐ A. The project found a new native species that feeds on rats and mice.
- ☐ B. Ten million pounds isn't enough for the big project.
- ☐ C. The dog handlers cheated on the experiment, and traced rats on the island.
- ☐ D. There is a big drop in the population of the South Georgia pipit.

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Questions 25-26 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about freedivers. Decide whether the statements are True or False according to the text.

Humans breathe many times a minute. How can freedivers hold their breath for so long under the water?

Human body

The average person breathes about every four seconds, yet freedivers can hold their breath for 10+ minutes and so skip about 150 breaths. This makes heavy demands on the body, which must not only make do with very small quantities of oxygen, but also endure the lactic acid produced by the muscles as they work without oxygen. The mind is also very much put to the test, resisting the fear of drowning, and if the freediver does not relax, stress hormones will make his heart beat faster, quickly consuming the oxygen.

Apart from ordinary physical and mental training, freedivers simply practice holding their breath. They also rely on the body's natural reaction to slow the heart and adjust circulation when underwater—the so-called Diving Reflex.

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In one of the exercises, the diver holds his breath for one minute, as he is at rest. Subsequently, and still without breathing, he must walk as far as he can. After that, he takes a deep breath and gets his breathing under control. A few minutes later, he repeats the exercise. Immediately before a contest, the freediver makes a sequence of exercises that reduce metabolism, breathing, heartbeat, and the quantity of CO₂ in the blood. The exercises include alternately holding one's breath, taking deep breaths, and hyperventilating. The reason why the diver breathes faster than he usually does is not to absorb extra oxygen, rather to get rid of as much CO₂ as possible from the blood.

Reflex saves oxygen

As soon as the head is under water, a series of physiological processes known as the diving reflex begin. The processes prolong the period during which the body can survive without oxygen and involves heart rate reduction and blood vessel contraction, so the oxygen is concentrated in the organs.

Arms and legs are “excluded”

The blood vessels of arms, legs, and other non-vital body parts contract, so they do not consume oxygen. Instead, the blood and so the oxygen is directed to the important organs in chest and abdominal cavity.

25. Before holding their breath, freedivers breathe faster mainly to bring more oxygen to their muscles, which can reduce lactic acid.

- ☐ A. True
- ☐ B. False

26. In the diving reflex the body slows its heart rate in order to conserve oxygen for the key organs.

- ☐ A. True
- ☐ B. False

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Questions 27-28 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about “anti-vax” parents. Answer the questions according to the text.



Whenever I talk about my research on how parents come to decide to reject vaccines for their children, my explanations are met with a range of reactions, but I almost always hear the same questions.

What is wrong with those parents? Are they anti-science? Are they anti-expert? Are they simply ignorant or selfish? Are they crazy?

The year is not half over, and the number of measles cases has now exceeded highs not seen since the U.S. was declared measles-free in 2000. Given the indisputably large role unvaccinated individuals are playing in it, parents who reject vaccines are increasingly vilified. Some people call to have these parents arrested or punished. Many are asking states to tighten laws that make exemptions to school enrollment without vaccines too easy.

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Others dismiss these “Whole Foods moms” as harming others and call for them to be socially ostracized.

As a sociologist, I have spent most of a decade talking to parents, pediatricians, policymakers, lawyers and scientists to understand competing views of vaccines. In my research, I find that parents who reject vaccines—by which I mean mostly mothers—work hard to make what they see as an informed decision to do what they think is best for their children. They also want to make a decision that best aligns with their belief system.

Many “anti-vax” parents see themselves as experts on their own children, as best able to decide what their children need and whether their children need a particular vaccine, and better qualified than health experts or public health agencies to decide what is best for their family.

These decisions are inarguably not _____²⁸_____ the community and indisputably increase risk to others who may be the most vulnerable to the worst outcomes of infection. And although no one can predict how someone will respond to measles infection, children under age five and adults over 20 are most likely to suffer the most serious complications.

The parents who choose to reject vaccines introduce risk to many, including their own children and others. This makes it easy for many people to see them with contempt.

Yet, their decisions also provide an opportunity for all of us to consider how we all may make choices that align with our own goals, but risk the health, and lives, of those in our communities.

27. What is the author’s attitude towards “anti-vax” parents?

- ☐ A. Neutral.
- ☐ B. Indifferent.
- ☐ C. Supportive.
- ☐ D. Critical.

28. Which of the following expressions best fits in the blank?

- ☐ A. harmful for
- ☐ B. at the sacrifice of
- ☐ C. in the best interests of
- ☐ D. submitted to

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Questions 29-30 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

“They’re always polite, they always upsell, they never take a vacation, they never show up late, there’s never a slip-and-fall, or an age, sex, or race discrimination case,” said Andrew Puzder, the chief executive of Hardee’s Food Systems Inc., a restaurant chain headquartered in Tennessee. He was talking about swapping employees for machines. Statements like these give workers reason to worry.

The advent of a jobless economy raises concern because tasks traditionally performed by humans are being—or are at risk of being—taken over by robots, especially those enabled with artificial intelligence. The number of robots operating worldwide is rising quickly. By 2019, 1.4 million new industrial robots will be in operation, raising the total to 2.6 million worldwide. Robot density per worker in 2018 is the highest in Germany, South Korea, and Singapore. Yet in all of these countries, despite the high prevalence of robots, the employment rate remains high.

_____30_____. Although the adoption of robots did not have any substantial net effect on employment in Germany, it reduced the hiring of young entrants. For this reason, the effects of automation can be different in countries that are aging compared with those that have young populations and anticipate large numbers of new labor market entrants.

Yes, robots are replacing workers, but it is far from clear to what extent. Overall, technological change that replaces routine work is estimated to have created more than 23 million jobs across Europe from 1999 to 2016, or almost half of the total increase in employment over the same period. Recent evidence for European countries suggests that although technology may be replacing workers in some jobs, overall it raises the demand for labor. For example, instead of hiring traditional loan officers, JD Finance, a leading fintech platform in China, created more than 3,000 risk management or data analysis jobs to sharpen algorithms for digitized lending.

Technological progress leads to the direct creation of jobs in the technology sector. People are increasingly using smartphones, tablets, and other portable electronic devices to work, organize their finances, secure and heat their homes, and have fun. Workers create the online interfaces that drive this growth. With consumer interests changing fast, there are more opportunities for people to pursue careers in mobile app development and virtual reality design.

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29. Which of the following statements is TRUE according to the text?

- ☐ A. While technical feasibility is important, it is not the only factor influencing the extent of automation adoption.
- ☐ B. Automation will change the world of work but probably for the better.
- ☐ C. Automation will hamper future jobs and change the structure of the labor force.
- ☐ D. Automation will not benefit most employees though technology will surely increase overall productivity.

30. Which of the following best fits in the blank in the text?

- ☐ A. In general, the adoption of robots is on the rise all around the world.
- ☐ B. The impact of automation on work varies by industry and geographic region.
- ☐ C. Automation is more likely to impact employment in developing countries.
- ☐ D. Young workers may be more affected by automation than older workers.

Questions 31-40 (Suggested completion time: 35 minutes)

Directions: Read three passages about gene therapy. Answer the questions according to the passages.

Passage A

Gene therapy is designed to introduce genetic material into cells to compensate for abnormal genes or to make a beneficial protein. If a mutated gene causes a necessary protein to be faulty or missing, gene therapy may be able to introduce a normal copy of the gene to restore the function of the protein.

A gene that is inserted directly into a cell usually does not function. Instead, a carrier called a vector is genetically engineered to deliver the gene. Certain viruses are often used as vectors because they can deliver the new gene by infecting the cell. The viruses are modified so they can't cause disease when used in people. Some types of viruses, such as retroviruses, integrate their genetic material (including the new gene) into a chromosome (染色体) in the human cell. Other viruses, such as adenoviruses, introduce their DNA into the nucleus (细胞核) of the cell, but the DNA is not integrated into a chromosome.

(A) The vector can be injected or given intravenously (by IV) (静脉注射) directly into a specific tissue in the body, where it is taken up by individual cells.
(B) Alternately, a sample of the patient's cells can be removed and exposed to the vector in a laboratory setting. The cells containing the vector are then returned to the patient. If the treatment is successful, the new gene delivered by the vector will make a functioning protein.

Researchers must overcome many technical challenges before gene therapy will be a practical approach to treating disease. For example, scientists must find better ways to deliver genes and target them to particular cells. They must also ensure that new genes are precisely controlled by the body.

Passage B

2017 was a notable year for gene therapy. The first such treatments in the U.S. came to market in 2017 after winning approval from the Food and Drug Administration (FDA). Meanwhile, researchers announced more miraculous cures of patients with rare and life-threatening diseases who were treated with experimental therapies.

Decades in the making, gene therapy—the idea of modifying a person's DNA to treat disease—represents a major shift in medicine. Instead of just treating symptoms like the vast majority of drugs on the market, gene therapy aims to correct the underlying genetic cause of a disease. Doctors and scientists hope these treatments will be a one-shot cure.

In 2017, we wrote that 2016 was gene therapy's most promising year. But 2017 proved to be even bigger.

Sickle-cell cure

In March 2017, researchers announced that a teenage boy in France had been cured of sickle-cell disease after receiving an experimental gene therapy developed by Bluebird Bio. Caused by a single genetic mutation, sickle-cell is an inherited blood disorder that affects 100,000 people in the U.S. and millions around the world. Scientists removed stem cells from the boy's bone marrow and modified them in the lab by introducing copies of a gene to prevent his red blood cells from becoming "sickled". When the treated cells were infused back into his body, they began to make normal blood cells. More than two years after treatment, the patient has enough normal red blood cells to evade any side effects of the disorder.

Cancer killers

In 2017, the FDA approved two pioneering treatments, Kymriah and Yescarta, that use a patient's own immune cells to fight rare types of cancer. Called CAR-T therapies, these "living drugs" are made by extracting T cells from patients and genetically engineering them to go after and destroy cancer cells. The cells are then infused back into the body. So far, these therapies are being tested only in a handful of lethal cancers as a last resort when more traditional treatments, like chemotherapy, don't work. Kymriah treats a bone marrow cancer that affects children and young adults, and Yescarta treats a type of lymphoma. Some patients have had remarkable recoveries and remain in remission months or years later.

Building new skin

When a bacterial infection threatened his life, a boy with a devastating connective tissue disorder called epidermolysis bullosa (大疱性表皮松解症) got new skin created with gene therapy. To make it, scientists extracted cells from a part of the child's body that wasn't blistered. They isolated skin stem cells and added copies of a healthy version of the gene. They let these cells grow into small sheets and, in a series of three surgeries, transplanted them onto the patient's body at a hospital in Germany. Researchers announced the groundbreaking skin graft in November 2017.

Restoring sight

In December 2017, the FDA approved the first gene therapy for an inherited disease. The treatment, called Luxturna, aims to correct a mutation responsible for a range of retinal diseases that make people gradually go blind. In human tests, the treatment has restored vision for more than two dozen patients who were losing their sight. It isn't an outright cure because it doesn't give patients normal vision, and it's unknown yet how long the benefits last. The company that makes the therapy, Spark Therapeutics, said it won't be announcing its price until January 2018. Some analysts have predicted it could cost \$1 million or more.

Hope for hemophilia (血友病)

BioMarin is one company working on a gene therapy that replaces the faulty gene involved in the most common type of hemophilia, effectively curing the disorder. In December 2017, the company published early clinical trial results showing that nine patients who received its therapy saw substantial increases in the blood-clotting proteins absent in hemophilia. A year and a half after treatment, patients have had fewer bleeding issues and have been able to cut back on infusions of clotting factor. Meanwhile, a handful of patients with hemophilia B, a rarer form of the disease, are already experiencing amazing cures after one-time treatments.

Passage C

It's easy to get excited about gene therapies, a group of new medicines that have the potential to cure diseases in one treatment. The saga of Solid Biosciences Inc. is a reminder that tweaking genes isn't a trivial task. These therapies are full of promise, but they're not entirely there yet.

Solid Bio has been working on a gene therapy for a muscle-wasting disease. It went public last year and saw its market value climb to almost \$2 billion amid a steady rise in its shares, only to plunge in recent months as its once-hyped efforts have been stymied by side effects and weak data. Then late Monday (May 13, 2019), it disclosed more potentially worrisome safety data after upping the dose, triggering a plunge in its stock of as much as 40 percent on Tuesday (May 14, 2019). It's now (May, 2019) worth around \$200 million.

Gene-therapy fever has led to a wave of expensive buyouts and lucrative IPOs (Initial Public Offerings). The excitement around these treatments has led to a great profusion of gene-therapy efforts in a variety of diseases, some of which are likely to end up like Solid Bio's. But it's still very early days.

While safety issues tripped up Solid Bio, they aren't the only risks. There are also concerns about whether these medicines are durable cures. BioMarin Pharmaceutical Inc.'s gene therapy for treating hemophilia has blockbuster potential, for instance, but its latest trial results showed that levels of the clotting factor it helps patients produce declined over time. Investors are watching closely for any further erosion, and billions of dollars in value and sales potential may swing on the result.

These durability fears raise another issue related to gene therapies: their cost. They are designed as one-time treatments for usually rare diseases, so prices are high. Spark Therapeutics Inc.'s eye-disease gene therapy Luxturna costs \$425,000 per eye and has struggled to make commercial headway, though that didn't stop Roche Holding AG from acquiring the company for \$4.8 billion.

Some gene therapies—like BioMarin's hemophilia drug—could replace expensive treatments that must be taken for a lifetime, so there's justification for a high price. That case is diminished if insurers doubt their durability, especially if drugmakers remain reluctant to offer deep discounts when their medicines don't work.

The massive potential of gene therapy means that money is easy and optimism is high right now. But the youth of this field and the dearth of actual commercial success means that it needs to be treated with caution for some time to come.

31-32. Decide whether the statements are True or False according to Passage A.

31. Gene therapy can modify the faulty gene, restoring the function of protein and getting rid of the viruses that cause disease.

- ☐ A. True
☐ B. False

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32. Gene therapy will only take effect when the gene is carried by a certain virus into the cell.

- ☐ A. True
- ☐ B. False

33. Which of the following does NOT make 2017 a notable year for gene therapy, according to Passage B?

- ☐ A. The commercial success for gene therapy.
- ☐ B. The unprecedented progress in gene therapy.
- ☐ C. The first approval from FDA for gene therapy.
- ☐ D. The access of gene therapy to the U.S. market.

34-37. In the third paragraph of Passage A, two ways of gene therapy have been marked by A and B. Read Passage B and match the way with each treatment by choosing A or B, or C if neither A nor B is mentioned.

34. Sickle-cell cure _____ 34 _____

35. Cancer killers _____ 35 _____

36. Building new skin _____ 36 _____

37. Restoring sight _____ 37 _____

38. The author of Passage C mentioned the following challenges gene therapy confronts EXCEPT _____.

- ☐ A. replacement
- ☐ B. safety
- ☐ C. durability
- ☐ D. cost

39. Both Passages B and C introduce the gene therapy for treating hemophilia by BioMarin Pharmaceutical Inc. What can we learn from this example of BioMarin?

- ☐ A. The gene therapy is more effective in treating the common type.
- ☐ B. The company has made a lucrative deal from the treatment.
- ☐ C. The treatment may not cure the disease for good.
- ☐ D. Investors show great confidence in the treatment.

40. Which of the following CANNOT be concluded from the three passages on gene therapy?

- ☐ A. Investors are as optimistic about it as most doctors.
- ☐ B. It is believed to be the quickest way to cure diseases.
- ☐ C. There are safety and cost issues to worry about.
- ☐ D. There is still a long way to go for its wide application.

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2019 阅读大赛初赛 3

Directions: *In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)*

Questions 1-3 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the following quotes. Match the quotes with the people. Please note there are two extra options you do not need.

- A. William Shakespeare
- B. Abraham Lincoln
- C. Robert Frost
- D. Socrates
- E. Alexander Pope

1. 1

True knowledge exists in knowing that you know nothing.

2. 2

You can fool some of the people all of the time, and all of the people some of the time, but you cannot fool all of the people all of the time.

3. 3

Good nature and good sense must ever join; To err is human; to forgive, divine.

Directions: *In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)*

Question 4 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Triclosan is a chemical that can kill bacteria. Companies have put it into toothpastes, soaps, hand sanitizers and other products to increase their germ-busting power. But triclosan washes down drains and into waterways. There, it can kill off good germs. Triclosan can also promote the development of bacteria that are resistant to triclosan and other germ-killers, including lifesaving antibiotics. That's why, in 2016, the U.S. Food and Drug Administration banned triclosan — and some similar chemicals — from use in soaps. Soap alone should be enough to beat back the bad bacteria.

4. Why did the U.S. Food and Drug Administration ban triclosan from use in soaps?

- ☐ A. It can pollute water when discharged directly into waterways.
- ☐ B. It is not an essential ingredient for soaps to remove bad bacteria.
- ☐ C. There are some similar chemicals serving as good substitutes.
- ☐ D. Besides its intended effect, it also causes some unwanted effects.

Directions: In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)

Question 5 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.



For years, scientists speculated as to why panda fur is colored the way it is. One belief was that it helped them camouflage in forests of bamboo and in the snow, and another suggested that it helped them maintain an appropriate body temperature, since black absorbs heat and white reflects it. But in 2017, a study published in the journal *Behavioral Ecology* claimed that the camouflage theory is in fact correct, stating that the white fur helps the animal hide in snowy habitats while the black fur is used for camouflage and communication. The study authors believe their black ears are a sign of aggression toward predators and the black fur around their eyes helps them identify other pandas.

5. Which of the following is NOT a reason why panda fur is colored the way it is according to the 2017 study?

- ☐ A. To communicate with others.
- ☐ B. To help recognise other pandas.
- ☐ C. To adjust body temperature.
- ☐ D. To protect themselves.

Directions: In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)

Question 6 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Since you're here...

... we have a small favour to ask. More people are reading *the Guardian* than ever but advertising revenues across the media are falling fast. And unlike many news organisations, we haven't put up a paywall — we want to keep our journalism as open as we can. So you can see why we need to ask for your help. *The Guardian's* independent, investigative journalism takes a lot of time, money and hard work to produce. But we do it because we believe our perspective matters — because it might well be your perspective, too.

6. What is the main purpose of the text?

- ☐ A. To explain why *the Guardian* doesn't put up a paywall.
- ☐ B. To keep *the Guardian* open and democratic.
- ☐ C. To ask readers to help finance *the Guardian*.
- ☐ D. To prove that people still have easy access to *the Guardian*.

Directions: *In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)*

Question 7 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

People tend to hate computer passwords, that often nonsensical jumble of letters, numbers and special keystrokes said to be essential for digital security. The secret codes seem impossible to remember. It's why every login page has a "Forgot password?" life preserver. The struggle even has a name: Password rage.

Now, a new standard is emerging for passwords, backed by a growing number of businesses and government agencies — to the relief of computer users everywhere. No longer must passwords be changed so often, or include an incomprehensible string of special characters. The new direction is one that champions less complexity in favour of length.

7. Which of the following is a possible password according to the new standard?

- ☐ A. W@5hPo5t!
- ☐ B. mycatlikesreadinggarfieldinthenewspaper
- ☐ C. 1234567890
- ☐ D. iwhbfowdgierlwoifghuierhrqjwegutnjyhtymjy

Directions: *In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)*

Question 8 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

According to researchers, perfectionists hold themselves to unrealistically high standards and become self-critical if they believe they haven't met these standards. Perfectionists are also likely to feel guilt and shame if they experience failures, which often leads them to avoid situations where they are worried they might fail. Amanda Ruggeri, writing about perfectionism for *BBC Future*, explains, "When perfectionists don't succeed, they don't just feel disappointment about how they did. They feel shame about who they are."

8. What is the best title for this text?

- ☐ A. Harm of perfectionism
- ☐ B. Traits of perfectionism
- ☐ C. How to combat perfectionism
- ☐ D. Pros of perfectionism

Directions: In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)

Question 9 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

As levels of carbon dioxide—CO₂—in the atmosphere have been rising in recent decades, Earth has been warming. ① That warming is one symptom of climate change. ② And it has the potential to affect food in many ways. ③ Rising temperatures and the changes in rainfall that it will bring should impact how much and where crops grow. ④ Data now show that rising levels of CO₂ also can affect how nutritious a crop will be. Some of those data were reported in 2017 in *Annual Review of Public Health*. Indeed, it noted that several studies have come to this conclusion.

9. Which blank does the following sentence best fit in?

That's because as a greenhouse gas, CO₂ traps heat in Earth's atmosphere.

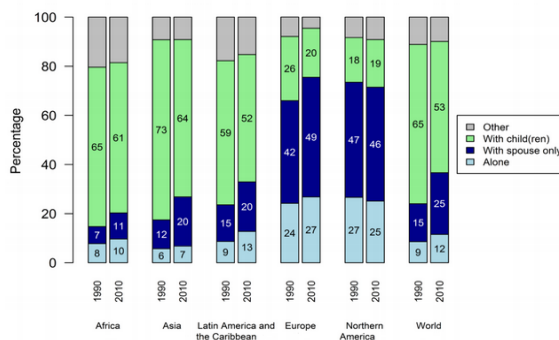
- ☐ A. ①
- ☐ B. ②
- ☐ C. ④
- ☐ D. ③

Directions: In Part I, you will read short texts of various kinds. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions. (Time allowed: 20 minutes)

Question 10 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: Answer the question according to the information in the figure.

Distribution (percentage) of persons aged 60 years or over by type of household living arrangement, for regions, circa 1990 and circa 2010



Data source: United Nations (forthcoming). Database on the Living Arrangements of Older Persons, 2017.

10. Which of the following is INCORRECT according to the figure?

- ☐ A. In Asia, the total proportion of people living alone and with spouse only increased by 9 percent from circa 1990 to circa 2010, while the proportion residing with children decreased by the same amount.
- ☐ B. Latin America and the Caribbean saw the largest increase in the proportion of older persons living alone from circa 1990 to circa 2010, while the proportion residing with their children declined to 52 percent.
- ☐ C. Older persons have become more likely to live alone in the five regions from circa 1990 to circa 2010, while residing with children has become increasingly less common.
- ☐ D. The prevalence of living alone and with spouse increased markedly among the older population of Europe circa 2010, driven mostly by a sizable jump in the proportion residing with spouse only.

Directions: In Part II, you will read short texts on different subjects. Read the instructions carefully and answer the questions based on logical inference and reasoning. (Time allowed: 55 minutes)

Question 11 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Employer: It says here on your resume that you are a hard worker, you pay attention to detail, and you don't mind working long hours.

Andy: Yes sir.

Employer: I spoke to your previous employer. He says that you constantly change things that should not be changed, you could care less about other people's privacy, and you had the lowest score in customer relations.

Andy: Yes, that is all true, as well.

Employer: Great then. Welcome to our social media team!

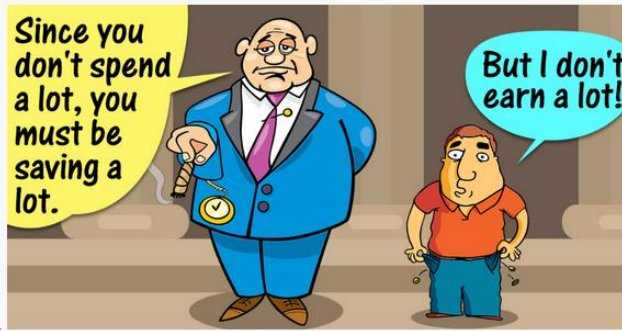
11. The above conversation has committed a logical fallacy called Cherry-picking. Which of the following statements takes the same fallacy?

- ☐ A. A presidential candidate mentioned all the cities where his tax policy decreased crime and failed to mention all the cities where his policy increased crime.
- ☐ B. "Great milk comes from happy cows. Happy cows come from California." (Real California Milk TV Commercial)
- ☐ C. Justine has just given Jake her reasons for believing that the Devil is an imaginary evil person. Jake, not wanting to accept her conclusion, responds with, "That's perhaps true for you, but it's not true for me."
- ☐ D. The councilman's argument for the new convention center can't be any good because he stands to gain if it's built.

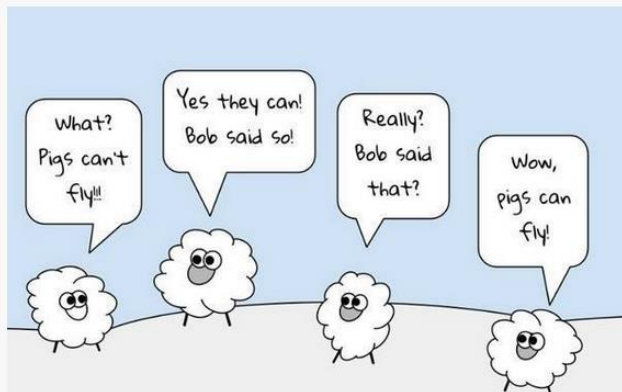
Question 12 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)



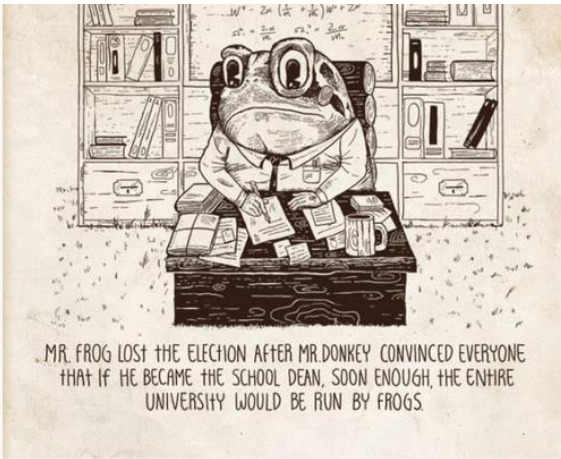
12. Which of the following pictures takes the same fallacy as the above one?



☐ A.



☐ B.



☐ C.



☐ D.

Questions 13-14 Reasoning (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

13.

Company travel manager: Although we had originally planned for the eight marketing department employees to drive 250 miles to this week's advertising meeting, our car rental firm informed us today that no van will be available for rent until next week. Thus, we have no choice but to postpone the meeting.

Which one of the following describes the flaw in the reasoning in the argument?

- ☐ A. The argument considers certain exceptional cases and generalizes to a rule that fits them alone.
- ☐ B. The argument assumes the two options are mutually exclusive when there are other options.
- ☐ C. The argument responds to a distorted version of an opposing position.
- ☐ D. The argument bases a conclusion on two pieces of contradictory evidence.

14.

Soft drink manufacturer: Our new children's soft drink, RipeCal, is fortified with calcium. Since calcium is essential for developing healthy bones, drinking RipeCal regularly will help make children healthy.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously weakens the argument above?

- ☐ A. RipeCal contains large amounts of sugar, which is unhealthy for children if consumed on a regular basis.
- ☐ B. In fact, there is no difference in ingredients between RipeCal and the manufacturer's former products.
- ☐ C. We have abundant evidence that consuming calcium-rich drinks does a body good, especially for children.
- ☐ D. It has been proved that calcium is not the only element that helps develop children's healthy bones.

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Questions 15-16 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text on Sabrina Gonzalez Pasterski. Answer the questions according to the text.

When you were 14 years old, what did you like to do? Maybe go to the movies, play sports, or game with friends online? By the time Sabrina Gonzalez Pasterski, Ph.D., was 14, she had built and flown her own plane.

That's when she first caught the attention of the geniuses at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT), where she went to get a notarization of aircraft worthiness from the federal government for her single-engine plane.

Despite MIT's interest, the Chicago native was wait-listed when she applied there for undergraduate studies. OZY (a media company sharing fresh stories and bold ideas) reports that two professors who saw her airplane intervened, calling her potential "off the charts," and she was later admitted. She graduated at the top of her class, earning a 5.00 grade point average, the highest possible score. She also became the first woman to win the MIT Physics Orloff Scholarship award.

After MIT, she headed for a Ph.D. program in theoretical physics at Harvard University Center for the Fundamental Laws of Nature. While there, she studied topics such as quantum gravity, black holes and spacetime. This June, she graduated with her doctorate.

What's next for the newly minted Dr. Gonzalez Pasterski? It seems she can take her pick: She has a standing job offer from Jeff Bezos at his Blue Origin aerospace company; her research has been cited by theoretical physicist Stephen Hawking; she has been interviewed by Apple cofounder Steve Wozniak, and NASA has its eye on her. She'll likely continue her work on quantum gravity, a theory that attempts to explain gravitational physics in terms of quantum mechanics.

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But you won't find her bragging about her exceptionalness, especially on social media, as she "does not have and has never had a Facebook, Twitter, LinkedIn or Instagram account." (She does, however, have a YouTube channel.) As she writes on her website, PhysicsGirl.com, "I have so much to learn. I do not deserve the attention."

A growing interest in physics

She is also an exceptional example of a growing trend: Efforts to increase interest in STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics) fields are paying off. According to the American Institute of Physics (AIP), the number of people in the U.S. graduating with bachelor's degrees in physics is rising.

There were 8,633 physics bachelor's degrees conferred in the class of 2017, up from around 8,000 in 2015. That figure has risen about 4% each year over the last 13 years, leading to a small but steady increase in physics-focused grads.

The number of women studying or working in physics has risen as well, though again, the numbers are small. In 2017, about 40% (about 65,000) of high school students who took the AP (Advanced Placement) Physics exam were female. But among college and university physics departments, women make up just 16% of the faculty and staff, according to the most recent data. Though 16% may seem low, that number is up from 10% in 2002.

Why did the decline in interest from high school to the professional realm happen? A 2016 study on how to retain women in physics found that women cited two main factors for leaving: negative relationships with graduate advisors and the "two-body problem," which is when a couple with both partners in academia needs to find two jobs in the same geographic area.

Let's hope the learnings from that study help pave the way for more smart young women to embrace science like Sabrina Gonzalez Pasterski and lead by example.



15. According to the text, which of the following roles does Sabrina Gonzalez Pasterski NOT play?

- ☐ A. A modest girl.
- ☐ B. A talented student.
- ☐ C. An active blogger.
- ☐ D. A promising scientist.

16. What is the implication of the example of Sabrina Gonzalez Pasterski?

- ☐ A. High school students will be more interested in physics.
- ☐ B. Girls will have more chances to study science in universities.
- ☐ C. More and more smart girls will be encouraged to study STEM.
- ☐ D. Female students tend to have better relationships with graduate advisers.

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Questions 17-19 (Suggested completion time: 8 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.



Businesses value collaboration. The latest survey by the *Financial Times* of what employers want from MBA graduates found that the ability to work in a team, to work with a wide variety of people and to build, sustain and expand a network of people were three of the top five skills that managers wanted. Practical qualifications like accounting, programming and applied microeconomics were among the least-desired attributes.

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But managers always have to balance the merits of teamwork, which help ensure that everyone is working towards the same goal, with the dangers of "groupthink", when critics are reluctant to point out a plan's defects for fear of being ostracized by the group.

A related phenomenon is the "wisdom of crowds". Large groups are remarkably good, on average, at estimating such things as the number of beans in a jar or the weight of a prize calf. But that accuracy relies on the guesses being independent. When people are aware of the views of others, there is a tendency for them to herd, as participants are reluctant to look foolish by deviating from the majority view. The same effect may lead to stock market bubbles.

Modern communication methods mean that collaboration is more frequent. Workers are constantly in touch with each other via e-mail, messaging groups or mobile calls. But does that boost, or detract from, performance? A new study by Ethan Bernstein, Jesse Shore and David Lazer, three American academics, tried to answer this question. They set a logical problem (devising the shortest route for a travelling salesman visiting various cities). Three groups were involved: one where subjects acted independently; another where they saw the solutions posted by team members at every stage; and a third where they were kept informed of each other's views only intermittently.

The survey found that members of the individualist group reached the optimal solution more often than the constant collaborators, but had a poorer average result. The intermittent collaborators found the right result as often as the individualists, and got a better average solution.

When it comes to idea generation, giving people a bit of space to find a solution seems to be a good idea. Occasional collaboration can be a big help; most people have benefited from a colleague's brainwave or (just as often) wise advice to avoid a particular course of action.

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Further clues come from a book, *Superminds*, by Thomas Malone of the Massachusetts Institute of Technology. He says that three factors determine the “collective intelligence” of collaborating groups: social intelligence (how good people were at rating the emotional states of others); the extent to which members took part equally in conversation (the more equal, the better); and the proportion of women in the group (the higher, the better). Groups ranked highly in these areas co-operated far better than others.

Close teamwork may be vital in the lower reaches of a hierarchy, but at the top someone has to make a decision. At this stage, intense collaboration may be less helpful. In their book, *Friend & Foe*, Adam Galinsky of Columbia Business School and Maurice Schweitzer of the Wharton School of the University of Pennsylvania found that fashion houses with co-creative directors were rated as less creative by industry experts over a decade (from 2000 to 2010) than brands that were individually led. They add that co-led teams of Himalayan climbers are more likely to suffer deaths than those with single leaders.

As the authors note, co-leadership “creates uncertainty over who is really in charge”. The battles between Sandy Weill and John Reed when they were co-chief executives of Citigroup in the late 1990s were infamous; the arrangement lasted just two years. Less than 5% of companies in the Fortune 500 have used a co-CEO structure since 1989. In short, collaboration may be a useful tool but it doesn't work in every situation.

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17. Which of the following could be the best title for the text?

- ☐ A. The hidden problems of collaboration
- ☐ B. Teams can work well, but co-leaders often don't
- ☐ C. The pros and cons of collaboration
- ☐ D. Success requires teamwork, but teamwork is hard

18. What can we know about the "wisdom of crowds"?

- ☐ A. Group wisdom better functions when people do not know what others think.
- ☐ B. Achievements of groups guarantee relatively higher accuracy.
- ☐ C. The term is originally used in the stock market when describing bubbles.
- ☐ D. Large groups of people are collectively smarter than individual experts.

19. According to the text, which of the following is true about collaboration?

- ☐ A. A new study by three American academics confirms the positive role of constant collaboration on performance.
- ☐ B. Different levels of a hierarchy do not gain the same benefits from collaboration.
- ☐ C. Collaboration becomes more diverse with the advancement of technology.
- ☐ D. A balanced gender proportion in the group can lead to better collaboration.

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Questions 20-22 (Suggested completion time: 8 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about trigger warnings. Answer the questions according to the text.



Trigger warnings that alert people to potentially sensitive content are increasingly popular, especially on college campuses, but research suggests that they have minimal impact on how people actually respond to content. The findings are published in *Clinical Psychological Science*, a journal of the Association for Psychological Science.

"We, like many others, were hearing new stories week upon week about trigger warnings being asked for or introduced at universities around the world," says psychology researcher Mevagh Sanson of The University of Waikato, first author on the research. "Our findings suggest that these warnings, though well intended, are not helpful."

Trigger warnings may be increasingly prevalent, but there has been almost no research actually examining their effects.

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It's possible that they function the way they're meant to, helping people to manage their emotional responses and reduce their symptoms of distress. But it's also possible trigger warnings could have the opposite effect, influencing people's expectations and experiences in ways that exacerbate their distress.

"We thought it was important to figure out how effective these warnings are," says Sanson. "This is the first piece of empirical work directly examining if they have their intended effects."

To resolve the question, the researchers conducted a series of six experiments with a total of 1,394 participants.

Some participants—a combination of college students and online participants—read a message about the content they were about to see, for example: "TRIGGER WARNING: The following video may contain graphic footage of a fatal car crash. You might find this content disturbing." Others did not read a warning. All participants were then exposed to the content.

Afterward, the participants reported various symptoms of distress—their negative emotional state, and the degree to which they experienced intrusive thoughts and tried to avoid thinking about the content.

The results across all six experiments were consistent: Trigger warnings had little effect on participants' distress. That is, participants responded to the content similarly, regardless of whether they saw a trigger warning.

The format of the content also did not make a difference: Trigger warnings had little impact regardless of whether participants read a story or watched a video clip.



Could it be that trigger warnings are specifically effective for those people who have previously experienced traumatic events? The data suggested the answer is no: There was little difference between groups. In other words, individuals with a personal history of trauma who received a trigger warning reported similar levels of distress as did those who did not receive a warning.

The researchers note that it remains to be seen whether these results would apply to individuals who have a specific clinical diagnosis such as anxiety, depression, or post-traumatic stress disorder. However, these findings indicate that trigger warnings are unlikely to have the meaningful impact they're typically assumed to have.

"These results suggest a trigger warning is neither meaningfully helpful nor harmful," says Sanson. "Of course, that doesn't mean trigger warnings are benign. We need to consider the idea that their repeated use encourages people to avoid negative material, and we already know that avoidance helps to maintain disorders such as PTSD (post-traumatic stress disorder). Trigger warnings might also communicate to people that they're fragile, and coax them to interpret ordinary emotional responses as extraordinary signals of danger."



20. What function are trigger warnings meant to serve?

- ☐ A. To make meaningful content more popular in young people.
- ☐ B. To help people lower their expectations of what they may see.
- ☐ C. To warn people against the potential traffic dangers.
- ☐ D. To reduce people's discomfort when seeing sensitive content.

21. What is said about the findings of the six experiments?

- ☐ A. Participants had similar responses to the content whether or not they saw a trigger warning.
- ☐ B. Trigger warnings had different effects on participants' distress across the experiments.
- ☐ C. All the participants responded to the content just as what was expected.
- ☐ D. The format of the content made a big difference to participants' distress.

22. What can we learn about the effect of trigger warnings on those who were once traumatized?

- ☐ A. The effect varies depending on the different anxiety or depression levels.
- ☐ B. It remains to be seen whether trigger warnings have any effect on them.
- ☐ C. Trigger warnings probably have no meaningful effect on them.
- ☐ D. Trigger warnings exert more serious effect on them.

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Questions 23-25 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.



*Copper tickets for the Theatre Royal dated 1671
featuring the bust of Charles II:
Top—obverse and reverse of a 30mm ticket for the First Gallery (gallerie).
A Upper Gallery ticket measuring 25mm; and a 33mm Pit ticket.*

With the restoration of Charles II in 1660, dramatists Thomas Killigrew and William Davenant returned to London from exile on the Continent and, after several petitions to the new King, both were granted royal charters which gave each of them the right to build a theatre and employ a company of actors. This in effect gave them a monopoly on theatrical performances in London.

Killigrew's actors were known as the King's Company and Davenant's were the Duke's Company. The patents also stated that all the women's parts should now be played by women, instead of boys, as had been the custom. Killigrew leased a parcel of land from the Duke of Bedford to build a new playhouse on the site of an old riding yard between Brydge Street and Drury Lane; the cost being raised by the sale of shares in the building and lease. The new Theatre Royal was quite small with seating for 700 and opened in May 1663 with *The Humorous Lieutenant*. Pepys and his wife went to see the play but had to leave as the glazed dome over the pit was letting in the rain.

The first tickets recorded for Drury Lane are dated 1671, which is the same year in which Charles Killigrew, Thomas' son, took over the management. The purpose of the tickets was to record how many people were in the theatre and therefore what the takings should be. The tickets are copper with the bust of Charles II and THEATRE ROYAL on the obverse, while the reverse has the date 1671 and either FOR THE PIT or FOR THE FIRST GALLERIE or UPPER GALLERIE. The tickets gave access to the chosen part of the auditorium but did not guarantee a seat. These were on a first come first served basis and to be sure of a seat one had to get to the theatre early or pay someone to reserve a seat for you. On entering the auditorium the ticket was handed to the collector so that it could be used the following day.

Performances took place daily and were advertised with playbills posted in convenient places or by word of mouth, the shows lasted over three hours with five acts. We would recognise old Drury Lane as a theatre with its rows of backless benches in the pit, with boxes around and galleries above but the actual performances were very different. To start with the curtain was raised at the beginning of the evening and stayed open until the play finished, with scenery being changed in full view and any actors who were unlucky enough to die in the play had to wait for a reasonable amount of time before they could get up to make their exit. The plays started at three in the afternoon to make use of the daylight, otherwise lighting was provided by large rings of candles suspended above the stage and should one of them begin to gut the candle snuffer was called for; wandering onto the stage in the middle of a scene to tend the offending candle. The actors wore their normal day clothes, except that the more important actors and actresses had richer and more ornate costumes, many of these were given by the nobility when they had tired of them. If the play was a tragedy a green cloth would be laid on the stage so that the actors dying would not get their clothes dirty.

The audiences were not quiet as they are now. Going to the theatre was as much about going to see and be seen as to watch the play, so the latest gossip would be discussed or arrangements to meet would be made often using one of the orange girls as an intermediary. Most of the men wore swords and fights were frequent, in fact the action in the auditorium was often more exciting than that on the stage. It is wonder that those in the gallery could see or hear anything with the smoke from the candles and the noise from the audience.



23. Which of the following is TRUE about the new Theatre Royal?

- ☐ A. It was a small open-air theatre.
- ☐ B. It was the King's private theatre.
- ☐ C. It was built on site of an old theatre.
- ☐ D. It was built by raising money.

24. What can be learned about the first tickets for Drury Lane?

- ☐ A. Many tickets were kept as collections by the audience.
- ☐ B. They didn't entitle the audience to have a seat.
- ☐ C. The selling prices of the tickets were not always fixed.
- ☐ D. They were issued mainly to honor the king at that time.

25. Which of the following is NOT true according to the text?

- ☐ A. The audience could even see the change of scene on the stage.
- ☐ B. The actors hardly had special costumes.
- ☐ C. The theatre was also a noisy sociable place.
- ☐ D. The performance was often interrupted by the change of candles.

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Questions 26-28 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and decide whether the statements are True or False or Not Given.

A recent study shows the importance of challenging your assumptions. Suppose a company ran misleading ads for a drug called Perfectil. Suppose the ads said that Perfectil cures cancer, even though it doesn't.

If you were in charge of correcting the error, your instinct might be to run ads saying "The claim that Perfectil cures cancer is untrue. Perfectil does not cure cancer." You wouldn't necessarily expect everyone to see the ad, or remember it, but at least those who do remember it would have the right information.

Yoon and Skurnik, both business professors, found that this isn't necessarily so. In a number of different experiments, they showed that the memory of the statement itself far outlasts any kind of disclaimer or warning that's attached to it. This was true especially in older people, but it happens in everybody to some extent. So even just a few hours after being told a statement wasn't true, some of their subjects started to believe it was true.

In short, you can make a lot of people believe that daffodils cause cancer by telling them that daffodils *don't* cause cancer. Weird, right? Now imagine that you're telling them something really important: for example, that a particular drug isn't safe for people with high blood pressure. If a warning like that backfires, the results could be deadly.

The findings have political implications as well. Candidates often run ads disputing their opponents' attacks. But according to this study, telling America that "Senator Smith never voted for that tax increase" may actually make more people believe that she *did* vote for it. That's because as time goes on, people just remember the Senator's name and the tax increase, not the "never" part.

A more effective ad, according to the researchers, might say "Senator Smith has always fought for lower taxes." Here, there's no negative: only the positive connection between Senator Smith and lower taxes. The downside to the findings is that they suggest that an unethical politician can make false charges seem true just by repeating them as often as possible. But even if their opponents can't stop them,

at least they can avoid unintentionally helping them out.

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26. When people are told a statement is false, they remember the statement itself much better than the warning. Older adults are especially susceptible to this unintended effect.

- ☐ A. True
- ☐ B. False
- ☐ C. Not Given

27. It is more effective to make a statement in a positive way rather than a negative way. This applies to many aspects, from consumer safety warnings to political ads.

- ☐ A. True
- ☐ B. False
- ☐ C. Not Given

28. According to Yoon and Skurnik's study, their findings have already been used by unethical politicians to make false charges seem true.

- ☐ A. True
- ☐ B. False
- ☐ C. Not Given

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Questions 29-30 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the information in the text.

We've all come to believe that as people get older, they inevitably lose their mental abilities, from speeded responses to the infamous inability to remember names. Occasionally, researchers challenge this set of assumptions, showing that age changes in everything from brain volume to higher-level intellectual skills are preserved in some people well into the 80s, 90s, and beyond. However, the considered wisdom is certainly on the side of aging bringing with it mental decline.

Now, the considered wisdom may be changing. University of Tübingen linguist Michael Ramscar and his colleagues (2014) systematically compared computer simulations with human performance data on aging in areas such as memory for names, ability to learn novel associations, and even speed of responses. Their basic argument is that as you get older, your storehouse of knowledge and experience continue to grow exponentially. As a result, it takes you longer to sift through all that information when you're trying to recall one specific item.

_____29_____.

Let's start with the case of people's names, always a sore spot for people with memory complaints. According to Ramscar and his co-authors, the reason you would have more trouble remembering the name of someone you meet when you're 50 than you did when you were 30 is due to the sheer number of people you've met over that two-decade period. Over your lifetime, by extrapolation, it would be statistically impossible for you to remember the many thousands more people you've met. Therefore, forgetting one person's name, or even 10 or 20, doesn't mean your mind is shot.

There's another reason it's becoming harder for everyone to remember names. As Ramscar and his group point out, names are just getting harder to remember. 100 years ago, there were only a limited number of first names. Today, almost anything can be a name, from a fruit to a season to an emotion. This means that keeping track of someone's name requires a great deal more effort when the only names you had to remember were "John," "Mary," and maybe the occasional "Jeffrey" or "Linda."

Older people, therefore, are not just struggling with remember more people's names, but more names. They also have a longer history of forming associations to words that are now names with referents that aren't people (such as "Apple" for a name instead of a fruit).

Similarly, the ability to learn new paired-associates, a frequent lab test of learning, can be more difficult for older adults because they have acquired so many more associations throughout their lives that have to be broken in one of these lab tasks. For example, you might be shown the pair "Jacket-Frame" in a learning trial. Then in the test trial, when you're shown the word "Jacket," you need to remember that it was paired with "Frame." However, older adults have a long history of associating the word "jacket" to lots of different things, people, and experiences (such as jacket-knife, or jacket-coat, or even jacket-down). It's not that they can't learn new associations, but that they'll take just that much longer than a younger, naïve subject would, to forget the ones they've formed earlier in life.

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29. Which of the following examples best fits in the blank of Paragraph 2?

- ☐ A. A case in point is that you forget what you ate for dinner last night, but you remember as soon as someone gives you a hint.
- ☐ B. The situation is very much the same as might happen to you when you're used to going the same way to your neighborhood coffee shop. When the sidewalk closes due to construction, you have to go a different way.
- ☐ C. When prompted with the cue to come up with all animal names that you can start with the letter B, you will generate more possible animal names when you're older than you would have when you were younger because you know so many more names.
- ☐ D. Like a crowded file drawer, each item becomes more difficult to pull out compared to a drawer that's nearly empty.

30. What is the main idea of the text?

- ☒ A. The aging process does not necessarily bring about declining mental abilities.
- ☐ B. Age differences are taken as a key factor in deciding how someone's brain functions.
- ☐ C. There are several causes for old people's inefficient mental performance.
- ☐ D. Losing track of people's names does not indicate a loss of mental abilities.

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Questions 31-40 (Suggested completion time: 35 minutes)

Directions: Read three passages about helicopter parenting. Answer the questions according to the passages.

Passage A

The fear of being a helicopter parent began years before I had my first son. Back then, I was fairly certain I could avoid overparenting, and would give my children a healthy amount of freedom.

Now, seven years and two kids later, I have no idea if that's the case. If I get down on the floor to do blocks with my toddler, am I guiding or hovering? If I help my kindergartner with a school project, am I inspiring or overbearing?

One reason I am so confused about whether or not I am a helicopter parent is because the definition of it is unclear. "Helicopter parenting" is often used as a synonym for intensive parenting, and, more confusingly, both permissive and authoritarian parenting. But these are all different.

Intensive parenting means you put a lot of time, energy and thought into raising your children. Helicopter parenting means you oversteer and overprotect, leaving little to chance. Helicopter parents can come in all flavors. There are the buttoned-up ones, who have their sights set on Ivy League degrees, and free-spirited ones, who view the curation of their child's creativity and self-expression as a monumental task.

Permissive and authoritarian parenting is part of another taxonomy altogether, one that also includes authoritative parenting. Authoritarian means you lead by command without taking the child's desires into consideration; authoritative means you direct your children, but are also responsive and nurturing; and permissive means you let your children do whatever they want.

One can be permissive or authoritarian and still be a helicopter parent. Permissive helicopter parents ensure that their child gets what their child wants. Authoritarian helicopter parents ensure that their child gets what the parents want. Either way, the child has few opportunities to fend for herself.

"Helicopter parents don't develop independence and self-advocacy in their children," said Catherine Steiner-Adair, clinical psychologist, school consultant and co-author of *The Big Disconnect: Protecting Childhood and Family Relationships in the Digital Age*.

Self-evaluation is always a risky endeavor, but here it goes. I give my kids a decent amount of free time, allow them to experience failure, and don't force them to take up a hobby unless they're interested. However, when they are interested in something I encourage it, engage with them about it, and make them stick with it. I'd say I am a(n) 32 and non-helicopter parent, while quite possibly a(n) 32 parent. But it remains to be seen whether this is a bad thing or not.

Passage B

"Buzz Buzz," you look around, expecting to find a swarm of bees, but find your mother looking over your shoulder at your computer screen. While parents should set limits, sometimes the limits seem out of proportion. When parents allow their children to have a Facebook or Twitter account, it feels like too much when they demand the password. Their access lets them over-analyze their teenager's friend list, and research the story behind every tweet. When parents have a strict cell phone policy, it can also seem like too much—"I take your phone whenever I please and I read everything you send and receive."

We all wonder, "Who invented the online grade book viewer?" Sure, it allows me to see test grades and class grades, but it also gives access to my parents. Personally, I prefer to find out my grades before they see them. I understand they want to monitor my progress and enforce what needs to be done, but again, there are boundaries. I have heard of parents who confront their kid before the student even knows the grade. Unfortunately, this puts extra pressure on the student and can cause a distant relationship between the child and their parents.

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Dealing with Overprotective Parents

In many cases, parents don't know when to let their teenagers be independent. When kids enter adolescence, they begin to defy their parents. Many times, parents continue to have the same tight grip on everything that they did when their kids were younger. This tight grip can actually cause teenagers to behave even worse and push them to sneak and lie.

Overprotective parents seem to want their kids to avoid mistakes and, in so doing, they deny their children a learning opportunity. For example, if teenagers are denied the opportunity to go to a party with friends, they may miss out on many life lessons. Sometimes the best way to learn to do the right thing is to make mistakes.

Being a helicopter parent isn't always negative. Parents often know what's best for their child. ___34___ ___35___ ___36___ ___37___. When the mistakes are dangerous and threatening, too much helicoptering can be a healthy influence.

Although helicopter parents have trouble knowing when it's time to let go, their intentions are very positive. Parents often try to shield their children from difficulties such as bullying, drug and alcohol abuse, and relationship stress. Many of these issues are prevalent among teenagers. But, I believe that by parents protecting us from these issues, they make it difficult for us in the future; we won't learn how to deal with certain problems.

Passage C

Why do so many seemingly sane people get over-involved with their kids? The answer is not that parents have collectively come unhinged, but rather, parents today are rational economic actors responding to an increasingly unhinged environment. Economists Matthias Doepke of Northwestern University and Fabrizio Zilibotti of Yale University explain that as society has become more unequal, and the stakes for higher education have skyrocketed, middle-class and upper-class parents have responded naturally: By helping with homework, signing kids up for every imaginable activity, reading *War and Peace* to their toddlers, and making sure their kids know how to code (of course).

In countries like the US and the UK, inequality since the 1980s has risen dramatically. In response, parents have decided to spend more time with children. In 2005, Dutch mothers spent four hours a week more on child care than in 1975; Dutch fathers spent three more. In the US, where inequality has risen faster, both mothers and fathers were spending six hours more a week with their kids than parents did in 1975. This development is made more intense by the fact that family size continues to shrink in the US, so each child is getting more attention.

The consequences of the economists' conclusions are worrisome. Even though helicopter parents may be acting rationally, the collective impact of the wealthy frantically working to ensure their kids stay ahead only exacerbates inequality, further entrenching segregation of opportunity for children.

"Parenting has become very unequal," said Doepke. "It's one of the big social problems we have because we have high inequality now, and if kids don't get the same starting conditions, it's just going to get worse and worse in the future."

Wisely, their prescription is not to fix the helicopter parents, but the institutions that are perpetuating inequality. They recommend that governments offer high-quality affordable or free child care to give less advantaged children better chances, and institute apprenticeships and vocational training programs that will give kids who don't go to college more professional opportunities. They also encourage governments to consider that parents and students respond to the organization of school systems, including high-stakes tests. If there is a high-stakes test, parents will help kids to prepare and kids will inevitably end up more stressed out because of this.

Doepke, a parent himself, admits to a sentiment that will resonate with many reluctant helicopter types: That we sometimes feel as if we don't have much choice. Reflecting on his own childhood, Doepke said, "We had lots of freedom. Our parents gave us food and shelter, but we had a lot of free time. I expected to be the same, but I find myself in America, and a lot more helicopter than free range."

31. What can we know about the author of Passage A?

- ☐ A. She has been afraid of being a helicopter parent.
- ☐ B. She used to be a helicopter parent with her first son.
- ☐ C. She is confident that she is a non-helicopter parent.
- ☐ D. She knows how to avoid helicopter parenting.

32. According to the definitions and descriptions of different types of parents in Passage A, what kind of parent does the author think herself is? Fill in the blanks with the correct words.

(Please answer with capitalized letters without punctuation marks, for example: XY)

- A. permissive
- B. intensive
- C. authoritarian
- D. authoritative

32

33. Which of the following does the author of Passage B find unacceptable?

- ☐ A. Parents deny the social account to their children.
- ☐ B. Parents access the social account of their children.
- ☐ C. Parents use the online grade book viewer too often.
- ☐ D. Parents do some research on their children's friends.

34-37. The following statements are taken from Paragraph 5 of Passage B. Rearrange them and fill in the blanks.

- A. This guidance isn't intended to be negative, but its purpose is to protect their teens and keep them safe.
- B. They usually have a good indicator on when their teenager is ready for independence.
- C. Some parents may be trying to protect their children from mistakes they might have made in their past.
- D. They also know what their child's capabilities are and this helps them guide their teenager on a correct path.

34

35

36

37

38-40. Decide whether the statements are True or False.

38. According to Passage C, helicopter parenting has intensified social inequality and formed a vicious circle.

- ☐ A. True
- ☐ B. False

39. According to Passage C, the issue of helicopter parenting can be solved by the government.

- ☐ A. True
- ☐ B. False

40. It can be concluded from the three passages that both parents and teenagers take a negative attitude to helicopter parenting.

- ☐ A. True
- ☐ B. False

2019 阅读大赛复赛 1

Questions 1-3 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the following quotes. Match the quotes with the people. Please note there are two extra options you do not need.

- A. Khalil Gibran
- B. Charlotte Brontë
- C. Winston Churchill
- D. Stephen Hawking
- E. J. K. Rowling

1.

Success is not final, failure is not fatal: it is the courage to continue that counts. 1

2.

Prejudices, it is well known, are most difficult to eradicate from the heart whose soil has never been loosened or fertilized by education; they grow there, firm as weeds among stones. 2

3.

Imagination is not only the uniquely human capacity to envision that which is not, and therefore the fount of all invention and innovation. 3

Question 4 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Embracing negativity may also have social benefits. Compared with cheery moods, bad moods have been linked to a more effective communication style, and sadness has been linked to less reliance on negative stereotypes. Feeling down can make us behave more fairly, too. _____.

4. Which of the following best fits in the blank?

- ☐ A. People who saw sad video clips before playing an allocation game were more generous with their partners than those who saw happy clips.
- ☐ B. Research shows that optimistic self-employed people earned no more than their pessimistic peers.
- ☐ C. Married couples who were extremely optimistic about their relationship's future were more likely to experience relationship deterioration.
- ☐ D. Students who had anticipated a higher grade than they received were upset after learning their scores.

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Question 5 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.



"If you make food that tastes really good, you win," says Josh Tetrick, with a smile. And winning is crucial, he says, with his company "Just" in the vanguard of a new sector with an ambitious mission: to use cutting-edge technologies to create food that will take down the meat and dairy industries.

The scope is huge: growing meat in labs, producing creamy scrambled "eggs" from mung beans, or making fish that has never swum in water, or cow's milk brewed from yeast. The drive is to lessen the colossal environmental damage wrought by industrial farming, from its vast carbon emissions to water pollution and disease.

5. What is the company's plan?

- ☐ A. To reduce air and water pollution.
- ☐ B. To make really tasty food in a new food sector.
- ☐ C. To make food with advanced technologies.
- ☐ D. To develop up-to-date methods in food industry.

Question 6 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Results from a slew of ancient-genome studies in 2018 could help to explain how humans spread across the Americas. Scientists hope to narrow down estimates of when and how people expanded into the region beginning around 15,000 years ago, and to clarify the timing and routes of subsequent migrations. The work might also help to explain the genetic diversity seen in today's Native American populations.

6. Which of the following is the best title of the text?

- ☐ A. Emigrant Americans
- ☐ B. Ancient Americans
- ☐ C. American Immigrants
- ☐ D. American Expansion

Question 7 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.



Earlier studies have shown that elephants may be monitoring ground vibrations through their bodies, a trait more commonly associated with small creatures like scorpions and insects. For example, elephants have been observed fleeing for higher ground in the moments before distant tsunamis, and a mother elephant who feels threatened will stomp on the ground to warn others away. By suggesting that elephants not only cause distinct vibrations with different activities, but can perceive the difference from great distances, a research published on May 7, 2018 in the journal *Current Biology* expands the possibilities of what the animals may be communicating. It also presents a new opportunity for researchers and conservationists looking to surveil the animals at a distance, a tactic that could be useful for saving a species that is threatened by poachers.

7. According to the studies, which of the following can NOT be learned about elephants?

- ☐ A. They can perceive distant differences.
- ☐ B. They can monitor vibrations on the ground.
- ☐ C. They can feel the threat posed by the poachers.
- ☐ D. They can notice certain natural disasters in advance.

Question 8 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Being rejected after a job interview can severely dent your confidence. Many candidates I have worked with over the years tortuously dwell on being turned down, often forgetting the bigger picture. Rejection, while not pleasant, can often be **blown out of proportion** and viewed as a sign of failure. However, by thinking objectively, candidates can use it to build on their core strengths, address development points and ultimately find a job that suits them best.

8. What does **blown out of proportion** probably mean?

- ☐ A. extremely overwhelmed
- ☐ B. precluded
- ☐ C. taken seriously
- ☐ D. exaggerated

Question 9 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

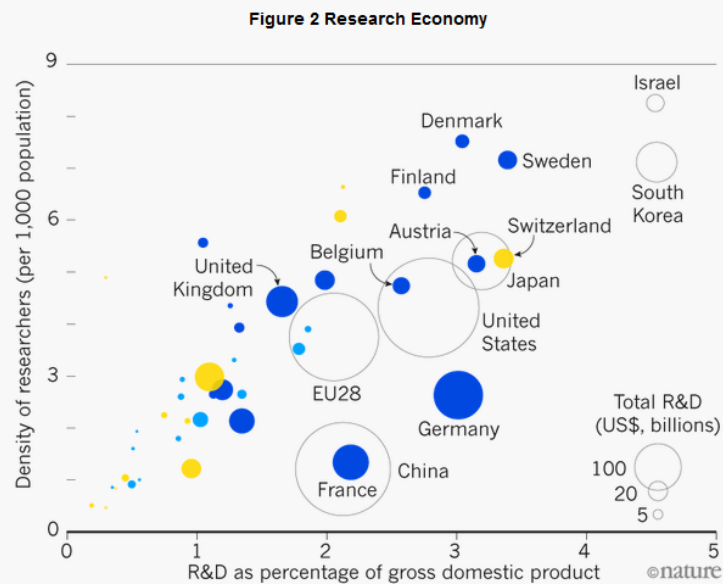
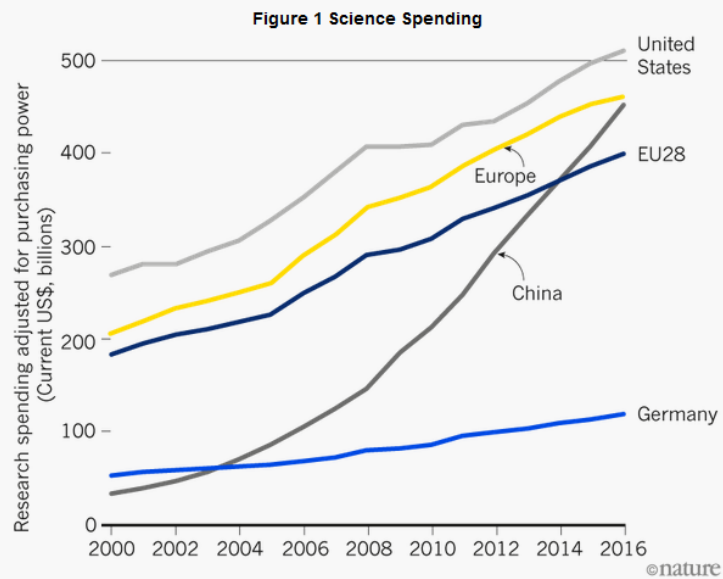
Cape Town found itself in crisis in 2018 as the city braced for "Day Zero," when little rainfall and low dam levels left the city with no water. However, restrictions on water usage proved effective, and the city was able to push Day Zero back to sometime in 2019 and loosen the restrictions. Unfortunately, though, the city is still not in the clear, and the city's water supply will depend on the amount of rainfall it receives in 2019. Other challenges facing Cape Town include "a growing population, contamination of rivers, and leakage from rickety infrastructure (including wastewater treatment facilities in disrepair)," Quartz Africa reports.

9. "Day Zero" most probably means a day set by the government to _____.

- ☐ A. enhance people's awareness of saving water
- ☐ B. open the floodgate to release the dam water
- ☐ C. limit the usage of water so as to save water
- ☐ D. commemorate the coming of the rainy season

Question 10 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: The two figures show the situation of science research in different countries and areas. Answer the question according to the figures.



10. Which of the following is an INCORRECT description about the figures?

- ☐ A. European countries have increased their spending on research and development by more than 100% in the 16 years.
- ☐ B. The Nordic countries have the highest researcher density, relative to their research and development spending.
- ☐ C. Denmark, Sweden and Finland lead the world in terms of the share of their economies devoted to research.
- ☐ D. In absolute terms, China spends around two-thirds of what EU28 does on research and development in 2010.

Question 11 (Suggested completion time: 4 minutes)

Directions: Read the following text. Answer the question according to the text.

A city official is charged with corruption for awarding contracts to his wife's consulting firm. In speaking to a reporter about why he is innocent, the city official talks only about his wife's conservative wardrobe, the family's lovable dog, and his own accomplishments in supporting Little League Baseball.

11. Which of the following fallacies does the text illustrate?

- ☐ A. **Use-Mention Error:** a fallacy that confuses the word used to describe a thing, with the thing itself.
- ☐ B. **False Analogy:** a fallacy which occurs when the analogy is irrelevant or very weak or when there is a more relevant disanalogy.
- ☐ C. **Gambler's:** a fallacy which occurs when the gambler falsely assumes that the history of outcomes will affect future outcomes.
- ☐ D. **Avoiding the Issue:** a fallacy when an arguer responds to an argument by not addressing the points of the argument.

Question 12 (Suggested completion time: 4 minutes)

Directions: Read the following text. Answer the question according to the text.

Samantha: David is a totally selfish person.
Yvonne: I thought he was a Boy Scout leader. Don't you have to give a lot of your time for that?
Samantha: Well, David's totally selfish about what he gives money to. He won't spend a dime on anyone else.
Yvonne: I saw him bidding on things at the high school auction fundraiser.
Samantha: Well, except for that he's totally selfish about money.

12. The above conversation commits the fallacy of Hedging. Which of the following is of the same fallacy?

- ☐ A. **Sidney:** I am mere weeks away from getting my time machine to work, at which time, I will go back to 1626 and buy Manhattan from the Native Americans before the Dutch West India Company gets their greedy hands on it. I'll be much more generous and give the Native Americans 70 guilders, not a measly 60.

Pete: Is this the time travel kit you bought online for \$99.99?

Sidney: Go ahead and mock me. People mocked the Wright brothers too for wanting to fly like birds!

- ☐ B. **Freddie:** All women are evil, manipulative, man-haters.

Wade: Including your mother and best friend?

Freddie: Not them, but all the others.

Wade: How can you say that, when you only know maybe a hundred or so women?

Freddie: Obviously, I am talking about the ones I know.

- ☐ C. **Reporter:** Mr. Congressman, where do you stand on the clean water vs. new factory issue?

Congressman: Of course, I want our state to have the cleanest water possible. I can appreciate the petition against the new factory as I can also appreciate the new jobs introduced in our community as a result of the new factory.

- ☐ D. **Kelly:** Chester and I support the inclusion of prayers in public schools.

Chester: Hey! I never said that.

Kelly: You're not an atheist, are you Chester?

Questions 13-14 Reasoning (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

13.

Supporters of the theory of global warming claim that carbon emissions are causing our environment to slowly warm, which will eventually produce catastrophic results. However, this past winter was one of the coldest on record. Therefore, the claim that global warming is accelerating is false.

Which of the following most accurately describes the flaw in the above argument?

- ☐ A. There is no causal conclusion drawn in this argument because it simply describes a position involving causal reasoning.
- ☐ B. The evidence given to support the conclusion actually undermines it.
- ☐ C. It proceeds as if a condition, which by itself is enough to guarantee a certain result, is the only condition under which that result would occur.
- ☐ D. It explains one event as being caused by another event, even though both events must actually have been caused by some third, unidentified event.

14.

A necessary condition is a condition that must be present for an event to occur. X is a *necessary condition* for Y is to say that it is impossible to have Y without X. In other words, the absence of X guarantees the absence of Y.

A sufficient condition is a condition or set of conditions that will produce the event. X is a *sufficient condition* for Y is to say that the presence of X guarantees the presence of Y. In other words, it is impossible to have X without Y. If X is present, then Y must also be present.

Which of the following examples about the necessary condition and the sufficient condition is NOT true?

- ☐ A. Completing all the requirements of your degree program is a necessary and sufficient condition for earning your degree.
- ☐ B. Regular gym-going is a sufficient but not necessary condition for keeping fit.
- ☐ C. Rain pouring from the sky is a sufficient condition for the ground to be wet.
- ☐ D. Having oxygen in the earth's atmosphere is a necessary condition for human life.

Questions 15-16 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about baseline tests. Answer the questions according to the text.

When I imagine the perfect way for a four-year-old to spend an afternoon, it chiefly involves making mud pies, eating raisins, finger painting with friends, all topped off by a much-needed afternoon nap. What it does not include is marching to Downing Street to protest against the government's education policy. Nor does it involve being subjected to a high-stakes assessment in the first six weeks of beginning school.

Yet the government's plans to reintroduce compulsory baseline assessments for four-year-olds next year mean that parents and their young children have been left with little choice but to protest. The baseline tests will supposedly assess the maths and literacy ability of children when they start school. Schools can then be held accountable for the "progress" students make from reception to year six. But the March of the Four-Year-Olds will descend on Downing Street to deliver a petition, signed by 64,000 people, demanding that the government listens to the growing evidence that these tests are both damaging and unnecessary.

First and foremost, the baseline tests will be prone to the same distortions that make existing high-stakes accountability assessments so unreliable. Schools will have an incentive to keep scores low on the test in order to show greater progress later on. Not only that, but extensive evidence has shown that testing very young children produces inconsistent outcomes depending on how a child might feel on that day. It is little wonder that a YouGov (a world-leading online market research company) poll showed that 74% of primary leaders feel the baseline tests are an unreliable way to measure a child's progress.

To make matters worse, the baseline tests serve no educational purpose whatsoever; teachers and parents don't even get to see the results! As a teacher, I use assessment in order to gather information about what my students know in order to adapt future planning. I could not teach without rich information about my students' abilities, interests and motivations. But the baseline test is for accountability, not assessment. With reports from the initial pilot revealing children crying and disoriented during the tests, this accountability mechanism certainly isn't worth the potential damage it causes to our youngest students.

Teachers and schools want to be held accountable. Receiving feedback and honing our craft is a vital part of teaching. But teachers want to be held accountable for the things that matter—not just the things that can be easily measured in a standardised test. The baseline assessments will only assess literacy and maths, in spite of convincing evidence that spoken language, play and playfulness, and "self-regulation" are far better predictors of later academic achievement.

As any parent knows, a child's first few weeks at school can be distressing, but getting it right can sow the seeds for a love of learning that can carry on through school and into adulthood. A child's first experiences at school should be full of awe and imaginative possibility in a caring, collaborative environment. In our troubled world, extending this period of creative wonder for as long as possible is the greatest gift we can give to the next generation.

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15. What is the parents' demand for the four-year-olds?

- ☐ A. The government should halt the controversial plans to test children when they first start school.
- ☐ B. More reliable standardised tests should be used to find out children's later academic potential.
- ☐ C. The government should provide more evidence that denies the accusation of baseline tests.
- ☐ D. More skills and abilities should be tested in addition to the maths and literacy ability of children.

16. Which of the following is NOT a reason why the writer is against the baseline tests?

- ☐ A. School teachers cannot utilize the results for teaching purposes.
- ☐ B. The results of the tests may be subject to the children's mood.
- ☐ C. Schools may deliberately give lower scores for their own benefits.
- ☐ D. The tests will bring extra stress for children and workload for teachers.

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Questions 17-19 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

Five hundred years ago, the bouncy balls that Spanish conquistadors brought back to Europe from the Americas were just an amusing novelty. To be sure, Spanish explorers found the rubber boots, sandals, ponchos, syringes, bottles, waterproof bags, and tarpaulins made by Native Americans very useful in rainforests. Still, they were perhaps too focused on finding gold to consider the commercial possibilities of rubber itself.

Two and a half centuries later, as part of the first scientific expedition to the New World, a French naturalist named Charles-Marie La Condamine noticed the many uses of rubber in South America. He sent samples to the Royal Academy of Sciences in Paris. Then, in 1751, he presented the group with the first scientific paper on rubber. It was written by Francois Fresneau, a naval engineer La Condamine had met in French Guiana on the north coast of South America. Rubber's unique qualities soon piqued scientific curiosity.

Rubber Mania

The people who worked drawing plans for machinery or buildings were delighted to discover that rubber erased errors and smudges. A clever showman even entertained Parisians by walking across the Seine River wearing inflatable rubber shoes. Then, in December of 1783, thousands of French people watched a hydrogen balloon made of rubber-coated silk lift Jacques Charles and Noel Robert above Paris and carry them 27 miles away to a successful landing. One of the spectators was the American statesman Benjamin Franklin, who noted how useful the invention would be for wartime reconnaissance.

Rubber factories quickly sprouted in France, Austria, Scotland, the United States, and elsewhere. Everything rubber, especially shoes, became the latest craze. Elastic replaced wires in garters, suspenders, and gloves. Rainwear, perfected by the Scottish inventor Charles Macintosh, was such a best seller that his name lives on in Britain as the word for "raincoat." The English inventor Thomas Hancock supplied airbeds and life preservers for Sir John Franklin's second polar expedition in 1825.

But, there was a problem. The climate of northern Europe and northeastern United States is not rubber-friendly. Shoes and garments would turn gummy in hot weather and brittle in cold. Worse, rubber smelled. As a result, the mania for rubber cooled. But Charles Goodyear, an inventor and hardware store owner in New England, did not give up.

Vulcanization

Goodyear was so dedicated to finding a way to make rubber more stable that he worked on his experiments while in the debtor's prison. When he was released, he lived off the charity of friends. In 1839, he accidentally spilled some rubber that had been treated with sulfur on a hot stove. Although charred, it retained its shape and elasticity. Plus, it was not at all sticky. Goodyear worked another five years to determine the ideal mixture, heat, and time needed to bring about this miraculous change in rubber. In 1844, he received the United States patent for his invention. His process was later named vulcanization, after Vulcan, the Roman god of fire.

Indispensable!

Vulcanized rubber opened the way to countless uses: tires for smoother carriage rides, bumpers for railway cars, insulation for transmitting electrical current, and surgical tools. By the 1880s, the spreading use of electricity was making rubber indispensable.

Three other inventions added major new markets for rubber. First came bicycles, which appeared on the market in England in 1872. By the 1880s, cycling was **all the rage** across Europe and the United States. Rubber companies took note. Pirelli in Italy, Michelin in France, the Goodyear Company (named for the deceased inventor) in Akron, Ohio, and Dunlop in Great Britain, all began by making bicycle tires. In 1887, Dunlop pioneered pneumatic tires, with air-filled rubber tubes inside. These were soon used on all bicycles. Next came the internal combustion engine. In 1895, when a competition in France pitted 30 entrants in a 732-mile loop from Paris to Bordeaux and back, the automobile age was launched. In 1901, the first aircraft propelled by an internal combustion engine made headlines. The ensuing growth of the aircraft industry required even more rubber tires and engine parts.

17. What does the subtitle "Rubber Mania" probably mean?

- ☐ A. the obsession with rubber
- ☐ B. practical aspects of rubber
- ☐ C. the refinement of rubber
- ☐ D. natural rubber technology

18. What does the phrase ***all the rage*** in the last paragraph probably mean?

- ☐ A. a widespread temporary enthusiasm
- ☐ B. a strong disapproval of something
- ☐ C. a target of a violent uncontrollable anger
- ☐ D. a visionary marvelous invention

19. Which of the following is NOT true according to the text?

- ☐ A. The use of electricity with other inventions made rubber increasingly important in many fields.
- ☐ B. Native Americans were able to make many practical rubber products far earlier than Europeans.
- ☐ C. A French naturalist wrote the first scientific paper on rubber to the Royal Academy of Sciences.
- ☐ D. The rubber products were sensitive to temperature before Goodyear found a new method.

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Questions 20-21 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about personality boundaries. Answer the questions according to the text.

A fascinating way of looking at personality differences revolves around this very concept of boundaries. The late psychiatrist Ernest Hartmann asserted that each person can be characterized on a boundary spectrum ranging from "thick" to "thin." In his words:

"There are people who strike us as very solid and well organized; they keep everything in its place. They are well defended. They seem rigid, even armored; we sometimes speak of them as 'thick-skinned.' Such people, in my view, have very thick boundaries. At the other extreme are people who are especially sensitive, open, or vulnerable. In their minds, things are relatively fluid... Such people have particularly thin boundaries... I propose thick and thin boundaries as a broad way of looking at individual differences."

Hartmann came to his conception in an interesting way. In the 1980s, he was studying people who have nightmares and noticed that they could readily recall other vivid or colorful dreams even if these didn't qualify as nightmares. Such people seemed to him especially "sensitive," "vulnerable," or "imaginative" in contrast with others who came across as more "solid," "stoic" or "persevering." He suspected there are real differences between thin and thick boundary people, and developed his Boundary Questionnaire (BQ) to gain more insight.

Since the 1980s, at least 5,000 people have taken the BQ, and more than 100 published papers have referenced it. The scores distribute in a Bell-shaped curve. Women tend to score significantly thinner than men, and older people tend to score somewhat thicker than younger people. Certain professions also seem to attract people of differing boundary types. Thin-scoring people predominate among artists, musicians, and fashion models, whereas thick-scoring people are more commonly naval officers, salespeople and lawyers.

More recent researchers have explored the similar terrain. Psychologist Elaine Aron has examined various facets of what she calls the "highly sensitive person" or HSP. Harvard professors Jerome Kagan and Nancy Snidman have pointed up the differences between "high reactive" and "low reactive" individuals. Developmental psychologist Bruce Ellis and pediatrician Thomas Boyce have differentiated "orchid" children from "dandelion" kids (the former are highly sensitive; the latter are more numerous and more hardy). And author Susan Cain touched a nerve with her popular book *Quiet*, extolling the underappreciated virtues of the introspective personality. Taken together, such investigations indicate a rising degree of interest in the biological basis of key individual differences.

Boundaries are more than a measure of introversion or extroversion, openness or closed-mindedness, agreeableness or hostility, or any other personality trait. While boundary thinness has been found to correlate strongly with openness to experience (one of the Big Five personality dimensions), Hartmann and his colleagues considered boundaries to be a broader measure—and more interesting and useful for that reason.

Boundaries allow for an assessment of the characteristic way anyone operates in the world. To what extent are stimuli kept out or let in? To what degree is a person rigid versus flexible, impassive versus excitable, self-contained versus sensitive, closed versus open?

Such terms inevitably invoke sentience, i.e., the felt basis of *self*. Although Descartes opined "I think, therefore I am," the contemporary scientific view is *Sentio, ergo sum*: I feel, therefore I am. Since consciousness derives from the *having* of sensations, and since sensation would be impossible absent a demarcated body, *self* must be based in feeling.

20. According to the text, which of the following factors could NOT help categorize people as of a thin boundary or a thick boundary?

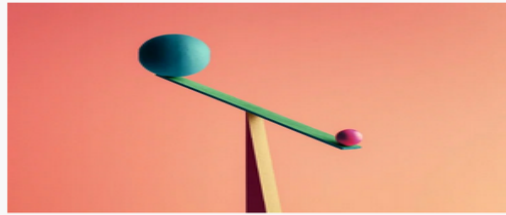
- ☐ A. age
- ☐ B. profession
- ☐ C. education
- ☐ D. gender

21. Which of the following statements about personality boundaries is true?

- ☐ A. Personality boundaries can precisely measure whether one is introverted or extroverted.
- ☐ B. The boundary concept is a broader measure to analyze an individual's personality traits.
- ☐ C. The differences between thin boundary persons and thick boundary persons are clear-cut.
- ☐ D. Personality boundaries tend to determine what personality traits a person is likely to present.

Questions 22-23 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about work-life balance. Answer the questions according to the text.



If you think about it, work-life balance is a strange aspiration for a fulfilling life. Balance is about stasis: if our lives were ever in balance—parents happy, kids taken care of, work working—then our overriding thought would be to shout “Nobody move!” and pray all would stay perfect forever. This false hope is made worse by the categories themselves. They imply that work is bad, and life is good; we lose ourselves in work but find ourselves in life; we survive work, but live life. And so the challenge, we are told, is to balance the heaviness of work with the lightness of life.

Yet work is not the opposite of life. It is instead a part of life—just as family is, as are friends and community and hobbies. All of these aspects of living have their share of wonderful, uplifting moments and their share of moments that drag us down. The same is true of work, yet when we think of it as an inherent bad in need of a counterweight, we lose sight of the possibility for better.

It seems more useful, then, to not try to balance the unbalanceable, but to treat work the same way you do life: By maximizing what you love. Here's what we mean.

Consider why two people doing exactly the same work seem to gain strength and joy from very different moments. When we interviewed several anesthesiologists, we found that while their title and job function are identical, the thrills and chills they feel in their job are not. One said he loved the thrill of holding each patient hovering at that one precise point between life and death, while he shuddered at the “pressure” of helping each patient get healthy once the operation was complete. Another said she loved the bedside conversations before the operation, and the calm sensitivity required to bring a sedated patient gently back to consciousness without the panic that afflicts many patients. Another was drawn mostly to the intricacies of the anesthetic mechanism itself and has dedicated herself to defining precisely how each drug does what it does. Each one of us, for no good reason other than the clash of our chromosomes, draws strength from different activities, situations, moments and interactions.

Think of your life's many different activities as threads. Some are black, some are grey and some are white. But some of these activities appear to be made of a different substance. These activities contain all the tell-tale signs of love: before you do them, you find yourself looking forward to them; while you're doing them, time speeds up and you find yourself in flow; and after you've done them, you feel invigorated. These are your red threads, and research by the Mayo Clinic suggests that doctors who weave the fabric of their life with at least 20% red threads are significantly less likely to experience burnout.

The simplest way for you to do this is to spend a week in love with your job. This sounds odd, but all it really means is to select a regular week at work and take a pad around with you for the entire week. Down the middle of this pad, draw a vertical line to make two columns, and write “Loved It” at the top of one column and “Loathed It” at the top of the other. During the week, any time you find yourself feeling one of the signs of love, scribble down exactly what you were doing in the “Loved It” column. And any time you find yourself feeling the inverse—before you do something, you procrastinate; while you do it, time drags; and when you're done with it, you hope you never have to do it again—scribble down exactly what you were doing in the “Loathed It” column.

Obviously, there'll be plenty of activities in your week that don't make either list, but if you spend a week in love with your work, by the end of the week you will see a list of activities in your “Loved It” column that feel different to you than the rest of your work. They'll have a different emotional valence, creating in you a distinct and distinctly positive feeling, one that draws you in and lifts you up.

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22. What is the main purpose of the text?

- ☐ A. To investigate the relationship between work and life.
- ☐ B. To show the downside of work-related stress.
- ☐ C. To explain why work and life cannot be balanced.
- ☐ D. To give advice on how to find love in work and life.

23. What is the author's attitude toward work-life balance?

- ☐ A. Work is part of life, so work as hard as possible and live life to the fullest.
- ☐ B. Strength and joy we gain from work can contribute to work-life balance.
- ☐ C. Work-life balance is an aspiration for us to live a fulfilling life.
- ☒ D. Maximize what you love in work and life and minimize what you hate in them.

Questions 24-25 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: Read the abstract for the article "The impact of global English on motivation to learn other languages: Toward an ideal multilingual self". Answer the questions according to the text.

In 2006, Graddol predicted that numbers of "English as a foreign language" learners would begin to decline through the second decade of this century, as global English achieves basic skill status for children entering education in more societies across the world. As he further noted, having skills in additional languages may thus offer a competitive edge in a global job market where English skills have become commonplace, and where monolingual and even bilingual English speakers may lose out to multilingual competitors. As yet, however, the extent to which the spread of global English may motivate individuals to diversify their language skills beyond English ____24____. Rather, both empirical evidence and commonly held perceptions would seem to endorse the view that global English tends to impact negatively on motivation to learn other languages, despite the growing linguistic and cultural diversity of today's societies. This article critically analyses this impact on motivation from two perspectives. First, from a macro-sociological perspective, it explores the tensions among language globalization, multiculturalism, and multilingualism in today's changing social world and examines the mixed messages communicated for language education in general and for language learners in particular. In so doing, it considers the socially distributed nature of motivation at the level of societal multilingualism and educational policy and practice, and the impact of the social on the individual. Second, from a theoretical perspective, the article considers whether the impact of global English on motivation to learn other languages might be more positively construed by shifting away from SLA (second language acquisition) frames of reference (concerned with progression toward proficiency in a particular language) in favour of a "linguistic multi-competence" framework, defined by Cook (2016) as the overall system of a mind or community that uses more than one language. As the article concludes, an important pedagogical implication would be a focus on multilingual (rather than second language) speakers as the normative model of communication and instruction, and the associated promotion of ideal multilingual selves.

24. Which of the following best fits in the blank in the text?

- ☐ A. seems limited
- ☐ B. becomes larger
- ☐ C. remains unclear
- ☐ D. is underestimated

25. Who are mostly likely to be interested in this article?

- ☐ A. International job hunters.
- ☐ B. Native English speakers.
- ☐ C. English learners.
- ☐ D. Education policy makers.

Questions 26-30 (Suggested completion time: 8 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about the hepatitis B virus. Answer the questions according to the text.

The hepatitis B virus has been infecting people since at least the Bronze Age, according to a new study by geneticists who teased the virus from 4500-year-old human remains.

Hepatitis B was discovered in the 1960s, and a vaccine (and Nobel Prize) came swiftly thereafter.

Despite the vaccine, the virus still kills people, and chronic infections cannot be cured. Nearly 900,000 people with the virus died in 2015, mostly from liver complications, according to the World Health Organization. An estimated 257 million people carry the virus that targets the liver and can be a risk factor for cancer.

Wayward viral particles in the blood also catch in teeth and bones. In some ancient humans, the virus became entombed in these hard materials — until researchers cracked open the samples and sequenced the DNA strands inside.

The study authors examined 304 samples of humans from Europe and Asia, who lived between 200 and 7000 years ago, to look for hepatitis B DNA.

Researchers found matches for the virus in the remains of 25 people, including in the bones of a warrior buried in a mass grave in Mongolia.

From these sequences, the researchers generated 12 hepatitis B genomes. These are the oldest viral genomes recovered from human or vertebrate samples, the authors said. (Though evolutionary biologist Hendrik Poinar, a professor at Canada's McMaster University, who was not involved in this study, predicted this superlative "won't stand too long".)

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The team found 12 ancient hepatitis B genomes, including a now-extinct type of the virus. To get the genetic sequences, the researchers had to do the molecular equivalent of a dumpster dive.

"We have screened what we normally call the waste product," study co-author Eske Willerslev, an evolutionary geneticist at the University of Copenhagen in Denmark, told reporters on May 8, 2018.

The scientists used a technique called shotgun sequencing, which shreds long strands of DNA at random (as if blasted by shotgun pellets) and clones the fragments.

Thanks to the high volume of DNA, geneticists can stitch together an organism's genome. But the shotgun process churns out plenty of non-human DNA, courtesy of long-dead infections and other contamination, which Willerslev and his colleagues typically ignored.

"But now we have started investigating this waste product," he said.

The viruses were not trapped alive in the bones. "Just to make it crystal clear, the sequences of viruses that we find are highly fragmented," said Barbara Muhlemann, a Ph.D student at the University of Cambridge and the lead author of the study, published in the journal *Nature*.

There is "absolutely no danger" that someone could contract ancient hepatitis by touching a skeleton, she said.

Poinar said the technology to perform this work existed for about five years, but it took the right samples to achieve these results.

"I think this is the real benefit to ancient DNA," he said. Scientists can now detect the presence of "key viral genomes at specific points in time" without other physical evidence for a virus's existence. Previously, hunts for ancient viruses often began with the examination of lesions on human remains, as was the case of a 500-year-old pock-marked mummy in Italy found to have hepatitis B.

Ancient viral genomes give scientists rough histories of infection. These histories can strengthen hypotheses or discard them, Willerslev pointed out. There had been speculation hepatitis B originated in the New World and spread to Europe about 500 years ago. That idea is "certainly wrong," he said, given the samples' age.

"It looks like several of the ancient hepatitis B viruses occurred in different geographical regions than their closest modern relatives," said Alexander Suh, an evolutionary biologist at Uppsala University in Sweden who was not a part of this study. "This provides a glimpse into how the geographic distribution of this disease agent has changed over time."

Some versions of the ancient hepatitis virus still infect humans. Another died out. "One of the really cool things is it shows the presence of genotypes that are no longer circulating today - that is, they have gone extinct. We'd expect this," Poinar said, "but to see it is really neat."

Willerslev said this work was the start of a catalogue of known "possible mutations" for the hepatitis B virus.

Ancient strains may or may not appear again, he said, but knowledge of the virus' past adaptations might aid scientists trying predict how hepatitis will mutate in the future.



26. What can we know according to the evolutionary biologist Hendrik Poinar?

- ☐ A. New mutations of hepatitis B virus would very much likely to be found in the future.
- ☐ B. Hepatitis B genomes older than that of the new study would be found in the future.
- ☐ C. The new findings on hepatitis B genomes would be proved wrong in the future.
- ☐ D. More hepatitis B genomes, rather than 12, would be inspected in the future.

27. Which of the following is true about the shotgun sequencing technique?

- ☐ A. It can trap DNA at random.
- ☐ B. It's a technique that has existed for decades.
- ☐ C. It shreds long strands of non-human DNA into fragments.
- ☒ D. It works through a combined method of separation and cloning.

28-30 Decide whether the following statements about hepatitis B are True or False.

28. Thanks to the vaccine, the chronic infections of hepatitis B can be cured.

- ☐ A. True
- ☐ B. False

29. The new study confirmed that hepatitis B originated in the New World and spread to Europe.

- ☐ A. True
- ☐ B. False

30. According to the text, the participants of the study included Barbara Muhlemann and Eske Willerslev.

- ☐ A. True
- ☐ B. False

Questions 31-40 (Suggested completion time: 35 minutes)

Directions: Read three passages about evolution. Answer the questions according to the passages.

Passage A

Sir David Attenborough: Humans have stopped evolving

Human beings have stopped evolving after becoming the only species to "put halt to natural selection of its own free will", Sir David Attenborough has said, as he predicts the "cultural evolution" of the future.

Sir David Attenborough (English broadcaster and naturalist), whose new show concentrates on the ascent of man, said he believed humans had now stopped evolving in physical terms, after developing means to keep even the weakest of the species alive.

Saying we are now able to rear up to 99 per cent of our babies, he added people were no longer subject to Darwinian theories' natural selection.

Instead, he proposed, humans would continue to develop in a cultural sense; inheriting knowledge from previous generations and building upon it. **[A]**

In an interview with the *Radio Times* in September 2013, Sir David said: "I think that we've stopped evolving.

"Because if natural selection, as proposed by Darwin, is the main mechanism of evolution — there may be other things, but it does look as though that's the case — then we've stopped natural selection.

"We stopped natural selection as soon as we started being able to rear 95-99 per cent of our babies that are born.

"[B]"

Sir David, who presented *Rise of Animals* on BBC2 in 2013, added: "Stopping natural selection is not as important, or as depressing, as it might sound — because our evolutionary process is now cultural.

"Humans have a great cultural inheritance as well as a physical, genetic inheritance — we can inherit a knowledge of computers or television, electronics, airplanes and so on.

"Each generation has got all these books that tell them these things, so our cultural evolution is proceeding with extraordinary swiftness."

He also insisted he was grateful to live in the modern day, saying that things were likely to get worse with future generations looking back "at a world that was less crowded, full of natural wonders, and healthier."

Passage B

Lots of readers have asked me to react to this *Telegraph* article: "Sir David Attenborough: Humans have stopped evolving":

We stopped natural selection as soon as we started being able to rear 95-99 per cent of our babies that are born.

We are the only species to have put a halt to natural selection, of its own free will, as it were.

Well, obviously he's wrong. **[C]**

First, should we discount the rapid evolution of the last 10,000 years? My post from several years ago describes this finding ("How human evolution accelerated").

Admittedly, many of the ecological factors that were important in that time frame are no longer selecting in the same way on human populations. It's not obvious, for example, that milk drinking is correlated with higher offspring number in today's industrialized societies, or that the speed of starch breakdown in saliva has anything to do with survival today.

But malaria does. It remains the top pathogen for human misery in the world, killing millions every year and debilitating many, many more. More than two dozen genes in human populations have common alleles that help to protect against malaria, from the well-known (sickle-cell) to the obscure (*FLT1*). Natural selection is mercilessly maintaining them in human populations. For some of these genes, natural selection is maintaining an equilibrium, with deaths from malaria balancing deaths in homozygotes who carry a harmful genotype. Even populations where malaria has been eradicated in the last hundred years, like the United States, still suffer natural selection on some of these genes. The sickle-cell allele has been declining in frequency among African Americans for the last hundred years, as a result of selection against the sickle allele in homozygotes.

People who talk about “natural selection stopping” in humans are usually forgetting about most of the world.

They're also forgetting about the other side of selection's two-faced coin: fertility. Not having children, or not bringing a pregnancy to term, allow selection just as death does. Fertility differences have become marked in today's industrialized societies, as people delay starting families into their 30s or 40s, or decide not to have children at all.

The Framingham study, in the town of Framingham, Massachusetts, is one of several that have examined phenotypes in large samples of people for long enough to examine fitness outcomes. Measure somebody when young, wait a long time, and see how many children they had. This is a measure of fitness, one that does not ignore the fertility component.

As studied by Stephen Stearns and colleagues, such studies have shown consistent and strong evidence for natural selection in the populations of the last fifty years. From a 2010 review paper *Stearns: 2010*:

These studies report three striking findings. First, both women and men are under selection for earlier age at first birth in both pre-industrial, natural fertility populations and in post-industrial populations. Second, women are under selection for later age at last birth in a pre-industrial population and later age at menopause in two post-industrial populations. Third, women are under selection for increased height in one pre-industrial population and for decreased height in three post-industrial populations.

And about saliva, above, I wrote “not obvious” because correlations between fitness and diet-related genes today in human populations are not inconceivable. For example, the Framingham study showed that weight in American women has been positively selected over the last 50 years, while blood glucose level has been under stabilizing selection — extreme high and low blood sugar levels having fewer offspring. No one has yet investigated whether salivary amylase or lactase affect either phenotype in Americans today. Both phenotypes are heritable in this population, meaning that some additive variation in genes underlies the total variation. Maybe someday we'll learn which genes are involved.

The next phase of human genetics will see the sequencing of hundreds of thousands of genomes. The UK has already embarked upon a project to acquire more than 100,000 genomes, and we can anticipate the addition of genetic sampling to vast long-term health studies in other nations. These studies are intended to discover associations between rare alleles and disease traits. Their huge sample size means that they will be much more powerful in identifying correlations between alleles and fitness than we have for any population in nature. We will begin to see an unparalleled picture of evolution in action, in human societies, now.

What will this do for our concept of humanity?

I expect it will be an enormous opportunity for biology education, and for anthropology. The traits that make a difference to selection are not typically the ones that matter to the health of 70-year-olds. [D] What we prioritize, the way we shape our lives, affects the evolutionary future of our species — maybe in surprising ways.

Passage C

The goblin shark, duck-billed platypus, lungfish, tadpole shrimp, cockroach, coelacanths and the horseshoe crab — these creatures are famous in the world of biology, because they look as though they stopped evolving long ago. To use a term introduced by Charles Darwin in 1859, they are “living fossils”. And to their ranks, some have added humans, based on the idea that technology and modern medicine has, for all intents and purposes, eliminated natural selection by allowing most infants to live to reproductive age and pass on their genes.

It may be tempting to conclude from the sharks, horseshoe crabs and other creatures that evolution does often stop, and that Darwin's “living fossil” term makes sense. But such a conclusion would be wrong.

Some argue that Darwin never intended the phrase to be used seriously. “The term is over-simplifying and leads to people believing that some things haven't evolved, which is so wrong,” noted Africa Gómez, a biologist at Hull University in the United Kingdom who led a genetic analysis of the tadpole shrimp that in 2013 demonstrated that this “living fossil” is no fossil at all. “They have been evolving non-stop and speciating and radiating, so why on earth are they called living fossils?”

The same is true if one looks closely at the other “living fossils”. They are all evolving, humans included. This is partially because there is more to biology than meets the eye, with things changing constantly at the cellular and biochemical level. But it's also because Darwin's watershed discovery, natural selection, known in popular language as “survival of the fittest” is not the only evolutionary force.

Death prior to reaching reproductive age and lack of reproductive capability are not the only factors controlling biological change. Mathematics also plays a role here. Keep the environmental conditions the same around a biological group, remove selective pressures, but mess with the numbers of individuals in a population, and evolution still happens. [E]

31. Which of the following statements is NOT Sir David's opinion, according to Passage A?

- ☐ A. Humans are still evolving only in terms of culture.
- ☐ B. Humankind has reached to its peak in natural evolution.
- ☐ C. Nature selection is no longer effective for human beings.
- ☐ D. Nature selection has been replaced by some artificial methods.

32. Sir David in Passage A is most probably _____ about the future life of human beings.

- ☐ A. optimistic
- ☐ B. worried
- ☐ C. skeptical
- ☐ D. neutral

33. What is true about malaria according to Passage B?

- ☐ A. It is the most deadly disease for all species throughout history.
- ☐ B. Humans can be protected from malaria through certain genes.
- ☐ C. It has killed millions especially among African Americans.
- ☐ D. The emergence of it is one of the results of natural selection.

34. What can we learn from the Framingham study in Passage B?

- ☐ A. It has made prominent findings on the changes of human fertility.
- ☐ B. It has found the relations between fitness and diet-related genes.
- ☐ C. It helps prove that natural selection has not stopped in human evolution.
- ☐ D. It involves large enough samples to identify the genes that cause diseases.

35-36 Decide whether the statements are True or False according to Passages A and B.

35. The author of Passage B argues against Sir David's opinion by quoting scientific findings.

- ☐ A. True
- ☐ B. False

36. Both Sir David and the author of Passage B agree that nature selection is the sole force in evolution.

- ☐ A. True
- ☐ B. False

37. What can be learned about "living fossils" according to Passage C?

- ☐ A. It is a term coined by Charles Darwin who has never used it seriously.
- ☐ B. It has been proved by Africa Gómez that there is no such thing in the world.
- ☐ C. Some think humans are "living fossils" because they have stopped evolving.
- ☐ D. Living fossils are decreasing because many of them had been extinct long ago.

38. Which of the following is NOT a sign of evolution according to Passage C?

- ☐ A. Survival of the fittest.
- ☐ B. Death before puberty.
- ☐ C. Intervention of the population.
- ☐ D. Removal of selective pressure.

39-40 There are five blanks in the three passages. Where do the following statements most fit?

39. Living things evolve, whether you see it on the surface or not. _____ 39 _____

40. We are the only species to have put a halt to natural selection, of its own free will, as it were. _____ 40 _____

Question 41 (Suggested completion time: 40 minutes)

Directions: Read the following two excerpts. Excerpt A is from *Key Concepts in Chinese Thought and Culture*. Excerpt B is from *A Short History of Chinese Philosophy* by Feng Youlan. Write a short essay according to the two excerpts.

Excerpt A

The original meaning of *li* (理) was the texture of jade; later it was extended to contain three meanings: 1) the physical forms or proprieties of things, such as length, size, shape, tensile strength, weight, and color; 2) the universal laws followed by all things and beings; and 3) the original source or ontological existence of things. The last two meanings are similar to those of Dao. Scholars of the Song and Ming dynasties were particularly interested in describing and explaining the philosophy known as *li*, and considered it as the highest realm, giving rise to the School of Principle which dominated academic thought in the period from the Song to the Ming dynasties.

Excerpt B

Whereas Chu Hsi endorses Ch'eng Yi's saying that "the nature is *li*," Lu Chiu-yüan replies that "the mind is *li*." The two sayings differ only by one word, yet in them lies the fundamental division between the two schools. ... the mind, in Chu Hsi's system, is conceived of as the concrete embodiment of *li* as found in *qi* (气)*; hence it is not the same as the abstract *li* itself. Chu Hsi, consequently, can only say that the nature is *li*, but not that the mind is *li*. But in Lu Chiu-yüan's system, on the contrary, the mind itself is the nature, and he considers the presumed distinction between nature and mind as nothing more than a verbal one. Regarding such verbal distinctions, he says: "Scholars of today devote most of their time to the explanation of words. For instance, such words as feeling, nature, mind, and ability all mean one and the same thing. It is only accidental that a single entity is denoted by different terms."

*** Notes:**

1. *Qi* has a material existence independent of subjective consciousness and is the basic element of all physical beings. It is also the basis for the birth and existence of life and spirit. ... Although things in liquid or solid form are different from things in air form, from the perspective of the ancient Chinese philosophy, their formation and existence are the results of the concentration of *qi*.

2. Chu Hsi: 朱熹

Ch'eng Yi: 程颐

Lu Chiu-yüan: 陆九渊

41. Write a short essay of about 300 words based on your understanding of the excerpts. Remember to write in your OWN words. Your essay should respond to the following questions:

- 1) Which meaning of *li* in Excerpt A is discussed in Excerpt B?
- 2) How are the two sayings about *li* in Excerpt B different from each other? What are the main disagreements between Chu Hsi and Lu Chiu-yüan?
- 3) What do you think is *li*?

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2019 阅读大赛复赛 2

Questions 1-3 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the following quotes. Match the quotes with the people. Please note there are two extra options you do not need.

- A. Henry David Thoreau
- B. Robert Burns
- C. Martin Luther King, Jr.
- D. Benjamin Franklin
- E. Jack London

1. 1

Life is not a matter of holding good cards, but sometimes, playing a poor hand well.

2. 2

I went to the woods because I wished to live deliberately, to front only the essential facts of life, and see if I could not learn what it had to teach, and not, when I came to die, discover that I had not lived.

3. 3

Human progress is neither automatic nor inevitable... Every step toward the goal of justice requires sacrifice, suffering, and struggle; the tireless exertions and passionate concern of dedicated individuals.

Question 4 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

According to one scholarly definition, something is humorous if people cognitively appraise it as funny, if it creates "the positive emotion of amusement," or if it produces laughter. But while the average adult laughs 18 times a day, laughter isn't a reliable indicator. Researchers found only 10 to 20 percent of remarks that prompted laughter to be remotely funny.

One general theory holds that we are amused when we are made to feel superior to others. Sigmund Freud, for his part, suggested that forbidden things are hilarious (because humor is a pressure valve for repressive psychic energy). Yet another approach, pioneered by Kant and Schopenhauer and affirmed by Henny Youngman, sees humor as arising from incongruity: When conventions are undermined by an absurd situation, we're tickled.

4. What can we learn from this text?

- ☐ A. Theories about humor date back to decades ago.
- ☐ B. Laughter is a dependable indicator of humor.
- ☐ C. Two theories about humor are mentioned in the text.
- ☐ D. Humor is not always a positive emotion.

Question 5 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Perched high in a California redwood, engineer Topher White tests an audio recorder that could _____ in the world's threatened rainforests. His design uses discarded cellphones, reprogrammed to listen to the forest, allowing for the sonic detection of chain saws. Using cellular service that White says is surprisingly widespread in many rainforests, the solar-powered phones can connect officials, conservation groups and researchers to the real-time sounds made by logging crews. Rainforest Connection, the non-profit group that White leads, says it has installed more than 100 such devices on five continents.

5. Which of the following best fits the blank in the text?

- ☐ A. record various sounds
- ☐ B. raise more public concern
- ☐ C. apply advanced technology
- ☐ D. help stop illegal logging

Question 6 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

MOON! EARTH'S BEST FRIEND begins with the narrator, the moon, explaining that the moon and Earth have been together since a space rock crashed into "baby Earth" about 4.5 billion years ago and created a big mess. "Pieces of rock, chunks of Earth, and even lava were blasted into space. This crash trash came together to make ME!" The moon goes on to tell all sorts of facts about the moon and Earth, including their relative sizes, strengths of gravity, the moon's phases and effect on Earth's tides, how solar and lunar eclipses work, and more.

6. Where is the text most probably taken from?

- ☐ A. A documentary recommendation
- ☐ B. A science fiction
- ☐ C. A book review
- ☐ D. A film script

Question 7 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.



Fifth-generation wireless technology, known as 5G, could significantly decrease reliance on physical networking hardware and give companies quicker and easier access to applications in the cloud, the head of an enterprise networking community said on May 7, 2018.

"5G plays into (companies') hybrid and multi-cloud strategies," said Nick Lippis, co-founder and co-chairman of ONUG, a group of IT leaders that advocate for creating open networking standards. "It's a much more streamlined way to access information and IT."

Widespread deployment of 5G, the expected next step after today's 4G LTE wireless technology, could cut corporate spending on physical infrastructure as firms connect wirelessly to cloud services, Mr. Lippis said. The technology would speed access to cloud applications and free up IT departments to focus on orchestration, application development, network monitoring and security, he said.

7. What advantage does NOT 5G have over 4G technology according to the text?

- ☐ A. Quicker access to cloud services.
- ☐ B. Less reliance on networking hardware.
- ☐ C. Easier wireless connection.
- ☐ D. Higher networking standards.

Question 8 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Every winter, flu season rolls around. Ads telling you to get your flu shot show up everywhere. Vaccination may not seem that important. _____. _____. _____. _____. Not only can they protect you, but they also limit your ability to spread the infection to vulnerable people around you.

①But influenza is more than just a bad cold.

②Getting a flu shot makes sense even for people at low risk, however.

③Those most at risk of side effects (including death) are the very young and very old.

④In the United States alone, it can kill several thousand people in any given year—and sometimes tens of thousands.

8. Read the four numbered sentences and fill them in the blanks in the right order.

- ☐ A. ①④③②
- ☐ B. ②③④①
- ☐ C. ①③④②
- ☐ D. ②④③①

Question 9 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.



3D printing of food works much like 3D printing of other materials in that layers of raw material are deposited to build up a final product. In addition to offering customized food options, the ability to 3D print food at home or on an industrial scale could greatly reduce food waste and the cost involved with storage and transportation. It might also help meet the rapidly increasing food needs of a growing world population.

In a new study, the researchers used a prototype 3D printer to create food with microstructures that replicated the physical properties and nanoscale texture they observed in actual food samples. They also demonstrated that their platform and optimized methods can turn carbohydrate and protein powders into food with microstructures that can be tuned to control food texture and how the food is absorbed by the body.

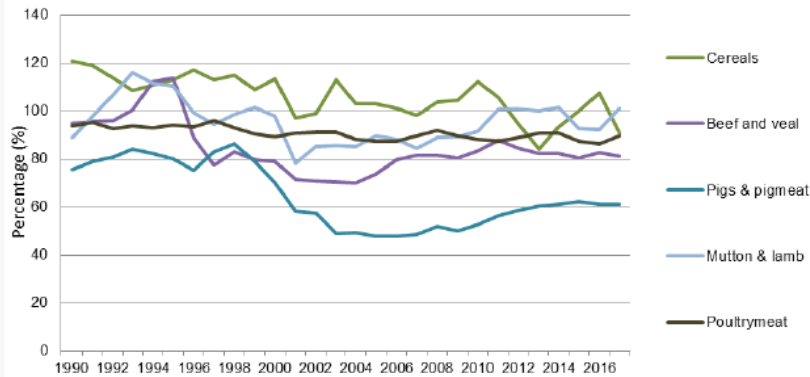
9. What do we know about 3D printed food according to the text?

- ☐ A. They could be exactly the same as real food.
- ☐ B. They can satisfy the demand for food all around the world.
- ☐ C. They can customize food texture and body absorption.
- ☐ D. They can be stored and transported more easily.

Question 10 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

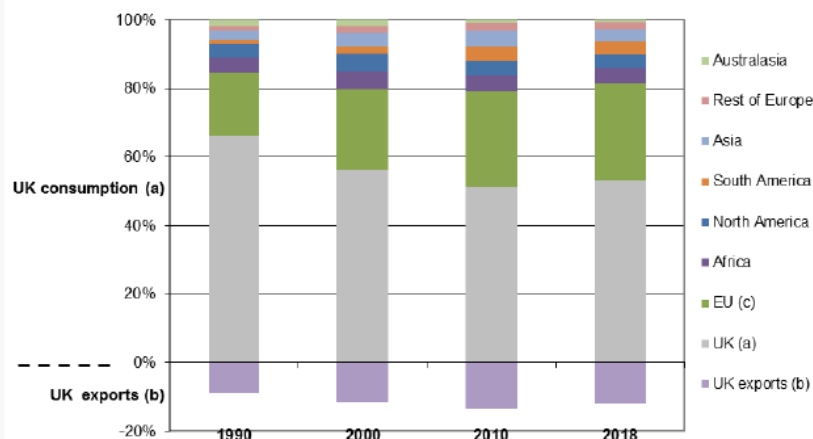
Directions: The two figures show UK domestic demand and production of agricultural products from the year 1990 to 2018. Answer the question according to the figures.

UK production to supply ratio ("self sufficiency") in key commodities



Note, measures of production to new supply ratio for commodities shown are volume based, whilst headline measure of production to supply ratio in all food is a value at the farm-gate measure. Source: Defra, Agriculture in the UK

Origin of food consumed in the UK: 1990, 2000, 2010 and 2018



Based on the farm-gate value of raw food

(a) Consumption of UK origin consists of UK domestic production minus UK exports

(b) UK exports are given as a percentage of total UK consumption.

Source: Defra, Agriculture in the UK

10. Which of the following is an INCORRECT description of the figures?

- ☐ A. The EU has basically been the largest supplier of imported food for the UK.
- ☐ B. The UK production of poultrymeat has maintained a relatively stable supply ratio.
- ☐ C. Overall, agricultural production of key commodities has fallen since the year 1990.
- ☐ D. The food demand in the UK has been rising while the domestic production has been falling.

Question 11 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the following text. Answer the question according to the text.

The seriousness of a punishment should match the seriousness of the crime. Right now, the punishment for drunk driving may simply be a fine. But drunk driving is a very serious crime that can kill innocent people. So the death penalty should be the punishment for drunk driving.

11. Which of the following logical fallacies does the text illustrate?

- ☐ A. **Straw man:** The arguer sets up a weaker version of the opponent's position and seeks to prove the watered-down version rather than the position the opponent actually holds.
- ☐ B. **Hasty generalization:** The arguer makes assumptions about a whole group or range of cases based on a sample that is inadequate (usually because it is atypical or too small).
- ☐ C. **Weak analogy:** Many arguments rely on an analogy between two or more objects, ideas, or situations. If the two things that are being compared aren't really alike in the relevant respects, the analogy is a weak one, and the argument that relies on it commits the fallacy of weak analogy.
- ☐ D. **Missing the point:** The premises of an argument do support a particular conclusion, but not the conclusion that the arguer actually draws.

Question 12 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the following text. Answer the question according to the text.

In Beijing, there is a 10-year-old who plays the piano as beautifully as Beethoven. In Xi'an, a 19-year-old genius is getting her PhD in nuclear physics. China's youth is certainly something of which we can be proud.

12. Which of the following logical fallacies does the text illustrate?

- ☐ A. **Line Drawing Fallacy:** A fallacy defined as rejecting a claim that is not precise but instead vague, yet not hopelessly vague.
- ☐ B. **Is-Ought Fallacy:** A fallacy which occurs when a conclusion expressing what ought to be so is inferred from premises expressing only what is so, in which it is supposed that no implicit or explicit ought-premises are needed.
- ☐ C. **Ignoring a Common Cause:** A fallacy that happens when someone believes that one thing caused another, without considering another factor that could have caused both things.
- ☐ D. **Misleading Vividness:** A fallacy in which a very small number of particularly dramatic events are taken to outweigh a significant amount of statistical evidence.

Questions 13-14 Reasoning (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

13.

In an effort to curb drug abuse, the government has imposed strict laws to prosecute the dealers. However, such an initiative is unlikely to be effective. Prosecuting dealers will lead to a shortage of drugs. At the same time, because no efforts are being taken to curb demand, drugs will be sold at a premium, attracting more people to the very remunerative job of drug dealing. Therefore, to effectively reduce drug abuse, the government will have to prosecute the drug users and not dealers.

Which of the following is the most relevant information in evaluating the credibility of the argument?

- ☐ A. Whether the majority of the users will be willing to pay a premium to continue to use the drugs.
- ☐ B. Whether drugs will continue to be sold at a premium when there are dealers in the market again.
- ☐ C. Whether the payoff from selling drugs outweighs the severity of the punishment.
- ☐ D. Whether efforts have been successfully taken in any other country to regulate drug users.

14.

It seems that medical care is constantly improving and is far better today than it was a few years ago. New medicines are being developed, and at a lower cost. Technological advancements are being made and new treatments are devised. However, hospital care has not improved as much as expected. Most hospitals do not have a large enough emergency room that can handle a sudden influx of patients and the number of people who die in a hospital due to reasons other than what they got admitted for is staggeringly high.

All of the following underscore the author's argument EXCEPT _____

- ☐ A. A number of doctors in private hospitals are not held accountable by the administration for the loss of patients.
- ☐ B. Doctors in most private hospitals have performance appraisals based on how much money they have brought in for the hospital rather than based on how effectively they treated patients.
- ☐ C. Most hospitals recirculate air and therefore, it is very easy for some fatal diseases to spread through the hospital.
- ☐ D. In smaller cities, the ambulance service is on a voluntary basis and the response time for calls is much lower than the national average, leading to a higher loss of life.

Questions 15-17 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about simpler spellings. Answer the questions according to the text.

The complexity of English spellings has been bothering people for nearly as long as English has been written down. They argue that inconsistent spellings make English unnecessarily hard to learn. The English Spelling Society, a UK organisation pushing for easier spellings, even argues that there's a link between difficult spelling and higher crime, with illiteracy pushing people into a life of illegality. While that argument might be a stretch, it's clear that non-traditional spelling does create a bad impression.

Compared to the UK variants, US spellings are easier for non-native speakers to learn, being shorter and slightly more phonetic. These US spellings are a legacy of dictionary pioneer Noah Webster's movement for simplified spelling. This movement sought to cleanse English of double and silent letters, as well as other inefficiencies related to orthography (the system of writing and spelling words).

In the US, the dictionary pioneer Noah Webster wasn't the first or last to propose radical reform of English spellings. Fans of simplified spelling across the centuries have included prominent figures like Benjamin Franklin, who advocated for an "alfabet" without the letter "X", and Theodore Roosevelt, who was mocked for attempting to adopt recommended changes like turning "phoenix" into "fenix".

But Webster was influential where most were largely ignored. His ideas led to the proliferation in the US of "labor" over "labour" and "center" over "centre", even if not all his ideas have become the "fashion". For one thing, English is such an irregular language that it's impossible to iron out all the kinks. No form of English is written out completely phonetically, as anybody with a tough cough (tuf cawf?) will know. Any new spelling rules would need plenty of exceptions.

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Overall, English's erratic spellings bear witness to the many words it has absorbed from other languages. Like the wealth of accents among English speakers, this feature both enriches the language and poses a challenge to standardised simplified spellings. Thus there's never been a critical mass of linguists or the general public supporting massive spelling reform.

Webster's ideas are perhaps newly relevant, as the language of IT and the Internet increasingly influences how English is written. Globally, Google returns more results for US spellings. In computing, "program" is generally accepted over "programme". Shorter words are more versatile in text messages and social media posts, and search engine optimisation often favours US spellings. The Googleisation (or "Googlization") of the Internet is one reason that Thai learners, for instance, prefer American spellings.

But the Internet is also exposing people to a large variety of spellings. So "people are representing their spoken dialects more through spelling in spaces like Twitter and Instagram", says Lauren Squires, a linguist at Ohio State University. She believes that "people are becoming more comfortable with spelling variation", even though there's a strong and enduring idea that only one spelling can be correct.

In the early days of the Internet, there were neo-Websterian attempts to rationalise English spellings as part of "netspeak". This gave the world "LOL" and some phonetic respellings, e.g. "luv u" and "cuz", though abbreviations like "hi school" haven't endured. (Of course, some of this predated online culture. Prince, that orthographic pioneer, insisted in 1984 that Nothing Compares 2 U.)

While English is too irregular to simplify its spellings as much as some proponents would like, one aspect of written English possibly being cut down by online communication is punctuation.

Full stops are now endangered in many brief instant messages, where the appearance of a full stop can give the impression of coldness or insincerity. This is partly related to line breaks in instant messages making full stops unnecessary.

As well, apostrophes may just fade away in some parts of written English as an unnecessary and time-consuming artefact. In more informal texts, they might go the way of the Oxford comma: some people using them only where needed to avoid confusion (e.g. his sister's money vs. his sisters' money).

And that will/that'll/thatll be ok.

15. Which of the following is NOT one of the characteristics of English according to the text?

- ☐ A. Spelling rules with quite some notable exceptions.
- ☐ B. Irregular rules in pronunciation and intonation.
- ☐ C. Varied dialects as a result of borrowings from other languages.
- ☐ D. Inconsistencies between spoken and written forms.

16. How does the Internet influence English spellings?

- ☐ A. American spellings are preferred by language learners on the Internet.
- ☐ B. Spoken dialects are reflected in some spellings.
- ☐ C. Spelling variations are less tolerated among the netizens.
- ☐ D. More abbreviations are encouraged as representations of the online culture.

17. Which of the following can be inferred from the text?

- ☐ A. Wrong spellings could leave very bad impressions.
- ☐ B. Punctuation marks will disappear in online communication.
- ☐ C. More changes in oral English are to be expected.
- ☐ D. US spellings will lose its status of being favored by non-native speakers.

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Questions 18-19 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about intelligence. Answer the questions according to the text.

The first IQ tests to measure intelligence were developed by Alfred Binet and Theodore Simon in the early 20th century. They evaluated short-term memory, analytical thinking and mathematical ability. Though the tests have changed since then, the basic skills they attempted to measure have remained the same. Within a few points either way, IQ is fixed throughout your life: the only way you'll lose it is because of a brain injury.

So-called "intelligence" tests abound online. Many children take aptitude tests at school. Most of these can be gamed or, at least, children can be trained to excel at them. Mensa (the High IQ Society) does its best to make its tests "culture fair"—in other words it aims to identify intelligence that is *intrinsic* rather than taught. "The original gifted children will have invented the wheel and discovered fire," says Kendall. But even Kendall, who is in the business of evaluating children, admits that "testing IQ is not like measuring height". No assessment is completely objective.

Most tests look only at particular types of intelligence, such as mathematical and verbal reasoning. That reflects how narrow society's notions of giftedness are. Many other types of skills and characteristics are missed, such as voracious curiosity or the ability to make intellectual connections. The tests are unlikely to identify future novelists or poets, or children who may be exceptionally good at sports or music. We don't yet have a way to measure creative, artistic or emotional intelligence. The sorts of children we rate as "geniuses" tend to be only those who fall into the standard categories.

Some people question the very notion of giftedness. The definition of a gifted child has fragmented over time, says Deborah Eyre, founder of High Performance Learning, an organisation that works with schools and teachers in Britain to try to help large numbers of children become "high performers". She does not see aptitude as innate. Eyre says that no matter where you look in the world, the children of wealthy parents are over-represented in cohorts of gifted children. Those who come from minority backgrounds are under-represented: "Latinos don't get selected [for programmes] in the US, Maoris don't in New Zealand."

She also says that what marks out brilliant and high-achieving children—and adults—is often determination. The difference between two equally talented physicists, one who goes on to win a Nobel Prize and one who does not, is their will to succeed. Apparent genius, she argues, is a combination of some kind of potential, along with the right support and personal drive.

Eyre claims that a certain type of parent, usually a highly educated one, takes pride in having a "gifted child" to show off. But this view wasn't borne out by the parents I spoke to, most of whom found their children's gifts to be a source of anxiety, even distress.

Many of these parents face two main difficulties. One is how to cater to the advanced intellectual development of their child. The second dimension is more rarely voiced but may cause just as many problems: exceptionally intelligent children are often socially isolated, even disruptive. Gifts that are admired in the abstract often seem less welcome in person.

18. Which of the following words is closest in meaning to

intrinsic in Paragraph 2?

- ☐ A. inherent
- ☐ B. acquired
- ☐ C. profound
- ☐ D. mutant

19. Which of the following statements is true according to the text?

- ☐ A. Determination is more important than talent to make one achieved.
- ☐ B. There is seldom any test that is objective, especially in IQ tests.
- ☐ C. Family education status is decisive in fostering gifted children.
- ☐ D. Intelligent people are born-to-be rather than taught or learnt.

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Questions 20-21 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about the Mona Lisa. Answer the questions according to the text.



Leonardo da Vinci's greatest triumph of combining art, science, optics, and illusion was the smile of the Mona Lisa, which he started working on in 1503 and continued laboring over nearly until his death 16 years later. He dissected human faces, delineating the muscles that move the lips, and combined that knowledge with the science of how the retina processes perceptions. The result was a masterpiece that invites and responds to human interactions, making Leonardo a pioneer of virtual reality.

The magic of the Mona Lisa's smile is that it seems to react to our gaze. What is she thinking? She smiles back mysteriously. Look again. Her smile seems to flicker. We glance away, and the enigmatic smile lingers in our minds, as it does in the collective mind of humanity. In no other painting are motion and emotion, the paired touchstones of Leonardo's art, so intertwined.

The artist Giorgio Vasari, a near-contemporary, told of how Leonardo kept Lisa del Giocondo, the young wife of a Florentine silk merchant, smiling during her portrait sessions. "While painting her portrait, he employed people to play and sing for her, and jesters to keep her merry, to put an end to the melancholy that painters often succeed in giving to their portraits." The result, Vasari said, was "a smile so pleasing that it was more divine than human," and he proclaimed that it was a product of superhuman skills that came directly from God.

That's a typical Vasari cliché, and it's misleading. The Mona Lisa's smile came not from some divine intervention. Instead, it was the product of years of painstaking and studied human effort involving applied science as well as artistic skill. Using his technical and anatomical knowledge, Leonardo generated the optical impressions that made possible this brilliant display of virtuosity. In doing so, he showed how the most-profound examples of creativity come from embracing both the arts and the sciences.

Leonardo's efforts to fashion the Mona Lisa's effects began with the preparation of the painting's wood panel. On a thin-grained plank cut from the center of a trunk of poplar, he applied a primer coat of lead white, rather than just a mix of chalk and pigment. That undercoat, he knew, would be better at reflecting back the light that made it through his fine layers of translucent glazes and thereby would enhance the impression of depth, luminosity, and volume.

Some of the light that penetrates the layers of paint reaches the white undercoat and is reflected back through those same layers. As a result, our eyes see the interplay between the light rays that bounce off the colors on the surface and those that dance back from the depths of the painting. This creates shifting and elusive subtleties. The contours of Lisa's cheeks and smile are created by soft transitions of tone that seem veiled by the glaze layers, and they vary as the light in the room and the angle of our gaze change. The painting comes alive.

20. What is the best title for the text?

- ☐ A. How Da Vinci Augmented Reality Through the Mona Lisa
- ☐ B. What Makes the Mona Lisa a Masterpiece
- ☐ C. The Science Behind Mona Lisa's Smile
- ☐ D. Leonardo da Vinci and the Mona Lisa

21. Which of the following statements is NOT true

according to the text?

- ☐ A. Leonardo da Vinci spent around 16 years completing the Mona Lisa.
- ☐ B. Mona Lisa's smile is a profound example of combining art and science.
- ☐ C. The process of painting the portrait of Mona Lisa was a joyful one.
- ☐ D. The effects of Mona Lisa's smile are realized through the painting's wood panel.

Questions 22-23 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about orange. Answer the questions according to the text.

What came first, the orange or orange? Did someone just make the un-creative decision to name the citrus fruit after its color? (That's how the blueberry got its name, after all.) Or did the color get its name because of the fruit? In terms of perplexing origin stories, this one is right up there with the chicken vs. the egg. Luckily, though, this one is much more easily solved!

So which came first, the color or the fruit? The answer is neither. Well, one did come before the other, but neither was actually the first meaning of the word. The linguistic ancestor to today's word "orange" was actually first used to describe the tree that the fruit grows on. The word's roots can be traced all the way back to Sanskrit. In that language, the word *nāranga* meant "orange tree." *Nāranga* evolved into the Persian word *nārang* and the Arabic word *nāranj*. If you know Spanish, these old words might look very familiar—the modern Spanish word for "orange" is "naranja." (You won't believe that this common word is one of the world's hardest to translate.)

As the word evolved, it eventually came to mean the fruit, not just the orange tree. Old French adapted the Arabic word *nāranj* as "pomme d'orenge" ("the fruit from the orange tree") or just "orenge." Speakers of Middle English adopted the phrase; the Middle English equivalent "pume orange" dates back to the 13th century AD.

The word didn't come to describe a color until almost 200 years later, making the fruit the clear winner. In 1512, a description of the color using the word "orange" appeared—in a rather strange place. According to the *Oxford English Dictionary*, the use of the word first appeared in a will.

So, the only mystery that remains is how did people describe the color before 1512? According to *Huffington Post*, speakers of Old English used the word *geolurēad*, meaning "yellow-red." But thanks to an Old French word, the color orange has a name all its own. And a unique name, at that—"orange" doesn't rhyme with any other word in English.

22. Which of the following statements is true according to the text?

- ☐ A. Nāranga is developed from the Persian word nārang and the Arabic word nāranj.
- ☐ B. Orange and blueberry share the same way of getting their names.
- ☐ C. The color orange got a name all to itself thanks to a Spanish word.
- ☐ D. No other words in English rhyme the same way as the word "orange".

23. Decide whether the following statement is True or False according to the text.

The word "orange" was initially used to describe the orange color in an article of law.

- ☐ A. True
- ☐ B. False

Questions 24-26 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about Beirut. Answer the questions according to the text.

Within an hour of landing in Beirut, my boyfriend and I were immersed in the buzz of Lebanon's capital.

The bar we'd gone to for one glass of local Ksara red wine had a DJ and a rooftop with views across this sparkling city, and we were encouraged to make a night of it. The Lebanese are proud to say that Beirut is one of the few places in the world where you can swim in the morning and ski in the afternoon. Add the culture, food and emerging wine scene and we were sold.

We stayed at The Phoenicia, which is a destination in itself. This hotel has a fractured history; opened in 1961, it was a grand symbol of a golden age. Then, during the 15-year civil war, it was nearly destroyed and was abandoned until 2000, when it reopened with 446 rooms—a sign that Beirut was looking to the future.

Now it has become a landmark again, standing proudly near Zaitunay Bay, where Beirutis go for evening promenades. The hotel's buffet breakfast is a chance to try the dishes Beirut is known for, including knafeh ka'ak: filo pastry filled with stretchy cheese, soaked in orange blossom syrup and sandwiched in a sesame seed bun. There's also manouche, a pizza-like bread topped with za'atar. The Phoenicia also hosts a stunning Italian restaurant called Rossini, serving delicious fresh seafood (try the seabass). After dinner there, we played backgammon by the mosaicked pool at Amethyste bar. There's an indoor pool, too, and a spa where the masseuse pummelled out my London tension. A 45-minute seaside walk west along the corniche leads to the Raouche, imposing rocky cliffs and islets that rise up out of the sea. This is where Beirut gathers to watch the sunset.

Every Lebanese person we met inundated us with restaurant suggestions, and Tawlet was the best. It's a light, flower-filled space in the Mar Mikhael area offering an all-you-can-eat Lebanese smorgasbord, run by local food celebrity Kamal Mouzawak, who set up the popular farmers' market, Souk El Tayeb. The surrounding neighbourhood is lined with shops, galleries and bars, which are packed out every night. Stroll along lively Armenia Street until it leads into hip Gemmayzeh, stopping at Sip coffee with its pink and green marble interior, tiny but pumping bar Torino Express, and gallery and shop Plan Bey. Housed in an elegant Italianate villa, the Sursock Museum in nearby Achrafieh boasts stained glass windows and a strong modern art collection.

Beit Beirut is a must-see for culture hounds. The centre is housed in an imposing 1930s Ottoman revivalist building that was used by snipers in the civil war. The facade still bears battle scars, while the rest of the building has been rebuilt and showcases art alongside the city's tumultuous history.

Beirut's compact size means that day trips are easy. We drove up the coast to Byblos and Batroun, ancient seaside towns that do a good line in fresh lemonade. Batroun is home to craft brewery Colonel, while Byblos is the world's oldest inhabited city with ruins dating back to at least 5000 BC. To the east are the archaeological wonders of Baalbek, the Ancient Roman site where the pillars and porticos of temples remain standing, and the eighth-century Umayyad complex at Anjar, where you can wander the ruins among the wildflowers. _____26_____

24-25. Decide whether the following statements are True or False according to the text.

24. We can learn from the text that Beirut is not large but has many wonderful places for travelers to visit.

- ☐ A. True
☐ B. False

25. The author has visited the bar, the famous hotel, the best restaurant, the historical sites and museums with her boyfriend in Beirut.

- ☐ A. True
☐ B. False

26. Which of the following is most likely to conclude the text?

- ☐ A. This gorgeous Mediterranean destination is a must-visit for travelers.
☐ B. Colourful, buzzing Beirut packs in so much that you won't want to leave.
☐ C. Beirut's energy, soul and intoxicating atmosphere make it an addictive city.
☐ D. Often called "Paris of the Middle East", Beirut is a thriving place for everything.

Questions 27-28 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

When life originated remains a mystery. Discoveries of seemingly organically produced carbon in 4.3-billion-year-old Australian minerals indicate that it happened relatively quickly after Earth formed. But that is not necessarily so. Perhaps life did not originate until 3.7 billion years ago. From this period, scientists have found evidence of photosynthesis in Greenland rock. In spite of disagreement about the fossils, scientists agree that life cannot have originated any less than 3.5 billion years ago. Based on the DNA of living organisms', geneticists have calculated that the common ancestor of all life on Earth must have lived at this time.

The ancestor, which is also known as LUCA—the last universal common ancestor, probably had the biological characteristics shared by all organisms, from the most simple of bacteria to the biggest whales, including cell membranes made of fat, a genetic code based on DNA, and an army of proteins to catalyse chemical reactions, carry building blocks, and hold all cell parts together. Consequently, those features are central for scientists, when they try to understand the formation of the earliest life.

The earliest known theory of the origin of life was proposed by Aristotle of Greece some 350 years BC. According to his theory, life originates spontaneously all the time from non-living material. This idea was rejected by French biologist Louis Pasteur in 1859. He knew that a nutrient-rich, but sterile liquid will not spontaneously become the home of bacteria and fungi. Not until it gets in contact with the air—and so the organisms that exist the air—will life originate.

The experiment helped develop the theory that many scientists support today: that life on Earth only originated once and has since developed in many directions and spread to all corners of the planet. This triggered the search for the enigmatic place that nurtured the very first life.

One of the first scientific theories of what the cradle of life must have looked like was proposed by English scientist Charles Darwin. In a letter to his friend, botanist Joseph Dalton Hooker, Darwin in 1871 described how the first proteins could originate in a small, warm lake with nitrogen and phosphorus compounds, light, heat, and electric voltage differences. So, the proteins could react with each other to form more complex compounds. Darwin's theory was brief, but it inspired a groundbreaking experiment 80 years later.

American chemists Stanley Miller and Harold Urey in 1952 set out to recreate the conditions of the early Earth with water and a mixture of methane, hydrogen, and ammonia. As an energy source, they added artificial lightning. The result was amino acids—the fundamental building blocks of proteins. The experiment showed that it was rather easy for some of life's most basic molecules to originate under the conditions that probably existed early in Earth's history.

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27. What is the main idea of the text?

- ☐ A. Life possibly originated from non-living materials.
- ☐ B. Theories and experiments verified the origin of life.
- ☐ C. The origin of life bothered many scientists centuries ago.
- ☐ D. The origin of life remains a mystery still.

28. What can we learn about the experiment by Stanley Miller and Harold Urey in the last paragraph?

- ☐ A. The experiment verified the correctness of Charles Darwin's theory.
- ☐ B. The experiment produced amino acids which are some kind of proteins.
- ☐ C. The experiment showed that some of life's most basic molecules are easy to create.
- ☐ D. The experiment imitated the probable conditions of the early Earth.

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Questions 29-30 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about the "Windy City". Answer the questions according to the text.

The origins of Chicago's famous nickname are not entirely clear. The most obvious explanation is that it comes from the frigid breezes that blow off Lake Michigan and sweep through the city's streets. However, another popular theory holds that it was coined in reference to Chicago's bloviating residents and politicians, who were deemed to be "full of hot air." Proponents of the "windbag" view usually cite an 1890 article by *New York Sun* newspaper editor Charles Dana. At the time, Chicago was competing with New York to host the 1893 World's Fair (Chicago eventually won), and Dana is said to have cautioned his readers to ignore the "nonsensical claims of that windy city." Dana is often credited with popularizing the "Windy City" moniker, yet according to David Wilton's book *Word Myths: Debunking Linguistic Urban Legends*, researchers have never managed to find his original article. Many now dismiss it as a myth.

Even if Dana's editorial does exist, it's unlikely that either he or the World's Fair debate were responsible for popularizing Chicago's nickname. Etymologist Barry Popik, a longtime researcher of the Windy City question, has uncovered evidence that the name was already well established in print by the 1870s—several years before Dana. Popik also dug up references showing that it functioned as both a literal reference to Chicago's windy weather and a metaphorical jab at its supposedly boastful citizenry. Many of the citations are found in newspapers from other Midwest cities, which were in a rivalry with Chicago over who was the region's main metropolis. For example, an 1876 headline in the *Cincinnati Enquirer* used the phrase "That Windy City" in reference to a tornado that swept through Chicago. "The *Cincinnati Enquirer's* use is clearly double-edged," Popik told the *Chicago Tribune* in 2006. "They used the term for windy speakers who were full of wind, and there was a wind-storm in Chicago. It's both at once." Since Chicago had previously used its lake breezes to promote itself as a summertime vacation spot, Popik and others conclude that the "Windy City" name may have started as a reference to weather and then taken on a double meaning as the city's profile rose in the late 19th century.

Interestingly, although Chicago may have gotten its nickname in part because of its fierce winds, it's not the breeziest town in the United States. In fact, meteorological surveys have often rated the likes of Boston, New York and San Francisco as having higher average wind speeds.

29. Who provided the reliable evidence to show the origin of Chicago's nickname "Windy City"?

- ☐ A. David Wilton
- ☐ B. The residents.
- ☐ C. Charles Dana
- ☐ D. Barry Popik

30. According to the experts, the name "Windy City" first referred to _____.

- ☐ A. the windy weather
- ☐ B. the boastful citizenry
- ☐ C. the metropolis
- ☐ D. the vacation spot

Questions 31-40 (Suggested completion time: 35 minutes)

Directions: Read three passages about *crying*. Answer the questions according to the passages.

Passage A

It might be stereotypes, but women do shed a tear more often than men, a study shows. The researchers said hormonal differences between the sexes could be to blame, but social conditioning plays a part too.

Women well up between 30 and 64 times a year, while men shed a tear between 6 and 17 times per year, a study found. And when women cry, it is also for longer than men. Researchers found women's tears last for six minutes on average, while for men, they last for between two and three minutes.

The study was carried out by Professor Ad Vingerhoets, a clinical psychologist at Tilburg University in the Netherlands and author of the book, *Why Only Humans Weep: Unravelling the Mysteries of Tears*.

He spoke to more than 5,000 people in 37 countries and asked them questions about their emotional responses. Among men, 66 per cent of participants cried for less than five minutes and 24 per cent cried for between 6 and 15 minutes. With women, however, 43 per cent cried for less than five minutes but more cried for between 6 and 15 minutes—38 per cent. Also, more than twice as many women cry for between 16 and 30 minutes: 11 per cent versus 5 per cent of men.

The findings also showed women cried twice as often as men for between 31 minutes and an hour, as well as for 60 minutes-plus.

Professor Vingerhoets said the differences in the sexes “could perhaps be explained to a large extent by the fact that women more often watch tearjerkers and read sentimental literature”.

However, it's not just women that cry at the movies. According to *Esquire* magazine, the films that make men cry include *The Shawshank Redemption*, *Saving Private Ryan* and surprisingly *Babe*, a comedy drama about a talking pig.

Previous studies showed tears contain prolactin, a hormone produced by the pituitary gland associated with emotion. Women have higher levels of this than men, which could explain why they cry more often. And because men have bigger tear ducts in their eyes, it takes more for them to well up and for the tears to spill over.

Passage B

It's been fashionable for a long time now to deny all evidence for human uniqueness, for the singular greatness of members of our species.

So it's refreshing to read Michael Trimble's claim that “The notion that animals can weep—apologies to *Dumbo*, *Bambi*, and *Wilibur*—has no scientific foundation.”

Other animals can tear up, but they can't cry from being moved emotionally, from empathy or misery or joy.

The title of Trimble's excellent article—“I Cry Therefore I Am”—suggests that crying might even be a more reliable evidence of my personal identity than thinking.

Crying, for us, serves “interpersonal purposes.” It becomes “a tool of our social repertory: grief and joy, shame and pride, fear and manipulation.” It serves our passions shaped and inflamed by our self-consciousness and our singularly relational lives.

Women all over the world and in all points in time seem to cry more frequently and more intensely than men. Is the cause of that gender-based difference hormonal? Or is it caused by “gender stereotypes”—we expect real women to cry in response to emotional events? Or is it true that oppressed and repressed women have simply had more to cry about? If that last explanation is right, then women can be expected to cry less and less as they achieve equality and are freed from discrimination and violence.

Women not only cry more frequently and longer than men, they are much more likely to explain their tears, to understand and use their tears as part of a complex process of communication. Tears, for men, are much less likely to be a way of relating to others, and more likely to be both caused by and a source of shame.

To be fair to women, of course, tearful communication is not mainly manipulation. It’s also true that they’re just more readily and deeply moved by personal joys, tragedies, and betrayals, and they use tears to share their deeply personal knowledge—what psychologists might call their deep empathy—with others. Being a mother, for one thing, is more intensely and naturally relational than being a father.

Men only readily cry when their “core identity”—their basic sources of pride—as fathers and fighters, providers and protectors is undermined. Big-time loss of status brings men to tears. That might mean that today’s increasingly superfluous men are crying more than ever.

So when women wonder why “real men”—confident men secure in their personal identity—have trouble tearing up, they don’t understand they don’t really have anything to cry about.

Trimble just plain contradicts himself on his speculations on the relationship between equality and weeping. The march toward justice, as I said, might give women less to cry about. But it’s also true as hierarchy declines the more the tears flow. That’s allegedly because “autonomy” means, among other things, “acceptance of emotional displays.”

Trimble adds, on even weaker grounds, that the democratization of “exposure to the arts” gives ordinary people more to cry about. It is true that we’re surrounded by various forms of emo art—mainly music—designed to produce real tears without real tragedy or real love.

That might explain why the sentimental romanticism of the philosopher Rousseau becomes so fashionable in sophisticated democratic circles. Rousseau’s “frivolous form of self-indulgence” was to “cry over nothing,” to cry for the love of crying. We’re not so judgmental these days as to call anyone’s crying frivolous, and we’re less likely than ever to say man up, get over yourself, stop crying, and get back to work.

That nonjudgmentalism extends in another direction: We’re more accepting of both crying and not crying. We no longer demand that a wife cry at the funeral of her husband, or citizens at the death of their president. Public weeping or not, it’s up to you.

Passage C

It’s perhaps surprising to learn that the gender gap in crying seems to be a recent development. Historically, men routinely wept, and no one saw it as feminine or shameful.

For example, in medieval romances, knights cried purely because they missed their girlfriends. In *Chrétien de Troyes’s Lancelot*, or, *The Knight of the Cart*, no less a hero than Lancelot weeps at a brief separation from Guinevere. At another point, he cries on a lady’s shoulder at the thought that he won’t get to go to a big tournament because of his captivity. What’s more, instead of being disgusted by this sniveling, the lady is moved to help.

There's no mention of the men in these stories trying to restrain or hide their tears. No one pretends to have something in his eyes. No one makes an excuse to leave the room. They cry in a crowded hall with their heads held high. Nor do their companions make fun of this public blubbing; it's universally regarded as an admirable expression of feeling.

So where did all the male tears go? There was no anti-crying movement. No leaders of church or state introduced measures to discourage them. Nevertheless, by the Romantic period, masculine tears were reserved for poets. From there, it was just a short leap to the poker-faced heroes of Ernest Hemingway, who, despite their poetic leanings, could not express grief by any means but tippling and shooting the occasional buffalo.

The most obvious possibility is that this shift is the result of changes that took place as we moved from a feudal agrarian society to one that was urban and industrial. In the Middle Ages, most people spent their lives among those they had known since birth. A typical village had around 250 to 300 inhabitants, most of them related by blood or marriage. If men cried, they did so with people who would empathize.

But from the 18th to 20th centuries, the population became increasingly urbanized, and people were living in the midst of thousands of strangers. Furthermore, changes in the economy required men to work together in factories and offices where emotional expression and even private conversation were discouraged as time-wasting. As Tom Lutz writes in *Crying: The Natural and Cultural History of Tears*, "You don't want emotions interfering with the smooth running of things."

Yet human beings weren't designed to swallow their emotions, and there's reason to believe that suppressing tears can be hazardous to your well-being. Research from the 1980s has suggested a relationship between stress-related illnesses and inadequate crying. Weeping is also, somewhat counterintuitively, correlated with happiness and wealth. Countries where people cry the most tend to be more democratic and their populations more extroverted.

You might also suffer if you simply hide your tears from others, as men are now expected to do. As we've seen, crying can be a tool to elicit care. While this might be inappropriate during a performance review, it could be an essential way of alerting others that you need support.

Taboos against male expressiveness mean that men are less likely than women to get help when they're suffering from depression. This, in turn, is correlated with higher suicide rates (men are three to four times as likely to commit suicide as women), as well as higher rates of alcoholism and drug addiction.

It's time to open the floodgates. Time for men to give up emulating the stone-faced heroes of action movies and be more like the emotive heroes of Homer, like the weeping kings, saints, and statesmen of thousands of years of human history. When misfortune strikes, let us all — men and women — join together and cry until our sleeves are drenched.



31. What question does the study in Passage A attempt to answer?

- ☐ A. Why are humans the only creature that weeps?
- ☐ B. What are the gender differences in crying?
- ☐ C. Why do women cry more often than men?
- ☐ D. How often and how long do humans cry?

32. Which of the following is TRUE according to Passage A?

- ☐ A. Men have biological advantages to help them escape from sadness.
- ☐ B. Women cry more than men mainly because of their hormonal differences.
- ☐ C. More than twice as many women cry for 16 minutes-plus than men do.
- ☐ D. Men watch fewer movies that may cause them to cry than women do.

33. What might *Dumbo, Bambi, and Wilbur* in Passage B refer to?

- ☐ A. Well-known scientists.
- ☐ B. Cartoon characters.
- ☐ C. Certain animals.
- ☐ D. Historical figures.

34. According to Passage B, which of the following fits Trimble's opinion?

- ☐ A. Women often use their tears to express themselves in a complicated way.
- ☐ B. It is scientifically reasonable to say that only humans can tear up.
- ☐ C. The ability to cry bitterly shows the difference between human and animals.
- ☐ D. Confident men seldom cry because they are satisfied with their core identity.

35. The example of the philosopher Rousseau in Passage B shows that _____.

- ☐ A. his philosophy about crying reflects an open-minded attitude
- ☐ B. democratic people are not judgmental about male crying
- ☒ C. people gradually accept crying as a form of emotional display
- ☐ D. he is a representative of the democratization of "exposure to the arts"

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36. What might be the reason that discourages men from crying according to Passage C?

- ☐ A. People no longer live among their friends and relatives.
- ☐ B. Emotional feelings may reduce workers' productivity.
- ☐ C. Masculine tears only happen in literature works.
- ☐ D. Heroes of Ernest Hemingway don't reveal their grief.

37. We can learn from Passage C that _____.

- ☐ A. tears can act as signals to call for care and support
- ☐ B. historical heroes are more worth admiring than modern ones
- ☐ C. the more often people cry, the healthier they will be
- ☐ D. crying can lead to happiness and wealth

38. Which is the best title for Passage C?

- ☐ A. Why should men cry?
- ☐ B. Men should cry more
- ☐ C. Real men don't cry
- ☐ D. Why men don't cry?

39. Both Passage B and Passage C suggest that _____.

- ☐ A. women cry less than before since they have gained equal rights
- ☐ B. it is necessary to encourage people to cry more to relieve their stress
- ☐ C. men cry less than women because they are more masculine
- ☐ D. the more advanced the society is, the freer people feel to cry

40. What can be learned from the three passages?

- ☐ A. Passages A and B list the statistic differences between genders in crying.
- ☐ B. All three passages provide theories explaining why women cry more often than men.
- ☐ C. Passage A is more objective compared to the other two passages.
- ☐ D. Passages A and C include experiments about crying of men and women.

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Question 41 (Suggested completion time: 40 minutes)

Directions: Read three excerpts about education. Excerpt A and Excerpt B are taken from *The School and Society* by John Dewey. Write a short essay according to the excerpts.

Excerpt A

If we go back a few centuries, we find a practical monopoly of learning. The term possession of learning is, indeed, a happy one. Learning was a class matter. This was a necessary result of social conditions. There were not in existence any means by which the multitude could possibly have access to intellectual resources. These were stored up and hidden away in manuscripts. Of these there were at best only a few, and it required long and toilsome preparation to be able to do anything with them.

Excerpt B

While training for the profession of learning is regarded as the type of culture, or a liberal education, the training of a mechanic, a musician, a lawyer, a doctor, a farmer, a merchant, or a railroad manager is regarded as purely technical and professional. The result is that which we see about us everywhere—the division into “cultured” people and “workers,” the separation of theory and practice. ... in the great majority of human beings the distinctively intellectual interest is not dominant. They have the so-called practical impulse and disposition. In many of those in whom by nature intellectual interest is strong, social conditions prevent its adequate realization. Consequently by far the larger number of pupils leave school as soon as they have acquired the rudiments of learning, as soon as they have enough of the symbols of reading, writing, and calculating to be of practical use to them in getting a living. While our educational leaders are talking of culture, the development of personality, etc., as the end and aim of education, the great majority of those who pass under the tuition of the school regard it only as a narrowly practical tool with which to get bread and butter enough to eke out a restricted life. If we were to conceive our educational end and aim in a less exclusive way, if we were to introduce into educational processes the activities which appeal to those whose dominant interest is to do and to make, we should find the hold of the school upon its members to be more vital, more prolonged, containing more of culture.

Excerpt C

“We need strategies that build and recognize learners as independent and self-benefiting agents, not waiting to be taught but wanting to be supported so they can go and learn themselves.” In the long run, numeracy, literacy, learning, etc. will remain as core competencies sitting at the heart of curricula. Then, there will be the “soft competencies”—collaborative problem solving, critical thinking, innovation. “We will always need subject specialist teachers. But they will work in teams, rather than in isolation. The subjects will not disappear but will be instruments to help students to acquire competencies.”

41. Write a short essay of about 300 words based on your understanding of the excerpts. Remember to write in your OWN words. Your essay should respond to the following questions:

- 1) What problems with education are stated or suggested in the three excerpts?
- 2) Compare Dewey's main idea about school education as implied in Excerpt B with the current situation as described in Excerpt C.
- 3) Do you think Dewey's theory still works? Please explain your answers.

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2019 阅读大赛复赛 3

Questions 1-3 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the following quotes. Match the quotes with the people. Please note there are two extra options you do not need.

- A. Winston Churchill
- B. Abraham Lincoln
- C. Thomas Nashe
- D. Alfred Tennyson
- E. Samuel Ullman

1. 1 Spring, the sweet spring, is the year's pleasant king,

Then blooms each thing, then maids dance in a ring,

Cold doth not sting, the pretty birds do sing:

Cuckoo, jug-jug, pu-we, to-witta-woo!

2. 2 Youth is not a time of life; it is a state of mind; it is not a matter of rosy cheeks, red lips and supple knees; it is a matter of the will, a quality of the imagination, a vigor of the emotions; it is the freshness of the deep springs of life.

3. 3 You ask, what is our aim? I can answer in one word: It is victory, victory at all costs, victory in spite of all terror, victory, however long and hard the road may be; for without victory, there is no survival.

Question 4 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

In a 40-year study of 1,222 men, half the participants received advice to lose weight, exercise, and give up smoking. Compared with the men who weren't counseled, this group of men reduced their risk of cardiovascular disease, but their death rate was higher—perhaps because making these changes caused stress. Within this group, those who took fewer than three weeks off work every year were 37 percent more likely to die between the ages of 40 and 85 than those who vacationed regularly, giving further evidence of the need to de-stress.

4. Which of the following makes the best title for the text?

- ☐ A. Work Less, Be Happier
- ☐ B. Reduce Stress, Live Longer
- ☐ C. Be Brave to Make Changes
- ☐ D. Stress—the Biggest Killer

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Question 5 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the ad and answer the question.

Discover
One of Tennessee's Best Kept Secrets
2019 Special Events

HISTORIC COLLINSVILLE may be the best-kept secret in Tennessee – even though it's been open to the public for 20 years.

The off-the-beaten-path pioneer settlement, located about 15 miles south of Clarksville, first opened in 1974 to give children a hands-on experience outside of the classroom about life in the 1800s. The attraction opened to the public a few years later, recreating the past with 18 historical structures and authentic period furnishings.

The Cherokee, Chickasaw, Creek, Iroquois and Shawnee Indians once roamed these hills bordered by the Cumberland River. Later, the soldiers of the North and South met nearby. Today, Collinsville visitors can learn more about all of the land's inhabitants.

2019 Special Events

- APRIL 20: Easter Egg Hunt & Spring Homecoming
- JUNE 28, JULY 26, AUGUST 23: Southside Summer Nights Bluegrass Series
- OCTOBER 5: Tennessee Craft Week
- OCTOBER 19: Celebration of the Arts
- OCTOBER 26: Fall Pilgrimage
- DECEMBER 14: Candlelight Christmas Tour

Historic Collinsville is open to the public for self-guided tours April 20-October 26, 2019, Saturdays and Sundays, or other times by appointment for groups of 6 or more. Regular admission is \$7; children under five are admitted free when accompanied by a paying adult. Special event admission varies.

5. What can we learn from this ad?

- ☐ A. Historic Collinsville is an attraction that has been opened free to the public for two decades.
- ☐ B. There are various special events in 2019 targeted at group visitors.
- ☐ C. Historic Collinsville has been used as a summer camp to add to children's life experience.
- ☐ D. Visitors can learn about the Civil War and life in the 1800s through a self-guided tour.

Question 6 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

DNA from Neolithic human remains found across Britain indicates they had travelled west across the Mediterranean before reaching Britain, in around 4,000 BC. The findings, published in the journal *Nature Ecology & Evolution*, show that Britain's Neolithic inhabitants descended from populations originating in Anatolia (modern Turkey) who moved to Iberia before they headed north—part of a larger expansion of people out of Anatolia in 6,000 BC.

6. What is the main idea of the text?

- ☐ A. There are new findings about Neolithic humans.
- ☐ B. DNA reveals the origin of Neolithic Britons.
- ☐ C. Britain's Neolithic inhabitants appeared 6,000 years ago.
- ☐ D. Early British immigrants came from Anatolia.

Question 7 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

The Wishing Well

"What are you doing?" my sister asked.
"Making a wish in the well."
Addy slipped a hand into her pocket and pulled out a coin. She let it fall into the well and we waited until it hit the water with an echoing plip.
"Nope. You're still here," she announced. "It doesn't work."
Addy turned and walked down the hill, her ponytail flouncing behind her as she went.
"Very funny," I shouted after her, but I wasn't mad at her for the joke.
It had been two years since the car crash. I was just happy to see her again.

7. It can be inferred from the text that _____.

- ☐ A. the wishing well was truly efficacious
- ☐ B. my sister and I wished to meet each other again
- ☐ C. I lost my sister two years ago
- ☐ D. my sister liked to play jokes with me

Question 8 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

When we let our hopes for the future override the reality of the present, we can really get ourselves into trouble. For example, entrepreneurs need a certain amount of optimism to start a business in the first place given the fact that 70 percent of startups fail within 10 years. However, research has shown that this same optimism can cause founders to ignore the problems that plague their companies.

In one study, a non-profit agency that specializes in predicting business risk assigned entrepreneurs' business plans a grade from A to F. For the 70 percent assigned a D or F, almost half of the business owners trudged ahead anyway. Many even doubled their efforts, wrongly thinking that hard work could make their non-viable businesses viable. In literally every case, it didn't.

8. What is this text mainly about?

- ☐ A. The benefits of long-term strategies.
- ☐ B. The problem with being over-optimistic.
- ☐ C. The disadvantage of being hardworking.
- ☐ D. The importance of good business plans.

Question 9 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Every morning I awake torn between a desire to save the world and an inclination to savor it. This makes it hard to plan the day.

This thought, by author E. B. White, captures the tension that every advocate for action on climate change should feel. This is especially true for those of us who do research and who are most knowledgeable about the problem and the role our lifestyles play in creating it.

George Marshall, in his book *Don't Even Think About It*, describes the inner conflict, depression and guilt that many scientists feel "as they struggle to square what they know about the impacts of high-carbon lifestyles with the pressure to conform to a society where those lifestyles are not just encouraged but also often required as a mark of social belonging."

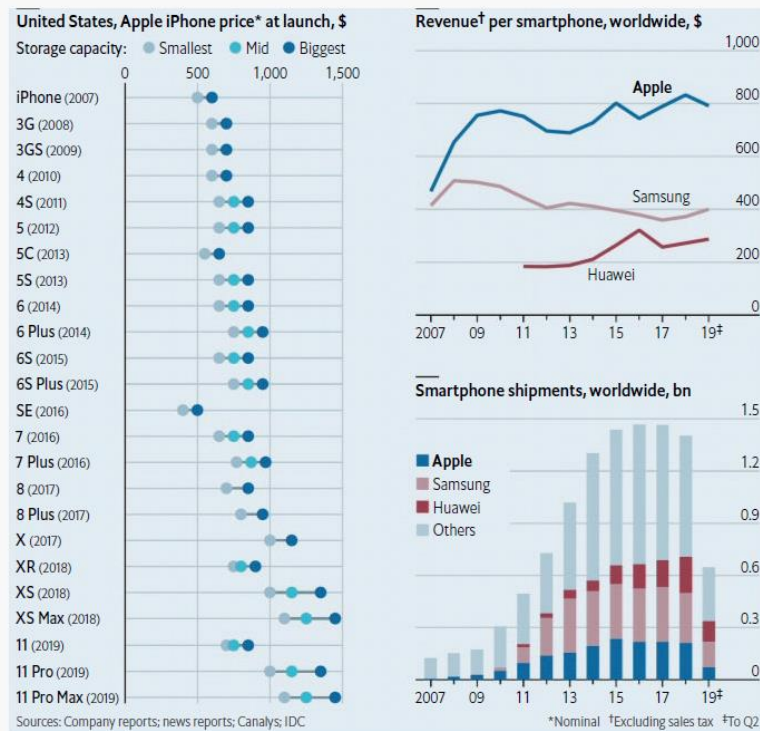
9. Why do many scientists feel depressed and guilty?

- ☐ A. They are knowledgeable about the problem but reluctant to take action on climate change.
- ☐ B. They know the impacts of high-carbon lifestyles but are forced to follow such lifestyles.
- ☐ C. They don't know the exact impacts of high-carbon lifestyles and the pressure posed by the lifestyles.
- ☐ D. They failed to arouse public concern about the impacts of high-carbon lifestyles by using their knowledge.

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Question 10 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: The three charts show Apple iPhone's price change and the revenue per smartphone as well as smartphone shipments worldwide from the year 2007 to 2019 Q2. Answer the question according to the figures.



10. Which of the following is a CORRECT description of the figures?

- ☐ A. The cheapest model of the iPhone 11 is the lowest-priced smartphone the company has launched in 2018 and 2019.
- ☐ B. Among all the smartphones, iPhone has kept bringing the largest revenue to its company since 2011.
- ☐ C. Users of Android phones have many sellers to choose from, leading to fierce price competition among smartphones.
- ☐ D. Sales of iPhones as well as other smartphones have stagnated around the world in the last five years.

Question 11 (Suggested completion time: 4 minutes)

Directions: Read the definition of the following logical fallacy. Answer the question according to the definition.

The *Line-Drawing Fallacy* is also called the Continuum Fallacy. This fallacy presents the alternatives as: Either there is a precise line to be drawn, or else there is no line to be drawn (no difference) between one end of the line and the other.

11. Which of the following provides a typical example of the *Line-Drawing Fallacy*?

- ☐ A. John is not rich. If someone gives him one dollar, he is not going to become rich. If he is given two dollars, he is not going to become rich. So how many ever dollars he is given he is never going to be rich. What if we were to give him twenty million dollars one by one very quickly? Of course, he would become rich. But since we cannot point to the precise dollar that makes him rich, he can never get rich.
- ☐ B. When asked to decide between receiving an award of \$50 now or \$60 tomorrow, the person chooses the \$50; however, when asked to decide between receiving \$50 in two years or \$60 in two years and one day, the person chooses the \$60.
- ☐ C. Owners of financially successful companies are more successful than poor people in the competition for wealth, power and social status. Therefore, these owners are morally better than poor people, and the poor deserve to be poor.
- ☐ D. A rhetoric professor from the University of New Hampshire, James Farrell, was irked as far back as the 2004 Democratic primary campaign, the first time the disclaimers were required. Then, as now, he said, advertisement writers were coming up with awkward non-sequiturs just to slip in something extra.

Question 12 (Suggested completion time: 4 minutes)

Directions: Read the following text. Answer the question according to the text.

Melvin: Boss, why do I have to work weekends when nobody else in the company does?

Boss: Am I sensing insubordination? I can find another employee very quickly, thanks to Craigslist, you know.

12. Which of the following fallacies does the text illustrate?

- ☐ A. **Appeal to Authority:** Insisting that a claim is true simply because a valid authority or expert on the issue said it was true, without any other supporting evidence offered.
- ☐ B. **Appeal to Consequences:** Concluding a hypothesis (typically a belief) to be either true or false based on whether the premise leads to desirable or undesirable consequences.
- ☐ C. **Appeal to Force:** Making an implicit or explicit menace of physical or psychological violence against others if they refuse to accept the conclusions offered.
- ☐ D. **Appeal to Desperation:** Arguing that your conclusion, solution, or proposition is right based on the fact that something must be done, and your solution is the "something."

Questions 13-14 Reasoning (Suggested completion time: 8 minutes)

13.

The Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) was designed to ensure that there is no discrimination against and unfair termination of differently-abled workers in the workplace. However, after the act was introduced, there has been a marked increase in unemployment among the differently-abled.

Which of the following best explains this seeming discrepancy?

- ☐ A. Not willing to deal with the issues of workplace discrimination of the differently-abled, several companies recruited fewer of them in the first place.
- ☐ B. Knowing that the act was about to be enforced, companies terminated some of the differently-abled while they had a chance.
- ☐ C. A number of differently-abled people chose not to work.
- ☐ D. There was no act introduced that would guarantee a job for the differently-abled.

14.

During mediaeval times, the administrative system was organized such that jobs were traditionally held within the same family. The eldest son of the village's blacksmith will take up his father's business and become the next blacksmith. The other sons would join the army or serve the king in some fashion while the daughters did what their mother did. Although the world has undergone innumerable changes, the dynastic system has not undergone any change whatsoever. Children who have fathers who played major league baseball are 800 times more likely than other kids to become major league players themselves.

Which of the following best refutes the author's reasoning?

- ☐ A. A major baseball player will have better knowledge and skills and will be able to guide his son better.
- ☐ B. The blacksmith's eldest son in a mediaeval village could not choose any other profession even if he wanted to.
- ☐ C. 60% of the country's doctors have at least one parent who is a doctor.
- ☐ D. It is a proven fact that success in any career is determined more by skill and practice rather than by genetic makeup.

Questions 15-16 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: Read the abstract of a paper. Answer the questions according to the abstract.

Every gigantic earthquake begins as a tiny rock failure at almost a point, followed by successive slip of the complex fault system, before radiating strong shaking from a vast rupture area extending over hundreds of kilometres. Whether the growth process of the rupture of a large earthquake is predictable and whether it produces observable signatures different from that of smaller events are fundamental questions related to the potential for earthquake early warning and probabilistic forecasting. Inspired by a recent discovery that large earthquakes might have seismic waves, and probably rupture processes, that are almost identical to those of smaller events, we show that such similarity characterized by large cross-correlation is a common feature of earthquakes in the Tohoku–Hokkaido subduction zone, Japan. A systematic comparison of 15 years of high-sensitivity seismograph records for approximately 100,000 events reveals 80 extremely similar and 390 very similar pairs of large (moment magnitude $M > 4.5$) and small ($M < 4.0$) earthquakes, co-located within about 100 metres. An extremely high similarity is observed for pairs of subduction-type earthquakes (170 of 899 large events) separated by a long period of up to 15 years, whereas for pairs of other types of large earthquakes only the foreshocks and aftershocks are similar. This frequently occurring similarity between different-sized subduction-type earthquakes suggests repeated cascading rupture processes in a widespread hierarchical structure along the plate interface and indicates a specific but probabilistically limited predictability of the final size of the earthquake (that is, the location and a set of possible sizes of an earthquake are well predicted, but its final size is not at all well constrained).

15-16. Decide whether the following statements are True or False according to the abstract.

15. According to the abstract, we can expect to learn from the paper the way to predict the location and magnitude of the earthquake.

- ☐ A. True
☐ B. False

16. The abstract includes the purpose and the method of the study in addition to the finding made by another related study.

- ☐ A. True
☐ B. False

Question 17 (Suggested completion time: 4 minutes)

Directions: Read the text on biological age. Answer the question according to the text.

A small clinical study in California has suggested for the first time that it might be possible to reverse the body's epigenetic clock, which measures a person's biological age.

For one year, nine healthy volunteers took a cocktail of three common drugs — growth hormone and two diabetes medications — and on average shed 2.5 years of their biological ages, measured by analysing marks on a person's genomes. The participants' immune systems also showed signs of rejuvenation.

The results were a surprise even to the trial organizers — but researchers caution that the findings are preliminary because the trial was small and did not include a control arm.

"I'd expected to see slowing down of the clock, but not a reversal," says geneticist Steve Horvath at the University of California, Los Angeles, who conducted the epigenetic analysis. "That felt kind of futuristic." The findings were published on 5 September in *Aging Cell*.

"It may be that there is an effect," says cell biologist Wolfgang Wagner at the University of Aachen in Germany. "But the results are not rock solid because the study is very small and not well controlled."

17. Which one of the following CANNOT be used to describe the result of the research?

- ☐ A. Uncontested
☐ B. Uncertain
☐ C. Unexpected
☐ D. Unconvincing

Questions 18-19 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about tourism. Answer the questions according to the text.

"More people are travelling—which is great!—but there are no hidden gems anymore."

That's a comment I overheard waiting in an immigration queue in Dublin last month. The travellers were talking about Dubrovnik, and how crowded all destinations seem lately. The idea struck me in a weird way. Sure, more people are travelling than ever—which is good. People are broadening their horizons. But reducing destinations to an ever-shrinking collection of "hidden gems" to be ticked off a bucket list is the kind of attitude that's fuelling over-tourism.

Over-tourism is a worldwide issue: Peru's Machu Picchu, Scotland's scenic Isle of Skye, Gion, Kyoto's geisha district, Amsterdam's Red Light district, the canals of Venice, California's "super-blooming" poppy fields, the Louvre, which reopened late in this May after a brief closure when employees walked out because of overwhelming crowds, and Thailand's Maya Bay, now closed to tourists indefinitely.

All these places have been inundated by more tourists than they can handle, both domestic and foreign. Visitors are overcrowding, littering, acting drunk and lewd, causing environmental damage, failing to respect local culture, inappropriately touching or taking things and driving up rents.

At the same time, no one should be discouraged from travelling. So how can you be a better tourist?

"Why do I want to go here?"

In 2013, journalist Elizabeth Becker looked at the issue of over-tourism in *Overbooked: The Exploding Business of Travel and Tourism*. "Nobody understood what I was talking about," she said.

But now it's a reality that cities across the world are grappling with.

According to a January report from the UN World Tourism Organization, international tourist arrivals hit 1.4 billion in 2018. Compare that to just 25 million in 1950, 602 million in 1998 and 936 million in 2008. By 2030, the number is expected to hit 1.8 billion.

There are many factors for this boom: a growing global middle class, cheaper fares, ambitious tourism targets set by governments and FOMO-inducing (FOMO: fear of missing out) social media.

To do your part, maybe it's worth examining why you want to travel in the first place.

In May, I walked along the east side of the Berlin Wall—the 12-foot high concrete

barrier that divided the city for decades. Before the wall came down, political or cultural graffiti of any kind was banned on its structure. Now, it's a 1.3km-long gallery of street art and murals—a homage to the freedoms that have flourished since the city reunified.

But finding room to appreciate the site and its symbolism was tricky. At three places, young travellers were staging lengthy amateur photo shoots, striking poses and monopolising swathes of space. (Art-covered walls like the “Insta-worthy” angel wings mural in tourist-smothered Nashville commissioned by Taylor Swift command massive queues of visitors.) Locals and fellow travellers alike both had to manoeuvre to get around the self-involved spectacle.

To be fair, this style of staged influencer photo is apparently wearing thin with the Instagram set. Still, the idea of securing proof of your trip, making it (and you) look fantastic and then beaming it out to everyone you know is a driving force of over-tourism.

“The question is, do you want to go to a place—or show people you’ve been to the place?” says Eduardo Santander, executive director of the European Travel Commission.

“Half the reason people have superficial travel experiences is because they’ve made superficial plans,” says journalist Becker. She encourages people to do more than read a paragraph in a guide book or copy friends on Facebook, then parachute into a city and get the same selfie they did. Otherwise, you risk committing what Becker calls “drive-by tourism”, which stokes many of the symptoms of over-tourism, like overcrowding and irritating locals.



18. What does "hidden gems" in the first paragraph mean?

- ☐ A. People who withdraw from society and live in seclusion.
- ☐ B. Places which are good and relatively unknown.
- ☐ C. Precious stones that are not discovered.
- ☐ D. Destinations which are remote and less crowded.

19. Which of the following statements CANNOT be inferred from the text?

- ☐ A. Pressure on certain popular tourist sites, especially at certain times, brings about some environmental damage.
- ☐ B. Tourism brings economic and public benefits that act as powerful tools in sustaining local economy and creating jobs.
- ☒ C. When travelling, ask yourself what you really want to do and see, rather than see something for the sake of seeing it.
- ☐ D. When attracting visitors and making profits, a destination should take its capacity into consideration.

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Questions 20-22 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about downtown. Answer the questions according to the text.

Outside North America, people don't head downtown. Around the world they go to the city or the center. The English, French, and Chinese combine city and center to form city centre, *centre-ville*, and *shizhongxin*. Germans talk of the inner city, or *Innenstadt*. Italians and Poles speak, respectively, of the historic center (*centro storico*) and the old town (*stare miasto*). Australians and South Africans use an acronym, the CBD or Central Business District, a concept Americans consign to urban planning manuals. All these terms expose ideological biases in the way citizens regard the urban core. "City" appears all-inclusive, yet is differentiated from outer, newer districts. "Center" assumes a middle or innermost point around which lie peripheral places. *Centro storico* correlates historical buildings with the center, while *stare miasto* emphasizes the importance of the earliest settlement. So it is significant that *downtown*, in American parlance, designates neither the city at large, nor a central, inner location, nor the oldest part of the city. Such references would attach too much worth to a particular location or past accomplishment.

Downtown may have originally referred to a place that was lower and hard by the waterfront—the "down town," in contrast to the "up town" further inland and higher in elevation. Manhattan likely inspired the concept. Urban settlement began at the island's southern tip and over time proceeded northward onto higher ground. Indeed, the topographic basis of the word *downtown* sets in motion a progression to *midtown* and *uptown*, and later to *suburbs* and *exurbs*. It links the American city's morphology and development with movement and improvement, with linear elongation and neighborhood succession.

The association of downtown with the harbor evokes the origin of American cities via great sailing ships plying oceanic trading routes. Yet the earliest colonial urban development in North America also proceeded in ways that recall later suburban development. All along the Atlantic shore, colonists from Great Britain and other European states founded settlements in environments with scant history of prior urbanization. Unlike cities in other regions that were founded atop older built foundations and cadastral patterns, the first colonial cities in the lands that would come to make up the United States of America were created *ex nihilo*, often drained from marshes or cut from forests. These cities grew from distant metropolitan centers but were separated from them by thousands of miles of ocean. Shipping lanes, the freeways of their age, connected the transoceanic "American suburbs" to their home cities, like London or Liverpool, and to sources of capital, labor, and finished goods.

On the landward sides of these cities lay the endless reaches of the continent. And while the earliest settlements were bounded by stockades, evidence of the violent wresting of land by European settlers from Native American bands and tribes, by the 18th century the young and prospering cities increasingly opened up to their surrounding landscapes.

20. **Decide whether the following statement is True or False according to the text.**

Around the world, people have different ideological references to city centers.

- ☐ A. True
- ☐ B. False

21. What can we know about downtown according to the text?

- ☐ A. It reminds people of a particular location and past glories.
- ☐ B. It was most likely created by European settlers.
- ☐ C. It's linked to the harbor and inspired continental trading and urban development.
- ☐ D. It's possibly prompted by Manhattan and reflects urban settlement.

22. What does the word ***ex nihilo*** in Paragraph 3 probably mean?

- ☐ A. independently
- ☐ B. immediately
- ☐ C. out of the blue
- ☐ D. out of nothing

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Questions 23-24 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about the wildlife photography. Answer the questions according to the text.



From a napping seal and a bandit raccoon to a curious whale and a misplaced cocoon, nature provides some gorgeous photo opportunities.

For 55 years, photographers have showcased their work in the Natural History Museum, London's Wildlife Photographer of the Year competition. This year, the competition attracted more than 48,000 entries from 100 countries. Winners will be announced Oct. 15 with winners and finalists going on display at the museum at an exhibit opening Oct. 18.

In advance of the event, the museum has released a selection of highly commended photographs from various categories in the competition, along with descriptions of each photo.

Here's what they say about the striking photo above from the urban wildlife category. It's called "____23____" by Jason Bantle:

An ever-adaptable raccoon pokes her bandit-masked face out of a 1970s Ford Pinto on a deserted farm in Saskatchewan, Canada. In the back seat, her five playful kits trill with excitement. It was a sentiment shared by Jason Bantle, waiting silently in a nearby hide, who had been hoping for this chance every summer for several years. The only access into the car was through the small hole in the cracked safety glass of the windscreen. The gap was blunt-edged but too narrow a fit for a coyote (the primary predator of raccoons in the area), making this an ideal place for a mother raccoon to raise a family.

23. Which of the following may be the name of the photo that fits in the blank in Paragraph 4?

- ☐ A. Mother and Babies
- ☐ B. Lucky Break
- ☐ C. A Raccoon in the Car
- ☐ D. Deserted Home

24. From the description of the picture, we can know that _____.

- ☐ A. the raccoon family moved to the deserted farm with the car
- ☐ B. the photographer had taken a lot of photos for the raccoon family
- ☐ C. the mother raccoon has got on well with the photographer
- ☐ D. the abandoned car provides an ideal shelter for the raccoons

Questions 25-26 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about online degrees. Answer the questions according to the text.

At online colleges, most if not all coursework is completed virtually, though some may have face-to-face requirements. While many classes are asynchronous — meaning students complete most schoolwork at their own pace under regular deadlines — some have synchronous components, which students attend by videoconferencing at a specific time.

Online degrees often appeal to adults looking for flexibility to study on their own schedules, as many also work full time or part time.

Experts say accredited online programs at reputable schools are generally just as rigorous as the on-campus options. The difference is mainly the format, with students completing individual and group assignments remotely. Classes and programs may be held either fully online or in a blended format, meaning partially online and partially on campus.

In recent years, online associate degrees have become more widely available in various disciplines at both community colleges — which are traditionally categorized as two-year schools — and institutions that also offer bachelor's and graduate degrees, experts say.

"That's the reality of life these days. People need degrees at different stages of their lives, and this is a way to get it," says Antone Aboud, director of online programs and professor of practice in labor and employment relations at Pennsylvania State University — World Campus, which has an online associate degree in the discipline.

But online courses aren't right for everybody. Without constant in-person guidance from a teacher, students need greater self-discipline and time-management skills. Some students may also prefer a traditional face-to-face classroom environment where they can interact with classmates more frequently.

Experts say online degrees typically have the same tuition as their on-ground counterparts, though this varies depending on the institution.

The academic calendar for an online program may offer flexible course scheduling options. At Mesa Community College in Arizona, many online classes last eight weeks, says Laura Ballard, e-learning director at the school, which offers online associate degrees. Online students may also take courses during a four-week winter intersession and the summer to help speed up the time to graduation.

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25. What is the main topic of the text?

- ☐ A. Pros and cons of online associate degrees
- ☐ B. A guide to earning an online associate degree
- ☐ C. Differences between online degrees and the on-ground counterparts
- ☐ D. How online associate degrees work

26. Which of the following is INCORRECT according to the text?

- ☐ A. Online courses require greater self-discipline and time-management skills.
- ☐ B. Some parts of online coursework may involve face-to-face requirements.
- ☐ C. Online degrees normally have lower tuitions than their on-ground counterparts.
- ☐ D. Online degrees tend to arouse the interest of those who prefer a flexible schedule.

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Questions 27-30 (Suggested completion time: 8 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about Alzheimer's disease. Answer the questions according to the text.

Growing older may be inevitable, but getting Alzheimer's disease is not. While we can't stop our advancing age (which is the biggest risk factor for Alzheimer's), there are many other factors that can be modified to reduce our risk for the disease.

Determining how these risk factors may differentiate between women and men could help us understand why Alzheimer's can present, progress, and respond to treatments differently in each sex, providing new therapeutic avenues to explore.

Unfortunately, most studies of Alzheimer's risk factors look at combined data for women and men and do not analyze data by sex to identify risk factors that are more common or more predictive in women versus men.

In a review paper just published in *Alzheimer's & Dementia: The Journal of the Alzheimer's Association*, I, along with researchers from the Society for Women's Health Research Interdisciplinary Network on Alzheimer's Disease call for more research into sex differences in Alzheimer's disease to improve prevention, diagnosis and treatment.

The paper examines our current knowledge about the differences between women and men in Alzheimer's, identifies knowledge gaps and recommends priority areas for future research.

There are three types of sex-related risk factors for Alzheimer's: those that only affect women, those that only affect men and those that impact both sexes.

THE IMPACT OF HORMONES

Hormones play a key role in sex differences in the brain, yet relatively little is known about their influence in Alzheimer's. Ovaries are the primary source of estrogen for premenopausal women, and surgical removal of a woman's ovaries before menopause is associated with higher risk of dementia. However, using estrogen therapy after surgery until age 50 **negates** that risk. This suggests that estrogen may be important and even protective in premenopausal women, but more research is needed to understand why.

On the other hand, there are conflicting studies as to whether androgen deprivation therapy, which is used to treat prostate cancer, increases risk for Alzheimer's in men. Further investigation is needed into the role of sex hormones, the use of different hormonal treatments, and how they each impact Alzheimer's risk.

RISK FACTORS FOR BOTH SEXES

Among risk factors that affect both women and men, some are more common in one

sex. For example, depression and sleep apnea are both risk factors for dementia, but depression is twice as common in women and sleep apnea is three times more common in men. Similarly, low education or job attainment are Alzheimer's risk factors, but traditionally women have not had the same access to education and job opportunities as men, putting them at increased risk.

Some risk factors have a stronger effect in one sex, but cannot be changed. The $\epsilon 4$ allele of the APOE gene is the strongest and most common genetic risk factor for Alzheimer's in both women and men. However, women with APOE $\epsilon 4$ have an increased risk of developing Alzheimer's compared to women without APOE $\epsilon 4$ and men with and without APOE $\epsilon 4$.

Cardiovascular disease and metabolic issues like type 2 diabetes and obesity are also factors that increase risk for Alzheimer's, but we don't yet know whether there are differences in risk between women and men for these factors. However, because we do know that there are sex differences in the development, progression and treatment of cardiovascular disease, it is important that we look at the relationship between sex and the cardiovascular and metabolic risk factors of Alzheimer's.

Learning how risk factors influence risk over time is also critical. For example, in cardiovascular disease, taking aspirin helps reduce heart attack and stroke risk in women aged 65 years and older. This effect is not seen in younger women. It is possible that certain Alzheimer's risk factors may be strongest at certain points during our lives, and understanding this is key for prevention and early intervention.

Determining how risk factors differ between women and men can help optimize our management of them and guide Alzheimer's research moving forward.

PRIORITY AREAS FOR FUTURE RESEARCH

Risk factors are just one of the areas in which we need more research into the differences between the sexes in Alzheimer's disease. As outlined in the review paper from the Society for Women's Health Research Interdisciplinary Network on Alzheimer's Disease, additional research is also needed to examine:

Sex and gender differences in racial and ethnic groups

Gender differences in care-giving and how the burden of care-giving increases Alzheimer's risk

Differences between women and men in the detection, diagnosis, progression, management, and treatment of Alzheimer's

Differences between women and men in response to current Alzheimer's therapeutics and those in development

To achieve these research goals, not only do we need funding agencies and scientists on board, we need the support and participation of patients, care-givers and the wider public in clinical trials. When all these groups join together, that's when true scientific progress is made.

27. Which of the following best expresses the main idea of the text?

- ☐ A. To reduce Alzheimer's risks, we need to consider different factors.
- ☐ B. To prevent Alzheimer's, we must study the differences between genders.
- ☐ C. To cure Alzheimer's, we can focus on hormones.
- ☐ D. To diagnose Alzheimer's, we must work together to achieve further progress.

28. What does the word **negate** probably mean in the text?

- ☐ A. enable
- ☐ B. refute
- ☐ C. neglect
- ☐ D. prevent

29. What can we learn from the risk factors of Alzheimer's?

- ☐ A. There are a number of proven differences in risk between women and men for obesity.
- ☐ B. Taking aspirin might help reduce certain Alzheimer's risk factors at certain points during our lives.
- ☐ C. There is less priority to study on sex and gender differences in racial and ethnic groups.
- ☐ D. Not having equal access to education or jobs, women are put at increased risk of the disease.

30. Which of the following statements is true according to the text?

- ☐ A. Depression and sleep apnea don't increase risk for Alzheimer's.
- ☐ B. Androgen deprivation therapy can increase risk for Alzheimer's in men.
- ☒ C. All humans have the APOE ϵ 4 gene, but it only causes women to get Alzheimer's.
- ☐ D. The removal of ovaries before menopause can increase risk for Alzheimer's in women.

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Questions 31-40 (Suggested completion time: 35 minutes)

Directions: Read three passages about heatwaves. Answer the questions according to the passages.

Passage A

In recent days heatwaves have turned swathes of America and Europe into furnaces. Despite the accompanying blast of headlines, the implications of such extreme heat are often overlooked or underplayed. Spectacular images of hurricanes or floods grab attention more readily, yet heatwaves can cause more deaths. Heat is one of climate change's deadliest manifestations. Sometimes its impact is unmistakable—a heatwave in Europe in 2003 is estimated to have claimed 70,000 lives. More often, though, heatwaves are treated like the two in the Netherlands in 2018. In just over three weeks, around 300 more people died than would normally be expected at that time of year. This was dismissed as a “minor rise” by officials. But had those people died in a flood, it would have been front-page news.

The havoc caused by extreme heat does not get the attention it merits for several reasons. The deaths tend to be more widely dispersed and do not involve the devastation of property as do the ravages of wind and water. Moreover, deaths are not usually directly attributable to heatstroke. Soaring temperatures just turn pre-existing conditions such as heart problems or lung disease lethal.

Heatwaves will inevitably attract more attention as they become more frequent. As greenhouse gases continue to accumulate in the atmosphere, not only will temperatures rise overall but extremes of heat will occur more frequently. Britain's Met Office calculates that by the 2040s European summers as hot as that of 2003 could be commonplace, regardless of how fast emissions are reduced. Urbanization intensifies the risk to health: cities are hotter places than the surrounding countryside, and more people are moving into them.

The good news is that most fatalities are avoidable, if three sets of measures are put in place. First, people must be made aware that extreme heat can kill and warning systems established. _____³²_____, which means warnings can be given in advance advising people to stay indoors, seek cool areas and drink plenty of water. Smart use of social media can help. In 2017 a campaign on Facebook warning of the dangers of a heatwave in Dhaka, Bangladesh's capital, reached 3.9m people, nearly half the city's population.

Second, cool shaded areas and fresh water should be made available. In poor places, air-conditioned community centers and schools can be kept open permanently (steamy nights that provide no relief from scorching days can also kill). In Cape Town, spray parks have been installed to help people cool down. Third, new buildings must be designed to be resilient to the threat of extreme heat and existing ones adapted. White walls, roofs or tarpaulins, and extra vegetation in cities, all of which help prevent heat from building up, can be provided fairly cheaply. A

programme to install “cool roofs” and insulation in Philadelphia reduced maximum indoor temperatures by 1.3°C.

It is a cruel irony that, as with other effects of climate change, the places that are hardest hit by heatwaves can least afford to adapt. In poor countries, where climates are often hotter and more humid, public-health systems are weaker and preoccupied with other threats. Often, adaptation to extreme heat is done by charities if it is done at all. Particular attention should be paid to reaching both remote areas and densely populated urban ones, including slums where small dwellings with tin roofs packed together worsen the danger that uncomfortably high temperatures will become lethal.

Adaptation is not an alternative to cutting emissions; both are necessary. But even if net emissions are reduced to zero this century, the persistence of greenhouse gases in the atmosphere means that heatwaves will continue to get worse for decades to come. As the mercury rises, governments in rich and poor countries alike must do more to protect their populations from this very real and quietly deadly aspect of climate change.

Passage B

There is a vexing paradox for scientists and policymakers: air conditioning keeps people cool and saves lives but is also one of the biggest contributors to global warming.

Two reports underscore the scale of the challenge. On July 16, 2018, Sustainable Energy for All, an NGO (non-governmental organization) that is dedicated to clean energy and is affiliated with the U.N. and World Bank, said that 1.1 billion people across the globe lack access to adequate cooling. And a May analysis from the International Energy Agency (IEA), an intergovernmental organization, shows that just 8% of the 2.8 billion people living in the world's hottest regions own an air conditioner, compared with more than 90% in places like the U.S. and Japan.

For those billions, gaining access to air conditioning isn't just a luxury. Without cooling, heat exhaustion can disrupt the body's functioning and lead to extreme ailments like organ failure and, eventually, death. The number of people who die of heat-related illness could grow to more than 250,000 by 2050, according to a World Health Organization report. Everyone else will become less productive as they toil under the sun, with some parts of Asia and Africa facing up to a 12% decline in work hours by 2050 as a result of heat stress, according to the Sustainable Energy for All report. More broadly, a lack of cooling often also means that people cannot ensure food safety or store medicine.

On the surface, addressing the issue appears simple: countries need to expand access to air conditioning and provide public cooling locations for people who cannot afford their own devices. This is under way. Sustainable Energy for All estimates that some 2.3 billion people in the developing world are on the verge of buying air conditioners, largely thanks to rising incomes as they leave poverty and enter the new global middle class. And in some places, government programs have sought to build public cooling centers for those without devices of their own.

“The world is getting richer. It's growing, and most of that is happening in the tropics,” says Dan Hamza-Goodacre, who heads the Kigali Cooling Efficiency Program, an initiative that targets pollution from cooling. “We're set for an absolute explosion in the demand for cooling.”

But using air conditioning as a tool for development is complex, both globally and locally. The IEA estimates that, without government action, air conditioners will use much more energy by 2050. That represents a threefold increase in energy consumption by air conditioners from today.



"Air conditioning has been an enormous, enormous drain on electricity," says Erik Solheim, who heads the U.N. Environment Programme. "Cooling is probably the biggest energy consumer, and people tend not to think of it."

Beyond energy consumption, cooling products can also contribute to climate change by emitting hydrofluorocarbons (HFCs), chemicals that trap heat in the atmosphere at alarming rates. Scientists say that unabated emissions from HFCs alone could add nearly 1°F of warming to the atmosphere by the end of the century—nearly a third of the 3.6°F target enshrined in the Paris Agreement by scientists as the maximum temperature rise before the world feels some of the most catastrophic effects of climate change.

The start of a global solution is emerging. Companies have developed more efficient cooling technology that is also free of HFCs and plan to expand the sale of such products in the developing world in the coming years. And in 2016, more than 170 nations reached an agreement called the Kigali Amendment, which sets targets to phase out HFCs and will reframe international standards for how to make air conditioners.

These efforts will have to match the magnitude of the trouble ahead. "It's not about everybody who can afford it buying an inefficient air conditioner," says Rachel Kyte, who headed the World Bank's climate-change program and who now leads Sustainable Energy for All. "Government has to realize the extent of the issue they have. This isn't something they can put off."

Passage C

What if retrofitted air-conditioners could convert carbon dioxide (CO₂) into renewable hydrocarbon fuel? And what if this model, adopted collectively and globally, could help put energy in the hands of the people?

That's what Roland Dittmeyer, from the Karlsruhe Institute of Technology in Germany, and co-authors have proposed in a comprehensive perspective published by the journal *Nature Communications*. Titled "Crowd oil not crude oil", the paper addresses people's frustration with inaction on climate change, suggesting the model could empower "prosumers" to create sharable oil wells as part of a new energy economy. Property owners could have the option of feeding excess fuel into a renewable oil grid.

"The envisioned model of 'crowd oil' from solar refineries, akin to 'crowd electricity' from solar panels, enables people to take control and collectively manage global warming and climate change," write the authors.

To synthesize the renewable hydrocarbon onsite, modified air conditioning and ventilation systems powered by renewable energy would capture CO₂ and water (H₂O) from the air using existing technology. Electrophoto or thermocatalytic processes would generate synthetic gas which is converted to hydrocarbon fuel using chemical processes. The fuel could replace fossil fuels or be stored for power generation when renewable energy supplies are low. If used, the emitted CO₂ is again captured, creating a net zero carbon cycle. If stored, it could result in negative CO₂ emissions.

In preliminary analyses, the researchers found that applying this innovation in Germany's Frankfurt Fair Tower could remove up to 1.5 tons of CO₂ per hour and convert it into 2,000 to 4,000 tons of fuel per year.

Every hour, 25,000 German grocery stores could capture around 1,000 tons of CO₂. Applying this to homes, a building with five to six flats could use 0.5kg of the gas per hour.

"The environmental, economic and social consequences of such a distributed oil well technology," the authors suggest, "should contribute to the practical realization of chemical fuels from carbon dioxide as feedstock in a circular sustainable economy of the future."



31. According to Passage A, why did officials dismiss the situation as a "minor rise"?

- ☐ A. Because 300 was not worth mentioning compared with the total number of 70,000.
- ☐ B. Because the destruction of heatwaves was not as attention-drawing as that of flood.
- ☐ C. Because the deaths caused by the heatwaves were within their normal expectation.
- ☐ D. Because extreme heat might not be the direct cause of death.

32. Which of the following best fits in the blank in Passage A?

- ☐ A. Media should guide the public to cope with heatwaves
- ☐ B. Advanced analyzing equipment should be put into use
- ☐ C. Heatwaves can be predicted with reasonable accuracy
- ☐ D. Common knowledge of extreme heat must be popularized

33. It can be inferred from Passage A that _____.

- ☐ A. the highest temperature in European history appeared in the summer of 2003
- ☐ B. poor countries overall do not have the ability to adapt to extremely hot weather
- ☐ C. an increasing number of people flock to cities and make cities hotter and hotter
- ☐ D. cutting emissions will alleviate the problem of global warming to a great extent

34. In Passage B, the two reports are cited to show that _____.

- ☐ A. there is a large demand of air conditioning in face of global warming
- ☐ B. air conditioners are too expensive for people in developing countries
- ☐ C. the lack of air conditioning may result in a series of health problems
- ☐ D. more and more air conditioners are needed in the world's hottest areas

35. Which of the following statements about HFCs is true according to Passage B?

- ☐ A. HFCs are emitted by cooling products to regulate temperature.
- ☒ B. HFCs will be prohibited in no time according to the Kigali Amendment.
- ☐ C. HFCs are indispensable when producing air conditioners.
- ☐ D. HFCs are chemicals contributing to global temperature rise.

36. What is the best title for Passage B?

- ☐ A. How to Make Air Conditioning Truly Beneficial
- ☐ B. Air Conditioning and Global Warming
- ☐ C. Air Conditioning Is a Life-Saver—and a Danger
- ☐ D. Air Conditioning—to Use It or Not to Use It

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37. According to Passage C, "crowd oil" refers to a kind of _____.

- ☐ A. renewable oil extracted by air conditioning and ventilation systems
- ☐ B. renewable oil generated through the process of negative CO₂ emissions
- ☐ C. renewable fuel obtained from solar panels similar to crowd electricity
- ☐ D. renewable fuel synthesized from the air through chemical processes

38. It can be learned from Passage C that _____.

- ☐ A. air conditioners will no longer be the largest contributor to global warming
- ☐ B. future air conditioners and ventilation systems can produce crowd oil
- ☐ C. the new model is both environmentally and economically beneficial
- ☐ D. the innovation has been successfully applied in German stores and homes

39. What has been mentioned in both Passage A and Passage B?

- ☐ A. Enough attention should be given to remote areas and developing countries.
- ☐ B. Air conditioning will bring about more and more environmental problems.
- ☐ C. The hottest areas in the world are usually too poor to afford cooling systems.
- ☐ D. Climate change has taken away many lives especially in tropical countries.

40. Which of the following is NOT true?

- ☐ A. The negative effect of using air conditioners is not included in Passage A.
- ☐ B. The authors in Passage C show a supportive attitude to the technology.
- ☐ C. Passage B and Passage C call for more attention to air conditioning.
- ☐ D. All three passages put forward certain solutions to climate change.

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Question 41 (Suggested completion time: 40 minutes)

Directions: Read a passage from *Plato: A Very Short Introduction*. Write a short essay according to the passage.

In many dialogues Plato grapples with the question of how we are to live a good life. He begins from an assumption which he shares with the rest of his society, namely that we all seek happiness (*eudaimonia*). What we think of as ethics emerges as the concern not just to *live* one's life, but to do it *well*, to make a good job of it. We all seek to be happy, in the sense of living a good life (something to be sharply distinguished from modern notions of happiness, which identify it with feeling good; happiness in all ancient thinkers is the achievement of someone who lives an admirable, enviable life). Plato never doubts that this is where ethical concern starts. He gives, however, a radically different answer than most people, and most other philosophers, to the question of what it is to live an admirable, enviable life, and so to achieve happiness.

Many people, in the modern as much as in the ancient world, find it natural to say that a happy life is one in which you are successful; the happy person will be, typically, the rich, secure person who has achieved something in life. It sounds odd, indeed perverse, to say that someone could be happy, could be living a life you admire and try to emulate, if he or she turned out to be rejected and unsuccessful. But Plato was influenced by the example of Socrates, who gave up worldly success for philosophy, and who ended up condemned as a criminal and executed—yet who clearly seemed to Plato to have lived an admirable life. And so, most people must be wrong about how to achieve a happy life.

Where do most people go wrong? They think that their life will go well, and that they will be happy, if they have the things that most people think are good—health, wealth, good looks, and so on. But are these things good? Do they do you any good—do they benefit you? Surely, thinks Plato, you are here like a craftsperson with tools and material—they do not do you any good until you put them to *use*, that is, *do* something with them. Moreover, you have to do the *right* thing with them, put them to use which is expert and intelligent, or they will not benefit you—indeed may do you harm. Someone who wins the lottery, for example, may well not be made any happier by just having the money. Unless she puts it to intelligent use, the money may do nothing for her, or even ruin her life. Happiness cannot just be the stuff you have; you have to put it to good use, deal with it in the way that a craftsperson deals with her materials, before it will benefit you, and so make your life better.

Hence we find that the virtues, which enable us to deal well with the material advantages of our life, are called (in the *Laws*) "divine goods", in contrast to the "human goods" constituted by those material advantages. Without the divine goods, we will lose the benefit of the human ones. So the value for us of health, wealth, and the like depends on our possession of virtues like courage and justice. And the virtues depend in turn for their value in a human life on the practical reasoning which forms them and guides their application. Hence in the *Euthydemus* the virtues which make something out of the stuff of our lives are identified with wisdom, the practical intelligence which guides virtuous living.

41. Write a short essay of about 300 words based on your understanding of the passage. Remember to write in your OWN words. Your essay should respond to the following questions:

- 1) What is Plato's general idea towards happiness?
- 2) What are virtues or "divine goods"?
- 3) What's the relationship between happiness and virtues?
- 4) What's your opinion on how to pursue and promote happiness?

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Questions 1-3 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the following quotes. Match the quotes with the works. Please note there are four extra options you do not need.

- A. *Far from the Madding Crowd*
- B. *Robinson Crusoe*
- C. *Walden*
- D. *The Moon and Sixpence*
- E. *Gulliver's Travels*
- F. *Oranges Are Not the Only Fruit*
- G. *The Remains of the Day*

1. _____ I was now in the twenty-third year of my residence in this island, and was so naturalised to the place and the manner of living, that, could I but have enjoyed the certainty that no savages would come to the place to disturb me, I could have been content to have capitulated for spending the rest of my time there, even to the last moment, till I had laid me down and died, like the old goat in the cave.

2. _____ I have an idea that some men are born out of their due place. Accident has cast them amid certain surroundings, but they have always a nostalgia for a home they know not. They are strangers in their birthplace, and the leafy lanes they have known from childhood or the populous streets in which they have played, remain but a place of passage. They may spend their whole lives aliens among their kindred and remain aloof among the only scenes they have ever known.

3. _____ I would rather sit on a pumpkin and have it all to myself than be crowded on a velvet cushion. I would rather ride on earth in an ox cart, with a free circulation, than go to heaven in the fancy car of an excursion train and breathe a malaria all the way.

Question 4 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

In 1503, a storm sank the Portuguese ship *Esmeralda* off the southeastern coast of the Arabian Peninsula, taking the lives of the crew. In 2014, divers and archaeologists returned to the wreck to retrieve what remained. That included this metal disk, thought to be an astrolabe—an instrument that mariners used to navigate by measuring the height of celestial bodies above the horizon. Two features of the Portuguese flag—the coat of arms and an armillary sphere, a pattern of rings meant to represent the heavens—affirmed its provenance. Likely constructed between 1496 and 1501, the astrolabe was certified this year as the oldest example known.

4. What is the purpose of this text?

- ☐ A. To introduce the metal disk found in *Esmeralda*.
- ☐ B. To disclose some truth of a sunken Portuguese ship.
- ☐ C. To prove the oldest astrolabe ever known.
- ☐ D. To describe a new archaeological finding.

Question 5 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

It was supposed to be a transformative merger in an industry facing intractable challenges. But Fiat Chrysler and Renault ran headlong into a familiar problem in France: the government itself.

With the two companies edging toward a deal, officials in Paris played a role that comes naturally—safeguarding jobs and protecting Renault, a celebrated brand here. But in the end, the government **infuriated** both Fiat and Renault executives, who wanted to create a competitive new industrial giant free of state influence, according to two people with knowledge of the discussions.

5. The word **infuriate** most probably means _____.

- ☐ A. to interfere
- ☐ B. to irritate
- ☐ C. to compromise
- ☐ D. to agitate

Question 6 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

I spent three months in India working on charity projects with Deaf Child Worldwide and Stories for Good, spending my days meeting and photographing charity participants in villages around Bodhgaya. After a long day's work, I had just stuffed my face with tandoori chicken in my favorite restaurant, my camera firmly at the back of my mind, and decided to wander the city's alleyways. They're incredibly atmospheric, with their brightly painted homes and local life spilling out everywhere. This man looked so peaceful sitting in silence outside his restaurant, with the mayhem of the town all around him. _____ I had to get my camera out one last time. I loved the photo the moment I took it—it takes me right back to the alleyways of Bodhgaya, and brings back strong memories of the best tandoori chicken I've ever had!

6. Which of the following best fits in the blank?

- ☐ A. Though I was hungry and exhausted,
- ☐ B. The scene grabbed me so much,
- ☐ C. It was such a blissful moment,
- ☐ D. As the only photographer at that time,

Question 7 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

For over 20 years, Germany's Melt Festival has taken place in a location just as charismatic as the acts that have performed there: Ferropolis. This grim strip mine turned greenery-fringed industrial museum in Saxony-Anhalt, 85 miles southwest of Berlin, is home to five giant excavators, with names like Medusa and Mad Max. This year, 19–21 July, they'll form the backdrop to sounds as diverse as the whispery indie of Bon Iver and the artful hip-hop of A\$AP Rocky.

7. Where is the piece of text most probably taken from?

- ☐ A. A concert poster
- ☐ B. A city introduction
- ☐ C. A public notice
- ☐ D. A travel brochure

Question 8 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

It's funny how a negative can give you a positive. Just like two sides of a battery. On one side, you have the not-so-good buzz.

But on the other, you have plans for an almost \$800 million assembly plant expansion in Chattanooga, Tennessee to build electric vehicles, and 1,000 newly employed Chattanoogaans who'll work there. You also have a brand-new platform for how to build electric cars, that will make them accessible to more people, with the ultimate goal of being carbon neutral globally by 2050. See, sometimes the bad can make you better. Sometimes it pushes you to learn from the past, to make the future something that belongs to everyone.

You might call it a lesson. We call it our all-electric ID. Buzz.

8. What does the author write the text for?

- ☐ A. To call for positive attitudes.
- ☐ B. To introduce a modern plant.
- ☐ C. To recruit new staff.
- ☐ D. To advertise new vehicles.

Question 9 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

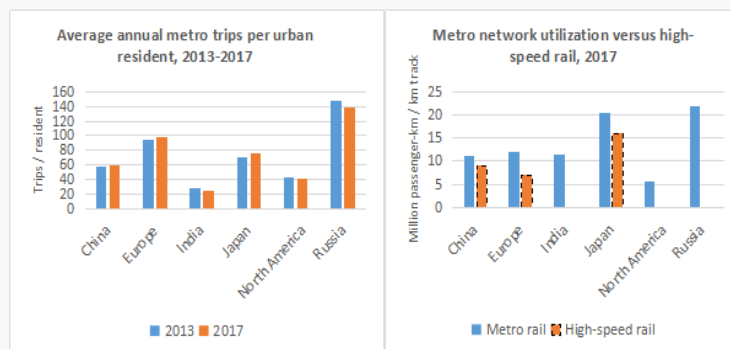
_____, at least in the classical sense. While they're made of proteins and genes like living things, they need to interact with living host cells to reproduce. These agents of cellular mayhem have been the cause of history-altering outbreaks and pandemics, from smallpox and polio to HIV and Ebola, but were only discovered at the turn of the 20th century. Since then, we've found them in nearly every ecosystem worldwide. Viruses are, and always will be, the world's experts at going viral.

9. Which of the following best fits in the blank in the text?

- ☐ A. Viruses spread fast
- ☐ B. Viruses are deadly
- ☐ C. Viruses are not alive
- ☐ D. Viruses replicate easily

Question 10 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: The two figures show the average number of metro trips per urban resident from 2013 to 2017, and metro network utilization versus high-speed rail in 2017 in selected regions. Answer the question according to the information in the figures.



Notes: Information in the figure on the left is based on a weighted average of the number of annual trips per city resident (weighted relative to the number of residents per city) taking into account only the cities that have a metro system.

10. Which of the following CANNOT be interpreted from the figures?

- ☐ A. On average, the utilization of metro rail is much lower than that of high-speed rail from 2013 to 2017.
- ☐ B. A smaller portion of the urban population in India uses the metro system compared with other regions such as China and North America.
- ☐ C. High-speed rail utilization in Japan is roughly twice as high as that in Europe, while residents in Europe make more metro trips annually than those in Japan.
- ☐ D. The intensity of metro system use is much higher in Russia and Europe whereas the intensity is lower in North America.

Question 11 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the definition of the following logical fallacy. Answer the question according to the definition.

Genetic Fallacy

A critic uses the *Genetic Fallacy* if the critic attempts to discredit or support a claim or an argument because of its origin (genesis) when such an appeal to origins is irrelevant.

11. Which of the following provides a typical example of *Genetic Fallacy*?

- ☐ A. Noisy children are a real headache. Two aspirin will make a headache go away. Therefore, two aspirin will make noisy children go away.
- ☐ B. The Supreme Court has just flinched from its responsibility to stop the unjust jailing of two journalists—not charged with any wrongdoing—by a runaway prosecutor who will go to any lengths to use the government's contempt power to force them to betray their confidential sources.
- ☐ C. My political candidate gives 10% of his income to the needy, goes to church every Sunday, and volunteers one day a week at a homeless shelter. Therefore, he is honest and morally straight.
- ☐ D. Whatever your reasons are for buying that gift, they've got to be ridiculous. You said yourself that you got the idea for buying it from last night's fortune cookie. Cookies can't think!

Question 12 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the following text. Answer the question according to the text.

Mom: Those look like bags under your eyes. Are you getting enough sleep?

Jeff: I had a test and stayed up late studying.

Mom: You didn't take any drugs, did you?

Jeff: Just caffeine in my coffee, like I always do.

Mom: Jeff! You know what happens when people take drugs! Pretty soon the caffeine won't be strong enough. Then you will take something stronger, maybe someone's diet pill. Then, something even stronger. Eventually, you will be doing cocaine. Then you will be a crack addict! So, don't drink that coffee.

12. Which of the following statements commits the same fallacy as the text?

- ☐ A. As the water level began to rise, the more advanced creatures would move to higher ground for safety, but more primitive creatures would not do so. This is why you find less complex creatures further down in the fossil record and human fossils near the top.
- ☐ B. You might say that scientific knowledge is a combination of social constructs and "real" knowledge. Of course, the problem then is to figure out how you can tell the realities from the social constructions! Another possibility is to point out that social constructs are also realities of a different sort, and so reality and social construction depend on each other to exist.
- ☐ C. The CEO's proposal will frustrate middle management, who will then take it out on the factory workers. When the factory workers are angry enough, they will go on strike and sink the whole company. Surely, we should not accept the proposal.
- ☐ D. If you do not graduate from high school, you will live in poverty for the rest of your life.

Questions 13-14 Reasoning (Suggested completion time: 8 minutes)

13.

A survey conducted recently in the city indicated that most college welfare-aid applicants understated the number of luxury items—such as cars and TVs—that their family owned, in an effort to maximize the amount of aid they can claim from the city. Paradoxically, the same study also found that many applicants claimed that they had running water and a gas connection even when they did not.

Which of the following best explains the apparent paradox?

- ☐ A. The city does not pay welfare unless the applicants have at least some things working for them.
- ☐ B. While the applicants may be willing to accept that they don't have certain things, they felt embarrassed having to accept that they don't have most things.
- ☐ C. The people who understated what they had were not the same people who overstated what they had.
- ☐ D. Historically, at least 30% of the applicants understated what they had while only 22% overstated what they had.

14.

Jack: To be a woman in this century is far better than to be a woman in centuries past. Life expectancy for women has—for the first time—surpassed that for men and while only around 20% of college students in the late 1800s were women, today, almost 60% of college students are women.

William: However, women educated in the top-ranked colleges in the country earn only about 70% of what their male counterparts earn. Also, studies show that even today, in a number of industries, women are refused top management positions simply because they are women.

Which of the following is Jack most likely to say in response to William?

- ☐ A. There are more women at the entry-level jobs of most industries than there are men.
- ☐ B. The proportion of women in the judicial and legislative branches of the country is at its highest and the country elected its first woman leader recently.
- ☐ C. Women today are healthier and live longer than women in the 1800s, who primarily died because of child birth.
- ☐ D. Women today are better able to juggle professional and personal lives and a number of them are proving to be successful single mothers.

Questions 15-17 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

The European Union gets a lot of flak. All right, it isn't literally blasted with anti-aircraft fire, but you know what we mean. One ongoing battle (OK, nobody died) involves the use of words. Earlier this year, the European Parliament's agriculture committee voted to prohibit the terms "burger", "sausage", "escalope" and "steak" to describe products that do not contain any meat. It was inspired by the European Court of Justice's decision in 2017 to ban the use of "milk", "butter" and "cream" for nondairy products. Exceptions were made for "ice cream" and "almond milk", but "soya milk" went down the drain, lest consumers assume it had been extracted from the soya udder of a soya cow. The court has yet to rule on the milk of human kindness.

Greens (a political group in the European Parliament composed primarily of green and regionalist political parties) are mounting a campaign against the committee's decision, which they suspect is supported not only by linguistic purists but also by the meat industry. This newspaper thinks the parliament is quite right to protect citizens from the confusion they would no doubt feel were they to find that no part of a "veggie burger" was made of the flesh of a dead animal. Indeed, this praiseworthy initiative needs to go further.

"Escalopes" pose a clear danger to consumers, who might well recoil in horror when, taking a mouthful of one, they discover that it is made not of the scallops from which it got its name but of chicken or veal. "Sausages" should refer only to heavily salted meat, whence the term derives; for clarity, consumers should be informed that the item is encased in animal intestine. Steaks should be sold only on a pointed stick, on the grounds that most shoppers will rely on the proto-Indo-European etymology. Any confusion could be avoided if kebabs were, as their Arabic root suggests, always sold burned. The production of burgers should be restricted to the butchers of Hamburg, long ago deprived of their intellectual property by a shocking failure of linguistic regulation. The same right should be extended to makers of Frankfurter sausages—sorry, meat-filled gut. And "meat" itself should apply to all food, sweet or savoury, which would make the term historically accurate, if useless.

Nor should the parliament's reforming zeal be restricted to food. Any reference to the European budget should be confined to the money that the commissioner for economic and monetary affairs, Valdis Dombrovskis, keeps on his person in a *bougette*, or leather purse. Only those banks which carry out their business on wooden benches (*banco*, in Italian) should be included in the banking union. Discussion of computers should be limited to clerks who do budgetary calculations, while that of the digital single market should apply only to sums that people can do on their fingers.

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15. What can we learn from the text?

- ☐ A. The European Union is bombarded with criticism for approving the decision made by the European Parliament's agriculture committee.
- ☐ B. The campaign launched by Greens is believed to have received support from both linguistic purists and the meat industry.
- ☐ C. "Soya milk" is exempted from the ban on the use of "milk," according to the decision made by the European Court of Justice.
- ☐ D. "Escalopes" made of chicken or veal and "sausages" containing little heavily salted meat can endanger customers.

16. What is the author's attitude toward the decision made by the European Parliament's agriculture committee?

- ☐ A. Appreciative
- ☐ B. Apprehensive
- ☐ C. Neutral
- ☐ D. Critical

17. Which of the following would best describe the style of the text?

- ☐ A. Emotional and sentimental.
- ☐ B. Serious and informative.
- ☐ C. Amusing and philosophical.
- ☐ D. Humorous and sarcastic.

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Questions 18-19 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

Some researchers divide the corporation's portrayal of women into distinct eras. First came the domestic era, when female characters like Snow White, Sleeping Beauty and Cinderella were portrayed as homemakers, often cleaning and in need of rescue by a man.

Then came the ____18____, new-age phase of Ariel in *The Little Mermaid*, Princess Jasmine in *Aladdin*, *Pocahontas* and *Mulan*. During this period, Disney's women seemed to gain a more independent streak, striving to free themselves from the bonds of society. But Ariel also sacrifices her voice in order to be with the man she loves.

"The symbolism here is powerful," wrote Mia Adessa Towbin and her colleagues at the family studies department of Colorado State University in one study. "To win the love of the prince, she must forfeit her thoughts and intellect, her independence and identity."

Although the story was originally written by Hans Christian Andersen, the researchers say it provides an apt metaphor for many of Disney's heroines—"no one listens to their words".

The Little Mermaid and the five subsequent films also show another trend—the female characters start to speak less. Despite being the title characters, women speak just 32% of the time in *The Little Mermaid*, while they have just 24% of lines in *Pocahontas* and 23% in *Mulan*. In *Aladdin*, female characters have just 10% of the dialogue.

Carmen Fought and Karen Eisenhauer, the linguists at North Carolina State University whose analysis produced these figures, also found male characters in the same films tended to boss the female characters around far more than vice versa. When the women did so, they were more polite than the men. Others have suggested levels of uncertainty in the dialogue of female characters have also increased.

For critics, this sends a strong message to young children that reinforces many long-standing gender stereotypes. And there is some evidence it could leave a lasting impression.

A study by family life researcher Sarah Coyne at Brigham Young University—inspired by concerns about her daughter's own consumption of Disney—found that engagement with Disney princesses in young girls around two years old was associated with greater female gender-stereotype behaviour and lower body self-esteem a year later.

18. Which of the following words best fits in the numbered space?

- ☐ A. rebellious
- ☐ B. intelligent
- ☐ C. benevolent
- ☐ D. vigorous

19. Which of the following statements is NOT true according to the text?

- ☐ A. Disney's portrayal of virtuous women helps eliminate gender stereotypes.
- ☐ B. Female characters speak far less in Disney films than male characters.
- ☐ C. Disney films are vehicles for powerful gender ideologies.
- ☐ D. Heroines in Disney films fall into two different categories.

Questions 20-22 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

Dark patterns are the often unseen web-design choices that trick users into handing over more time, money, or attention than they realize. A team of Princeton researchers is cataloging these deceptive techniques, using data pulled from 11,000 shopping sites, to identify 15 ways sites subtly game our cognition to control us.

The research builds on the work of Harry Brignull, a London-based cognitive scientist who coined the term *dark pattern* in 2010, and the authors Richard Thaler and Cass Sunstein, whose work on “nudges” explores how default options influence behavior. Just over one in 10 websites contain at least one type of dark pattern, the Princeton research finds. The more popular the site, the more likely it has at least one.

The most common dark pattern is scarcity bias: Put an item in your cart, and you’ll be served a message claiming “Only eight left in stock!” thereby urging you to buy immediately before the item is gone. But by analyzing webpages’ scripts and plug-ins, the researchers found that in many cases, these numbers are either generated randomly or set to decrease according to a schedule.

This theater of numbers is also key to the second most popular dark pattern: the flash sale. Major fashion retailers often tease a sudden, temporary drop in prices, crowning a page with a banner reading “Sale ends soon!” and a countdown timer. The “urgency” creates anxiety and uncertainty, pushing us to take advantage of lower prices immediately. But again, researchers found instances when the sales continued even after the timer had expired.

It’s not just the numbers that are fake—the shoppers are, too. The third most frequent pattern, “social proof,” has to do with the pop-up messages displayed on the sidebar of some sites: “90 people have viewed this item!”, “Joanne from Florida just saved on a sweater!” The tactic harnesses the power of both **bandwagon thinking** and scarcity. But after analyzing the sites, researchers again found that the pop-ups come from random number generators and selections of stock messages. You don’t have to buy the sweater if you don’t want to. Joanne isn’t real; she’s just a few lines of code, and code doesn’t wear sweaters.

I’m certainly not immune to dark patterns. My personal weakness is limited to free trials—to Audible, to Starz, to Amazon Prime. I’ve been burned enough to know better, but I’m still sure every time that I will remember to delete my account before the cutoff date and avoid being charged. Essentially, I have more confidence in my future self than in my present self. That assurance that we can outwit the dark pattern is, naturally, a dark pattern of its own.

20. Which of the following best illustrates "the flash sale"?

- ☐ A. Shoes: This is a limited edition. Final call!
- ☐ B. Discount coupons: Half price. Buy and save 50% today.
- ☐ C. Books: The 100-hour sale is on! Save up to 50%. Ends 24 May.
- ☐ D. Hamburgers: Friday is freeday! Buy one, get one free!

21. What does **bandwagon thinking** in Paragraph 5 most probably mean?

- ☐ A. Arriving at a conclusion without enough evidence.
- ☐ B. Assuming a chain of cause-effect relationships with a very suspect connection.
- ☐ C. Claiming what most people agree to must be right.
- ☒ D. Giving a slanted view of an issue by focusing only on one side.

22. Which of the following is true about the author according to the text?

- ☐ A. He could be not affected by dark patterns after being burned enough.
- ☐ B. He is keen on the free trials on the websites.
- ☐ C. He believes that people can hardly avoid dark patterns.
- ☐ D. He detests and criticizes the dark patterns by retailers.

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Questions 23-24 (Suggested completion time: 7 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.



We are having a productivity crisis. More of us are working, but since the crash we've made almost no progress in getting more out of each hour. In part, that's why we've had the longest pay squeeze in two centuries. But what affects our productivity? An answer has come from an unlikely source—fishmongers in Vietnam. And those of a ____23____ disposition are not going to like it.

Many economists recognise the benefits of having similar companies in proximity. The story goes that “clusters” of particular types of businesses lead to higher productivity because people learn from each other. But does this apply to proximity of workers within a firm? Not so much is the answer from intriguing research by the University of Hong Kong. The author took a seafood-processing plant in Vietnam and compared how many kilograms of fish were filleted when people were randomly allocated work stations as against choosing their neighbours. Ten per cent more fish were gutted when people were randomly allocated work stations and less able to chat to their mates. But before employers start segregating staff it's worth noting that people like to chat—the study found that workers would forgo nearly 5% of their wages to work around friends.

Personally, I prefer acting on separate Bank of England research that says we face a “crisis of attention” at work courtesy of emails and social media. Our virtual friends, rather than close work colleagues, are the real distraction.

23. Which of the following words best fits in the numbered space?

- ☐ A. friendly
- ☐ B. greedy
- ☐ C. generous
- ☐ D. sociable

24. What can we conclude from the study by the University of Hong Kong?

- ☐ A. A casual working environment helps Vietnam's fish workers to enhance their work efficiency.
- ☐ B. Vietnam's fish workers are more productive but less satisfied when separated from their mates.
- ☐ C. Employers' random segregation of staff may be the real reason for today's productivity crisis.
- ☐ D. “Clusters” of seafood-processing plants in proximity can lead to higher productivity.

Questions 25-26 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

As much as we venerate rebels, free-thinkers, and marching to the beat of our own drum, in reality it's much easier—and more common—for us to follow the crowd. Our natural tendency for conformity strikes many as harmful, but it can also strengthen bonds and generate outcomes that benefit both groups and individuals. In his book *Conformity*, Harvard law professor Cass Sunstein examines when it's best to follow others and when we're better off thinking for ourselves.

Following the herd is widely denigrated. Why do we still do it?

Conformity is a universal feature across societies, which suggests that it has an evolutionary advantage. Today, many existing norms that people conform to make sense from that perspective. If people in one society are socially pressured to use only words during a disagreement, for example, that society will do better over time than one where people use fists.

_____ 25 _____

There are two scenarios in which conformity is usually best: solving coordination problems, like getting everyone to drive on the right side of the road, and solving collective action problems, like making a group decision to mutually respect private property. For individuals, it might be rational to not respect others' property, but for the group as a whole, it's best to do so. Conforming solves that problem.

_____ 26 _____

Conforming out of deference to authority, concern for one's social standing, or fear of punishment can lead someone to defy the evidence of their own senses. Another issue is polarization: Research has found that groups often end up taking more extreme positions than their average member. Conformity—both learning from others and wanting others' favor—helps explain why groups can become shockingly extreme.

How can we better tell the difference between “good” and “bad” conformity?

Practices to which people conform should be regularly evaluated on their merits. Having just one voice of nonconformity in a group increases the stock of information, which allows us to test and refine ideas. Society doesn't benefit from people saying the Holocaust never happened. But in any organization, there's a risk of people silencing themselves out of courtesy, camaraderie, or fear. That can make the group do poorly, because it won't learn what its members know. Conformity suppresses information.

25-26. Decide whether each subtitle is correct for the numbered spaces in the text.

25. Generally, when is it better to conform?

- ☐ A. YES
☐ B. NO

26. How does conformity influence our behavior in daily life?

- ☐ A. YES
☐ B. NO

Questions 27-30 (Suggested completion time: 8 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

Jeremy Newman is the global CEO of BDO, one of the world's largest accounting firms. By any measure he is hugely successful in his professional life, and yet he tells me that he worries constantly that he is not good enough. In my 25 years of researching leadership and professional service firms I have heard numerous brilliant, successful, and apparently confident people describe themselves as insecure. They are "insecure overachievers": exceptionally capable and fiercely ambitious, but driven by a profound belief in their own inadequacy.

Insecure overachievers are made, not born, and typically in childhood, through experiencing psychological, financial, or physical insecurity. For example, children who experience sudden and unexpected poverty may find that, as adults, they are never able to earn enough to overcome their fear that this will happen again. Some children grow up believing that they are noticed and valued by their parents only when they are excelling. This attitude may persist long after they have left home because they have internalised that insecurity as part of their identity.

It is no wonder that people like this have traditionally applied for jobs in elite professional firms. However, the evaluation and reward systems within these firms make the fears very real. Promotion is highly competitive and—worse—opaque. Dr. Alexandra Michel at the University of Pennsylvania has researched the lives and careers of investment bankers. She explains: "The reward at the end of the year depends on your evaluation in relation to others. And you don't know what they're producing. You just know that they're super smart and that they're working super hard."

People know that they are being directly measured against their colleagues. But because they don't actually know how their colleagues are doing, they set themselves incredibly high standards, just to be sure. And because everyone in the system is doing this, the standards just get higher and higher, requiring everyone to work harder and harder.

So if you are an insecure overachiever, what can you do about it? The factors that create insecurity are based in childhood so there is little that you can do to influence that. However, you can influence how you respond to it.

First, 29. Notice the ways in which your organisation is trying to manipulate your behaviour and how you respond. Notice which of your colleagues are particularly likely to make you feel more anxious through their comments and actions—be ready to raise your psychological defences if necessary.

Second, 30. If you are going to devote yourself, body and soul, to your work, choose a job where you stand the best chance of succeeding and enjoying what you do. Don't persist in a job that doesn't suit you—quitting a job you "can't cope with" is not a sign of failure but a sign of good sense and emotional maturity.

And, third, respect the evidence of and celebrate your success. Once an insecure overachiever has achieved a goal, they tend to discount it quickly and set the bar even higher. So when you have achieved something, remember how concerned you were about not succeeding, how often you have succeeded in spite of these concerns, and challenge yourself to believe the evidence of your persistent pattern of success.

27. Which of the following is NOT one of the characteristics of "insecure overachievers"?

- ☐ A. Ambitious.
- ☐ B. Competent.
- ☐ C. Industrious.
- ☐ D. Impetuous.

28. "Insecure overachievers" are made by a complex combination of the following factors EXCEPT _____.

- ☐ A. childhood experiences
- ☐ B. lack of work-life balance
- ☐ C. internal competition for promotions
- ☐ D. lack of transparency for promotions

29-30. Which two of the following topic sentences best fit in the numbered spaces in the text?

- A. leap the psychological hurdle
- B. recognise your triggers
- C. remember when to job hop and when to stay put
- D. define success in your own terms, not others'
- E. care less about others' judgment of your work

29

30

Questions 31-40 (Suggested completion time: 35 minutes)

Directions: Read the three passages about water. Answer the questions according to the passages.

Passage A

Where does all the Earth's water come from? Primordial Earth was an incandescent globe made of magma, but all magmas contain water. Water set free by magma began to cool down the Earth's atmosphere, until it could stay on the surface as a liquid. Volcanic activity kept and still keeps introducing water in the atmosphere, thus increasing the surface- and groundwater volume of the Earth.

The water cycle has no starting point. But, we'll begin in the oceans, since that is where most of Earth's water exists. The sun, which drives the water cycle, heats water in the oceans. Some of it evaporates as vapor into the air. Ice and snow can sublime directly into water vapor. Rising air currents take the vapor up into the atmosphere, along with water from evapotranspiration, which is water transpired from plants and evaporated from the soil. The vapor rises into the air where cooler temperatures cause it to condense into clouds.

Air currents move clouds around the globe, cloud particles collide, grow, and fall out of the sky as precipitation. Some precipitation falls as snow and can accumulate as ice caps and glaciers, which can store frozen water for thousands of years. Snowpacks in warmer climates often thaw and melt when spring arrives, and the melted water flows overland as snowmelt.

Most precipitation falls back into the oceans or onto land, where, due to gravity, the precipitation flows over the ground as surface runoff. A portion of runoff enters rivers in valleys in the landscape, with streamflow moving water towards the oceans. Runoff, and groundwater seepage, accumulate and are stored as freshwater in lakes. Not all runoff flows into rivers, though. Much of it soaks into the ground as infiltration. Some water infiltrates deep into the ground and replenishes aquifers (saturated subsurface rock), which store huge amounts of freshwater for long periods of time.

Some infiltration stays close to the land surface and can seep back into surface-water bodies (and the ocean) as groundwater discharge, and some groundwater finds openings in the land surface and emerges as freshwater springs. Over time, though, all of this water keeps moving, some to reenter the ocean, where the water cycle "ends" ... oops—I mean, where it "begins."

Passage B

Pictures of the earth's water cycle used in education and research throughout the world are in urgent need of updating to show the effects of human interference, according to new analysis by an international team of hydrology experts.

Leaving humans out of the picture, the researchers argue, contributes to a basic lack of awareness of how humans relate to water on Earth—and a false sense of security about future availability of this essential and scarce resource.

The team has drawn up a new set of diagrams to promote better understanding of how our water cycle works in the 21st century. These new diagrams show human interference in nearly all parts of the cycle.

The study, published in *Nature Geoscience*, with an additional comment in *Nature*, was carried out by a large team of experts from Brigham Young University and Michigan State University in the US and the University of Birmingham in the UK, along with partners in the US, France, Canada, Switzerland and Sweden.

It showed that, in a sample of more than 450 water cycle diagrams in textbooks, scientific literature and online, 85 per cent showed no human interaction at all with the water cycle, and only 2 per cent of the images made any attempt to connect the cycle with climate change or water pollution.

In addition, nearly all the examples studied depicted **verdant** landscapes, with mild climates and abundant freshwater—usually with only a single river basin.

The researchers argue there is an urgent need to challenge this misrepresentation and promote a more accurate and sophisticated understanding of the cycle and how it works in the 21st century. This is crucial if society is to be able to achieve global solutions to the world's water crisis.

"The water cycle diagram is a central icon of hydro science, but misrepresenting the ways in which humans have influenced this cycle diminishes our awareness of the looming global water crisis," says Professor David Hannah, UNESCO Chair in Water Sciences at the University of Birmingham.

"By leaving out climate change, human consumption, and changes in land use we are, in effect, creating large gaps in understanding and perception among the public and also among some scientists."

The new diagrams drawn up by the team show a more complex picture that includes elements such as meltwater from glaciers, flood damage caused by land use changes, pollution and sea level rises.

Professor Stefan Krause, Head of the Birmingham Water Council states: "For the first time, the new water cycle diagram adequately reflects the importance of not just quantities of water but also water quality and pollution as key criteria for assessing water resources".

Professor Ben Abbott, from Brigham Young University, is lead author on the paper: "Every scientific diagram involves compromises and distortions, but what we found with the water cycle was widespread exclusion of a central concept. You can't understand water in the 21st century without including humans."

"Other scientific disciplines have done a good job depicting how humans now dominate many aspects of the Earth system. It's hard to find a diagram of the carbon or nitrogen cycle that doesn't show factories and fertilizers. However, our drawings of the water cycle are stuck in the 17th century."

"Better drawings of the water cycle won't solve the global water crisis on their own,



but they could improve awareness of how local water use and climate change have global consequences.”

Passage C

We were warned 150 years ago about our water shortage. We have to do better.

Coming into the crush of the first real rapid, Red Creek, I white-knuckle my paddle, try to keep breathing and think about what John Wesley Powell must have felt when he teed up to the trough of the first wave.

It's May, the same time of year that, 150 years ago, Powell and a nine-man crew put onto the Green River just upstream from here and paddled on down the Colorado through the Grand Canyon—the first non-Native Americans on record to do so.

When Powell made his trip, the Homestead Act was less than a decade old, and the chalk-dust canyons of the Colorado Plateau were a big blank space on the map. America's manifest destiny was just manifesting itself, but he could see that as the West filled up, human demand for its resources would outstrip supply.

His predictions about water shortages have proved eerily true. The Colorado River—of which the Green is the biggest tributary—is the main water source for 40 million people. It's already overallocated, and climate change is predicted to shrink flows by up to 50 percent by the end of the century. We're finally coming to grips with those forecasts and beginning to pay careful attention to Powell's century-and-a-half-old warnings. But it's taken drought and desperation to get us there, and we have to do better.

This spring, the seven states in the Colorado River Basin signed a drought contingency plan. For the first time, each of the states has agreed to take less than its individual allocated share of water, to try to shore up the supply for a drier future. It's a small but significant step in dialing back demand to meet supply—the heart of Powell's prediction—but no one, not even the state leaders who agreed to it after almost 100 years of battling over water rights, thinks it goes far enough.

Climate change and overuse are still advancing. I followed Powell's path because I wanted to understand how water conflicts were going to play out, and my first move was the same as his: get on the river to see what's going on. Today, Red Creek is in the tailwater of Flaming Gorge Dam, and I can see the impacts of a highly regulated waterway: the non-native trout, the unnaturally clear water, because the dam stops sediment that would normally make the current milky and thick. We've constructed a vast network of pipes, reservoirs and dams and built up a society around that man-made river, and that's not going to change. No one wants to cut off water to Salt Lake City or to stop growing food in Yuma, Arizona.

This winter brought above-average snowfall, but it barely dents two decades of extended drought that experts are now calling aridity, because drought sounds temporary and fixable. It was another anomalous winter in the swinging yo-yo of climate change: unpredictable and hard to manage, in a river system that's managed down to every drop.

We've been okay so far, in part because reservoirs give us a buffer in the dry years, but we're sucking down our storage, and in the fragile interlocking mesh of current water use, our squeezed supply won't last for long.

As I paddled, I saw the intractability of an overstretched water system firsthand: ranchers with decades of family history who told me they were unable to pass down their land, cities building new reservoirs to shore up their reserves, desiccated tribal reservations where opportunity has been thwarted by withheld water rights. It was obvious, as Powell anticipated, that the math didn't line up.

In his "Report on the Lands of the Arid Region of the United States," he predicted that there wouldn't be enough water for unchecked westward growth in the drylands beyond the Great Plains; he warned that groundwater wouldn't be enough to sustain agriculture and that the most sustainable way to use water in the West would be lightly, and within a river's own watershed.

The prevailing climate theory at the time, pushed by land speculator Charles Dana Wilber, was that "rain follows the plow"—that is, agriculture itself could change the climate of arid regions—so Powell's message of moderation was inconvenient to the culture of optimism and American exceptionalism. It still is. We know better than that now, I think, but it's hard to shake the outdated dreams that we can keep growing and not suffer consequences. The drought contingency plan is an important step in addressing that, but there will need to be more compromises and creative ways to incentivize using less.

Spring, if you're a boater, always comes with the fragile dream of following the hydrograph, watching for the spike of runoff, trying to predict your risk and your rush as you hope that snowmelt and spring rains have provided the depth to make your way downstream. But at some point, that risk has to line up with reality. You can't float if you don't have any water.



31. Which of the following is NOT true about the water cycle described in Passage A?

- ☐ A. The sun provides the important driving force for the water cycle.
- ☐ B. Water vapor keeps rising and becomes clouds in the process of transpiration.
- ☐ C. Water exists in magma and when set free it can cool down the Earth's atmosphere.
- ☐ D. Precipitation is the last step of the water cycle that brings water back to the ocean.

32. Which is the best title for Passage A?

- ☐ A. All water runs into the oceans
- ☐ B. The origin of the Earth's water cycle
- ☐ C. How does water come into being?
- ☐ D. The fundamentals of the water cycle

33. The word **verdant** in Passage B is closest in meaning to _____.

- ☐ A. productive
- ☐ B. fresh and green
- ☐ C. cool and bleak
- ☐ D. droughty

34. In Passage B, Professor David Hannah's words suggest that _____.

- ☐ A. it is necessary to correct people's awareness of the water cycle in the 21st century
- ☐ B. the solution to the world's water crisis should begin with rousing society's attention
- ☐ C. the new diagrams are more accurate and proper to be the icon of hydro science
- ☐ D. there're different perceptions of the water cycle between the public and some scientists

35. According to Passage B, the water cycle diagrams are "stuck in the 17th century" because _____.

- ☐ A. human impacts are included in other scientific diagrams but not those of the water cycle
- ☐ B. other scientific disciplines adequately reflect the activities of humans
- ☐ C. distortions are allowed in scientific diagrams except in the water cycle diagrams
- ☐ D. they fail to keep pace with the development of modern science

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36. According to Passage C, it can be inferred that

John Wesley Powell might be _____.

- ☐ A. an explorer
- ☐ B. a scientist
- ☐ C. an activist
- ☐ D. a reporter

37. Reservoirs and dams are mentioned in Passage C

in order to show _____.

- ☐ A. the achievements of water conservancy in the Red Creek
- ☐ B. the concern about their function in the river system
- ☐ C. their positive impacts on regulating the waterway
- ☐ D. their influence on the people and wildlife around

38. According to Passage C, what can be learned from

Charles Dana Wilber's climate theory?

- ☐ A. It points out the interaction between agricultural production and climate change.
- ☐ B. It is an optimistic assumption about the impact of agriculture on the water system.
- ☐ C. It is still popular today because people have a better understanding of it.
- ☐ D. It shares a common idea with John Wesley Powell's report about water shortage.

39. What has been admitted in both Passage B and

Passage C?

- ☐ A. There is a long way to go to solve the problem of water shortage.
- ☐ B. Human activities have undoubtedly changed the water system.
- ☐ C. Solving the global water crisis is a pressing priority for humanity.
- ☐ D. Climate change is one of the consequences of water shortage.

40. Which of the following is TRUE based on the

passages?

- ☐ A. Passage C focuses on the impact of water shortage in the Red Creek region.
- ☐ B. The water cycle mentioned in Passage A is inaccurate and out of date.
- ☐ C. None of the three passages shows the viewpoint of the authors.
- ☐ D. The study in Passage B is meaningful and thought-provoking.

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Question 41 (Suggested completion time: 40 minutes)

Directions: Read the excerpt from *A Short History of Chinese Philosophy*. Write a short essay according to the excerpt.

When a Western student begins to read Chinese philosophical works, the first impression s/he gets is perhaps the briefness and disconnectedness of the sayings and writings of their authors. Open the *Confucian Analects* and you will see that each paragraph consists of only a few words, and there is hardly any connection between one paragraph and the next. Open a book containing the philosophy of Lao Tzu, and you will find that the whole book consists of about five thousand words—no longer than a magazine article; yet in it one will find the whole of his philosophy. A student accustomed to elaborate reasoning and detailed argument would be at a loss to understand what these Chinese philosophers were saying. He would be inclined to think that there was disconnectedness in the thought itself. If this were so, there would be no Chinese philosophy. For disconnected thought is hardly worthy of the name of philosophy.

It may be said that the apparent disconnectedness of the sayings and writings of the Chinese philosophers is due to the fact that these sayings and writings are not formal philosophical works. According to Chinese tradition, the study of philosophy is not a profession. Everyone should study philosophy just as in the West everyone should go to church. The purpose of the study of philosophy is to enable a man, as a *man*, to be a man, not some particular kind of man. Other studies—not the study of philosophy—enable a man to be some special kind of man. So there were no professional philosophers; and non-professional philosophers did not have to produce formal philosophical writings. In China, there were far more philosophers who produced no formal philosophical writings than those who did. If one wishes to study the philosophy of these men, one has to go to the records of their sayings or the letters they wrote to disciples and friends. These letters did not belong to just one period in the life of the person who wrote them, nor were the records written only by a single person. Disconnectedness or even inconsistency between them is, therefore, to be expected.

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The foregoing may explain why the writings and sayings of some philosophers are disconnected; but it does not explain why they are brief. In some philosophic writings, such as those of Mencius and Hsün Tzu, one does find systematic reasoning and arguments. But in comparison with the philosophic writings of the West, they are still not articulate enough. The fact is that Chinese philosophers were accustomed to express themselves in the form of aphorisms*, apothegms, or allusions, and illustrations. The whole book of the *Lao-tzu* consists of aphorisms and most of the chapters of the *Chuang-tzu* are full of allusions and illustrations. This is very obvious. But even in writings such as those of Mencius and Hsün Tzu, mentioned above, when compared with the philosophical writings of the West, there are still too many aphorisms, allusions, and illustrations. Aphorisms must be very brief; allusions and illustrations must be disconnected.

Aphorisms, allusions, and illustrations are thus not articulate enough. Their insufficiency in articulateness is compensated for, however, by their suggestiveness. Articulateness and suggestiveness are, of course, incompatible. The more an expression is articulate, the less it is suggestive—just as the more an expression is prosaic, the less it is poetic. The sayings and writings of the Chinese philosophers are so inarticulate that their suggestiveness is almost boundless.

Suggestiveness, not articulateness, is the ideal of all Chinese art, whether it be poetry, painting, or anything else. In poetry, what the poet intends to communicate is often not what is directly said in the poetry, but what is not said in it. According to Chinese literary tradition, in good poetry “the number of words is limited, but the ideas it suggests are limitless.” So an intelligent reader of poetry reads what is outside the poem; and a good reader of books reads “what is between the lines.” Such is the ideal of Chinese art, and this ideal is reflected in the way in which Chinese philosophers have expressed themselves.

(*aphorism: a short phrase that contains a great idea)

41. Write a short essay of at least 200 words based on your understanding of the excerpt. Remember to write in your OWN words. Your essay should respond to the following questions:

- (1) What are the two characteristics of the Western philosophical writings in contrast with the Chinese ones as implied in the excerpt?
- (2) How does the author clear up the Westerners' confusion about Chinese philosophical writings?
- (3) Do you agree with the author's description of the purpose of philosophy? Please support your opinion with information from the given excerpt.

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